



HEADWATERS · DIGITAL EDITION

How a Community Runs Its Own Economy

A field guide to the words, relationships,
and practices that keep community work
rooted in the people who own it.

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- Coda · From scared to prepared
- C · The Source

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BOOK CONTENT

Part P · Prologue

Pioneer training — the calm before the storm, and who this work is for.

P.E · The eagle answered

Prologue · the founding moment · is this the right direction?

I was drafting this plan standing out on my deck, observing nature, and I asked myself: *is this the right direction?*

At that moment an eagle appeared overhead. I said, "well hello!" — and he lowered with force, and slowly stayed above me.

I asked again, this time to him: *is this the right direction?*

He soared in a circle formation, then flew out of sight.

| *The story that sealed Headwaters' fate.*

P.0 · For the mothers

I may have solved all the problems of the world from my kitchen table.

I say that with a straight face, and I also say it knowing that kitchen table is not meant to be clean.

This book is for the mothers. It was written at the table where the coffee DOESN'T go cold before you drink it because you use a travel mug every day, where the conversation gets interrupted before it finishes (but the shared glance built a connection worth a million words), where the system you built before breakfast gets rattled by noon and rebuilt by supper. If you are reading this and you have never had to choose between finishing a thought and feeding something that cannot feed itself — this book will still teach you something. But it was not written for you first.

The women who need this book already know the work is real. They do not need me to convince them the system matters. They need to feel that I know what the system costs, where the shortcuts are and why agitation is what makes the clothes clean.

Here is what I know: the coop still needs to be cleaned when the contract comes in. The dishes do not wait for the season to settle. The child who watches you hold the hard thing without dropping it is learning something that no classroom teaches and no curriculum names. You are not behind. You are in the friction. That is where the coordinates live.

You always need to hold both states or you will lose your coordinates in time and space.

That is the whole book. Everything that follows is the worked example.

P.1 · Pioneer training

Prologue · who this work is for · the calm before the storm.

This handbook teaches you how to run a community economy — the vocabulary, the methods, and the repeatable moves that let a band council, a food co-op, or a community organisation build and hand forward systems it owns outright. It was written by a practitioner who built these systems in Northwestern Ontario and tested every word in the field. The work is rooted there — reserves and northern communities are the origin and the ongoing priority. The discipline travels: it belongs to any practitioner, anywhere a community needs language precise enough to own what it builds. By the time you finish it, you will have the language to scope a problem, name the work precisely, and hand it over to the people who will run it — without importing someone else's assumptions along with the terminology.

This is the calm before the storm.

Sons and daughters of thunder.

We are the sons and daughters of thunder — those who have stood for years at the headwaters, holding back the flood not to stop it, but to learn its rhythm, its force, its promise. We did not dam the future; we studied it. We prepared.

How the instruments are built.

The kits and tools in this handbook are not derived from theory. They move the other way. We begin with what people are already doing and already struggling with — at the kitchen table, in the household, in the small group — and we watch. We watch what helps, what keeps leaking, what quietly holds even when no one has named it yet. Only when a pattern has proven itself across independent encounters with the same terrain does it get shaped into an instrument and passed on.

The method has a name.

The formal term is Grounded Theory — a research discipline that refuses to begin with a hypothesis and earns its conclusions instead by asking whether the pattern keeps appearing when you look for it across real, independent attempts at the same problem. The sons and daughters of thunder do not need the academic name to practise the method. They are already practising it whenever they trust what they have lived over what they have read. The name is offered here not to impress but to make the claim verifiable: this is not intuition dressed as method. It is a recognised discipline with a body of literature, and it produces the same results when applied honestly by anyone willing to start with real life rather than a whiteboard.

We trust the kitchen table more than the whiteboard. The useful tool has to earn its place by working in ordinary life before it is written down and passed on.

Why the Rename Test exists.

Every kit in this handbook carries a Rename Test — a check that asks whether the person holding the tool can put it in their own words, for their own community, without losing the function. That test is not a formality. It is the method keeping itself honest. A tool that cannot survive renaming has not been grounded. It is still theory. The Rename Test is the mechanism by which the discipline stays rooted in what people can actually use — and why the power the sons and daughters of thunder carry is verifiable, not assumed.

The icon is a ship.

The Headwaters icon is a ship. Not a fortress. Not a temple. A vessel — trim, seaworthy, ready to leave the known shore. AI is the new territory: vast, unmapped, alive with both peril and possibility. Literate programming — the practice of writing code so the human logic drives the machine, not the other way around — is only the first small sail on that horizon, a tiny blip of clarity in an ocean of code. It still lacks shape. It still needs hands — many hands — practicing, refining, grounding it in reality.

Who the work belongs to.

This work belongs to well-grounded individuals who prize self-sovereignty and refuse aggression. It calls to big hearts, restless minds, and artists who understand that the most powerful tools are also the most beautiful when shaped by care.

We are not late to this frontier. We are the ones who kept the headwaters while the world slept. Now we launch.

What follows.

Begin with Grounding — the teachers, Thunder, and the reading lineages the practitioner trained on. Then Part I names the discipline: what it is, where it lives, and the three or four moves it makes. Part II is the discipline applied to a real community economy — six zones, three naming primitives (Saltbox, Both-States, Both-Sides), and two constellation-wide tools. Part III is the practitioner in the field, including Zone 0, the household as the first ground. The Open Questions section keeps unresolved problems in writing so the discipline cannot

quietly resolve them by attrition. The Deep Dives section is optional: seven chapters on how codetory differs from the disciplines it most closely resembles. If you know what codetory is and you are ready to use it, skip directly to the Field Ledger or set the book down and begin.

The chapter you are reading now returns later, in §5.7, in a different register — there as the open question of who this work is for, named structurally rather than spoken aloud. The two readings are meant to bracket the discipline: the invocation at the front, the kept-open question at the back, and the practice in between.

Tool: The Pioneer Path — The handbook walked, not read. Five stations — each with a short voiceover, a reading, and one thing to do before the next opens.

P.2 · What this is

Prologue · for the practitioner who found this · the front door.

The words you use to describe your economy determine what your economy can become. This is not a rhetorical claim. It is a practical one.

Language is not neutral.

When a northern food co-op uses the word *resident* instead of *neighbour*, something real changes — the relationship implied, the obligation carried, the culture formed. When a practitioner names their emergency food reserve *The Call* and their ongoing stock discipline *The Pantry*, they end up with two separate systems, two separate cultures, and a handoff they have to invent under fire. When a funder asks a community to describe its *bank account* and the community's word for that thing is *channel*, the translation is not neutral — something is lost, or flattened, or colonized in the language itself.

This handbook is a vocabulary.

Not a framework, not a methodology, not a strategic plan. A vocabulary — the specific, precise, weight-tested words that a community needs to run its own economy without importing someone else's assumptions along with the terminology.

It was built in Headwaters, a small constellation of economic systems serving northwestern Ontario — food, money, knowledge, emergency preparedness, land. The words here emerged from practice: from the specific moment when the wrong word caused a real problem, and the right word had to be found. They have been tested in the field, rejected when they didn't hold, and revised when the context changed.

What a primitive is.

The vocabulary is organized around *primitives* — named systems that do a specific job inside the constellation. A primitive, in programming and in the natural world, is a base element: the bedrock everything else is built from. That the word crosses both registers is intentional — this handbook is trying to make new programmers out of people who already think in systems. Each primitive has a name chosen to hold across every context in which it appears. The Standby, for instance, is not a pantry and not an emergency callout. It is the single system that holds both — in its resting state, an always-on preparation discipline; in its activated state, a fast collective response. One word. Both states. The name does not bend.

The Gate is not a translator and not a filter. It is the membrane between the community's own language — *neighbour, channel, standby stock, the watch* — and the language that regulators, funders, and bankers will accept. The Gate holds both sides simultaneously, all the time, and it knows when a word has no honest equivalent in the other language and refuses to substitute.

The refused outcome is not a failure. It is a discipline. Some words do not cross. Protecting the word is more important than completing the translation.

Who this is for.

This is not neutral technical vocabulary. It is a set of claims about how a community economy works, encoded in the words used to run it. If your vocabulary is borrowed from grant applications, from SaaS platforms, from government forms — your economy will slowly take the shape of those forms. If your vocabulary is built from your own practice, named by your own practitioners, tested in your own conditions — your economy has a chance to stay yours.

This handbook is for practitioners: people who are already running something, who are frustrated by language that almost fits, and who are ready to name what they are actually doing with precision.

It is not for everyone. It is for the people who feel the friction of the wrong word at the exact moment when the right word would have mattered.

About the vocabulary.

This handbook introduces specific words — *primitive, zone, constellation, The Gate, The Standby, resting state, activated state*. Each word was chosen because the generic alternative came with someone else's assumptions embedded in it. You do not have to adopt the vocabulary wholesale to use the discipline. But each time a specific word appears, it is there because the generic word was not precise enough to do the job without importing a foreign frame along with it.

The test for any word in this handbook is in §1.1: try to rename it. If the rename costs nothing — if the thing it named still stands — the word was decoration. If the rename takes something structural with it, the word was load-bearing, and it was load-bearing for a reason. Run that test on anything here that feels like jargon. It will tell you whether the word is earning its place.

The examples are Bobbie's. The discipline is yours.

The worked examples in this handbook come from one practitioner's specific context — a small constellation in northwestern Ontario, on Treaty 3 Territory, centred in Dryden. A food co-op. A jar kitchen. A spring-fed well with a manual pump. Those examples are here because a discipline without a real example is not a discipline; it is a wish. Use them to understand the moves.

Then throw them away. The only correct way to read this book is to come out the other end building something that has nothing to do with a food co-op in Dryden — unless, of course, that is exactly where you are.

How the discipline began.

The work began not with a theory but with a condition: people already stretched past their limits, pulled sideways in a dozen directions at once. The immediate temptation — add more pressure, add more complicated systems — was the wrong answer. What the conditions called for was a model that lets ordinary people make capacity-creating moves consciously, at the kitchen table, in a form that does not break when many tables eventually link together.

The search and the result.

The search began in overload. The result is a repeatable way to restore and expand capacity that stays human-scaled at the table and still works when many tables join.

That is the through-line: from the original need to the geometry, the primitives, the kits, and the 720° return pass.

Tool: Word Walk — Five codetry words a day, one deliberate choice at a time. Use it to build vocabulary as you read — not before, not after.

Part G · Grounding

Start here. The teachers whose thinking this practice grows from, Thunder — the statement that arrives before you can reason about it — and the reading lineages that trained the practitioner's ear. Understand the roots and the discipline in Part I will make immediate sense. Understand the soil before you plant.

4.1 · The four teachers and Thunder

Codetry is not a school of thought. It is a practice that grew up listening to four teachers in particular. They are named here, in their own words where possible, because the discipline cannot be honestly read without them.

Jack Spirko — The Survival Podcast. for if times get tough or even if they don't.

Joel Salatin — The Lunatic Farmer. frequent meditations on food and farming that bring a wise and humble conscience to practice, policy, and participation.

Nicole Sauce — Living Free in Tennessee. build the life you choose on your terms.

Freedom Cells. peer-to-peer community organization, co-founded by Derrick Broze and John Bush.

Henry Cloud — *Boundaries / Your Desired Future*. you cannot change what you do not own; you cannot build what you have not named.

One more — from further back.

Lao Tzu is not in the constellation manifest. He predates the discipline by about 2,500 years and he did not run a podcast. But the *Tao Te Ching*'s twenty-second chapter is the oldest statement the practitioner knows of the principle that codetory practices: *Yield and overcome. Bend and be straight. Empty and be full. Wear out and be new. Have little and gain. Have much and be confused.* The way that names naming is not the eternal naming. That is not a paradox to escape — it is the first instruction. The name is always downstream of the thing. The discipline is keeping the name close enough to the thing that the distance between them is survivable.

Thunder

there is no shortage of problems, but when we look for solutions it all becomes a little easier

From the constellation manifest, grammar.thunder.

- Jack Spirko · *The Survival Podcast*
 - Joel Salatin · *The Lunatic Farmer*
 - Nicole Sauce · *Living Free in Tennessee*
 - Freedom Cells · *peer-to-peer network*
 - Henry Cloud · *Boundaries / Your Desired Future*
 - Lao Tzu · *Tao Te Ching* — *the oldest statement the practitioner knows of this principle*
-

The oldest horizon.

The Haudenosaunee Great Law of Peace names the design constraint this practice tries to answer: a decision is not finished until its consequence for the seventh generation has been named. Seven generations is roughly 175 years — far past any individual practitioner's working life, far past any current software stack, far past any funder's reporting cycle.

Codetry's bet is that the names a community coins for its own systems are the things likeliest to survive those horizons, because they are the things the community can hold without an outside contractor, a platform licence, or an institutional login. The seventh generation is the test. The name is the thing that could pass it.

The seven-generation principle runs through the whole constellation. It is named first here, in the grounding, because it is the reason the discipline exists — not as an ambition for scale, but as a standard of honesty about what the work is actually for.

4.2 · Lineage

Codetry sits in a lineage of disciplines that take naming seriously. The roots are deeper than the prior chapter implied — most of what codetry does load-bearingly was already practised, in pieces, by people who were not calling it codetry. This chapter names the roots honestly and then names the smaller thing that is genuinely new on top of them.

Code poetry (1980s →)

From Perl in the late 1980s to the Stanford Code Poetry Slam, Mez Breeze, Nick Montfort, and Ishac Bertran's *code {poems}* anthology — a tradition of source code as poem. Adjacent and respected.

Go deeper → §DD.1

Literate programming (Knuth, 1984)

Donald Knuth's WEB and CWEB; Org-mode Babel, Jupyter, R Markdown, and Quarto carry the practice today. Document is the source; code is woven from prose. The discipline closest to codetry in this lineage — and, on the reading §5.1 lands on, the discipline codetry sits one floor underneath rather than across the room from: literate programming verifies by exposing the reasoning, but the woven program only does what its prose says it does to the extent that the names inside the source carry the metaphor the prose claims, and holding those names is the move codetry is for.

Go deeper → §DD.2

The earlier book (2017)

The practitioner's prior book on codetry was written in 2017 from inside an industry context. It named the impulse but did not yet have a constellation to draw the discipline against. This handbook is the same impulse, nine years later, with the worked examples now in front of it.

Don't trust; verify

The older line that codetry's verification belongs to. Show your work in the medium where the work actually lives. For codetry, the medium is the name on the button.

Domain-driven design (Evans, 2003)

Eric Evans' *Domain-Driven Design* and the bounded-context, ubiquitous-language vocabulary it seeded. DDD's *ubiquitous language* is the closest single phrase in the prior literature to what codetry asks of a name: a word that has to live in the conversation, the whiteboard, and the code at once, with no translation step in between. §DD.3 already named DDD as a sibling discipline to codetry; this chapter names it as a *root*. The rename test of §3.2 is the same move DDD's bounded-context boundary already half-described — codetry's contribution is to make the test sharp at the level of the individual noun rather than the bounded context, and to apply it outside enterprise software, in community institutions where the *domain experts* are the people who live in the place.

Go deeper → §DD.3

Beck and the XP/agile vocabulary (1999 →)

Kent Beck's *Extreme Programming Explained* and the agile lineage that grew from it built one of the most consequential pieces of codetry-shaped work in the prior literature without naming it as such: the metaphor *system metaphor* itself. XP's original twelve practices included *system metaphor* as a load-bearing element — the team agrees on a shared overarching metaphor for the system, and the metaphor disciplines naming throughout. The practice quietly fell out of fashion in the agile mainstream (it was the first XP practice most teams dropped), but the underlying claim — that a single chosen metaphor can constrain a system's structure across a whole codebase — is the bet codetry generalises into community institutions.

Go deeper → §DD.6

Brooks and *No Silver Bullet* (1986)

Fred Brooks' *No Silver Bullet — Essence and Accident in Software Engineering* drew the line codetry's whole verification standard rests on. Brooks distinguished between *essence* — the irreducible conceptual structure of the software — and *accident* — the parts that exist only because of the substrate. Codetry's claim that *the metaphor must be inspectable in the name itself* (§3.6) is a claim about *essence*: the name is not an accident of the substrate (a label, a string field, a UI affordance), it is part of the system's essential structure, and a discipline that does not protect it is leaving the load-bearing layer undefended. Brooks did not write about names. He drew the line that says names *can* belong to essence rather than accident, which is the line codetry walks across.

Go deeper → §DD.7

Nielsen, heuristic #2 — *match between system and the real world* (1994)

Jakob Nielsen's second usability heuristic: *the system should speak the users' language, with words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user*. The HCI tradition has carried this rule for thirty years and it is the most under-cited root of codetry. Nielsen's framing is descriptive (a usability principle, evaluated heuristically); codetry's contribution is to make it constructive (a design discipline whose load-bearing test is the rename of §3.2) and to extend it from interface copy into the *system structure* the names enact. Heuristic #2 is what made the move legible to UX practitioners; codetry says the same move has architectural consequences the UX framing did not yet claim.

Lakoff and Johnson — *Metaphors We Live By* (1980)

George Lakoff and Mark Johnson's *Metaphors We Live By* is the philosophical root underneath the entire discipline. Their claim — that conceptual metaphor is not decorative language but the substrate of human cognition, and that the metaphors a community lives by shape what that community can think — is the claim codetry treats as a working assumption. The reason renaming *Buckets* to *Categories* lets the UI quietly suggest balances can grow by clicking (§3.2) is the Lakoff/Johnson claim playing out at software scale: the metaphor was structuring thought, the new word structures different thought, and the system shifts to match. Codetry is what the Lakoff/Johnson observation looks like once it is treated as a constraint on building, not just a description of speaking.

GOV.UK content design and the Mailchimp voice tradition

The two clearest practical traditions in the prior literature for *holding a vocabulary across a system* are GOV.UK's content design discipline (Sarah Richards' *Content Design* and the GOV.UK style guide that followed) and the long line of voice-and-tone style guides that Mailchimp's open-sourced voice guide popularised. Both treat the words on the surface as load-bearing — a benefit form that uses the wrong noun for *household income* fails for users in ways that a redesigned visual layout cannot fix — and both build organisational discipline around protecting that vocabulary. Codetry's contribution is to extend the same protection one floor deeper, into the *names in the source code* that the surface words rest on, so the discipline is not lost the moment the work crosses from the content team to the engineering team.

Knuth and the Karlton line — *the two hard things*

Phil Karlton's line — *there are only two hard things in computer science: cache invalidation and naming things* — has been a folk axiom of the field for thirty years. The line is usually quoted as a joke. It is also a complete inheritance: the field has *known*, in its own folk wisdom, that naming is one of the two genuinely hard problems, and has built almost no discipline around it. Codetry is what it would look like to take the second half of Karlton's line as seriously as the field has taken the first half. (Knuth's literate programming, named above, is the largest existing piece of work in the field that did take it seriously — most of the rest of the lineage in this chapter sits between Karlton's joke and Knuth's discipline.)

What is genuinely new on top of those roots

The honest claim is small. Almost everything codetry asks a practitioner to do has been asked, in pieces, by one of the disciplines named above. What codetry adds is four specific moves the prior literature did not put together, named here so the reader can hold the discipline at its actual size:

- *A constructive rename test for individual nouns.* Nielsen's heuristic #2 evaluates the match between system and real-world language descriptively. DDD's bounded-context boundary tests vocabulary at the context level. Codetry's §3.2 rename test is the same family of move, sharpened to the individual noun and made constructive: hold the rest of the system constant, swap the word, read what shifts. The test is small enough to fit on a workbench page and falsifiable enough to settle a disagreement at the kitchen table.
- *The discipline applied outside enterprise software.* DDD's *domain experts* are usually a product manager and three subject-matter specialists in a corporate setting. Codetry's

domain experts are the people who live in the place — the fishing camp, the food co-op, the neighbourhood clinic — and the *ubiquitous language* is whatever they already say to each other before a software person enters the room. The discipline is the same; the room it is practised in is older and slower than the one DDD was written for.

- *Drift detection as a continuous practice, not a project phase.* Lakoff/Johnson observed that conceptual metaphor shifts under social pressure; codetry's §3.3 and §3.6 install that observation as a routine check — audit pages, build-time version checks, vocabulary sweeps run on a cadence. The closest prior practice is the GOV.UK / Mailchimp style-guide tradition; codetry extends the cadence into source code and version control so the metaphor and the system cannot disagree without something visibly breaking.
- *Verification by inspection of the name on the surface.* The XP system-metaphor practice, the literate-programming weave, and the Brooks essence/accident line each get to the edge of this claim without making it. Codetry makes it explicit: the verification standard is that a user reading the name on the button can predict what happens when they press it, because the metaphor the name carries is enacted by the system underneath. Verification lives in the place the user already looks. This is the move §3.6 names and the falsifier the rest of the practice is built around.

Codetry's claim is that those four moves, taken together as a single discipline rather than scattered across the prior literature, are worth a name. The roots above are worth more than the new layer. The honest framing is: a small load-bearing rearrangement on top of decades of work the field did not yet know to call by one name.

Falsifier for the lineage claim

The lineage above is falsifiable. If a discipline already in the prior literature can be shown to do all four moves named in *what is genuinely new* — the constructive rename test at the noun level, the application outside enterprise software, drift detection as a continuous practice, and verification by inspection of the surface name — codetry is not a new discipline; it is a renaming of that one. The practitioner who finds the prior discipline that does all four is owed the credit and this chapter owes them the rewrite. Until then, the four moves taken together is the smallest claim this handbook is willing to make on its own behalf.

4.3 · The reading lineage — fiction

The lineage chapter that just preceded this one named the *disciplines* codetry sits inside. This chapter names the *books* that trained the practitioner's own ear for the kind of pattern recognition codetry depends on. The two are separate inheritances. The disciplines name the moves; the books taught the listening that lets a practitioner notice when a move is needed in the field.

This chapter is not training data for an AI on a corpus. It is the reading list that trained one human mind to hear what codetry is for. The distinction matters because the framing keeps drifting in conversations about contemporary writing — it is now common to read a list of influences as if its purpose were to ground a model in a tradition. The purpose here is older and smaller: to be honest about which authors taught the practitioner to recognise *load-bearing story* when it is in front of them, and to give a future reader of this handbook a way to walk the same path on foot if they choose. There is no claim that reading these books produces the discipline. There is only the claim that, for this practitioner, the discipline was unreachable without them.

Why fiction first.

Codetry is a discipline about story being load-bearing — about names whose job is to carry the metaphor a community lives by, into the system that community runs on. The clearest place to learn what *load-bearing story* feels like is the place where story bears the most weight: a novel. Fiction is where a single chosen noun decides what is thinkable inside the world the reader enters; where renaming a thing renames the room around it; where a metaphor either holds the chapter together or quietly collapses it. Theory can describe those moves after the fact, and is useful when a practitioner needs to argue for the discipline at the policy table. But theory ossifies the diagnosis without teaching the ear. The practitioner who has only read theory can name *what kind of capture* a vocabulary is performing and cannot reliably notice the capture happening in the room they are standing in. The practitioner who has read the seven books named below has been trained, repeatedly and for a long time, in the muscle of *hearing the load-bearing word being swapped out before the swap is announced*. That muscle is what codetry asks for in the field. Fiction is where it is built.

The seven works below are grouped into three clusters. Each cluster teaches something the books in it teach together that no single one of them teaches alone.

The language-is-the-cage cluster — *1984*, *Animal Farm*, *Brave New World*.

These three are read here as one triangle. *1984* names the *fast capture* of a vocabulary — Newspeak as the deliberate, top-down compression of what can be said and therefore thought. *Animal Farm* names the *slow capture* — the painted commandments on the barn quietly rewritten in the night, where the drift is so gradual that no single reading catches it but the comparison across years is unanswerable. *Brave New World* names the *soft capture* — a vocabulary so comfortable that the cage is welcomed in and the question of whether one is inside it never arises. The triangle teaches that capture has at least three speeds and that a practitioner who is only watching for one will miss the other two; the rename test of §3.2 is sharp against fast capture, the drift detection of §3.3 is sharp against slow capture, and the protection of community vocabulary against generic professional English is the move sharpest against the third.

1984 — Orwell.

1984 is the foundational text. Newspeak is the clearest fictional rendering ever made of a system in which a community's available vocabulary is engineered top-down so that whole moves of thought become unsayable, and over time, unthinkable. Orwell's appendix on the principles of Newspeak — written in the past tense, as if the language has already passed away — is the single passage in twentieth-century fiction that comes closest to a working specification of the discipline codetry is built to *resist*. The Party's project is not to ban dissenting thoughts; it is to remove the words the dissent would have to be assembled from.

The diagnostic the book gave the practitioner is a method, not a mood. If Newspeak is the deliberate compression of a vocabulary so that load-bearing thought becomes impossible, then the rename test of §3.2 is the same operation run in reverse: hold the system constant, swap the noun, and read what becomes thinkable that was not thinkable a moment ago. The test surfaces the words a system is quietly relying on by removing them and watching what the system can no longer say. Orwell built the negative case at civilisational scale; codetry runs the positive version at the scale of a single button on a single screen, on the working assumption that a community whose buttons keep their words has not yet had its Newspeak written for it.

The rename test is Newspeak run in reverse: instead of removing a word so a thought becomes unsayable, remove it so the system tells us which thought it was quietly carrying.

Animal Farm — Orwell.

Animal Farm is the slow companion to *1984*. Where Newspeak compresses overnight, the painted commandments on the barn wall change a syllable at a time, between visits, while everyone is busy with the harvest. *All animals are equal* becomes *all animals are equal, but some animals are more equal than others* and no one in the barn quite remembers when. The book is a manual in the *cadence* of vocabulary drift: the words on the wall are not policed in the moment they shift; they are policed by the comparison between this season's reading and last season's, by the practitioner who keeps a record and notices the syllable that was added.

This is exactly the drift codetree §3.3 is built to hedge against, and the worked examples it gives are the *Animal Farm* shape: a benefit form's category label *household* quietly becoming *qualifying household*; a savings envelope quietly being called *reserve* in the next sprint; a *neighbour* quietly becoming a *resident* on the third revision of the document. None of these are Newspeak; all of them are the painted-commandment move. The audit page, the build-time vocabulary check, the version-controlled glossary — these are the practitioner's equivalent of standing in the barn at night with a lantern and reading the wall against a written copy held in the pocket. The book's quiet horror is the threat profile codetree's drift practices are calibrated to.

If the only check on the wall is the wall, the wall has been rewritten by morning. The discipline is the lantern and the copy in the pocket.

Brave New World — Huxley.

Brave New World is the third side of the triangle and the most quietly damaging of the three. Huxley's World State does not compress vocabulary by force or rewrite the wall at night; it makes the existing vocabulary *comfortable*, conditioned, soothing. *Soma, the feelies, community-identity-stability* — the words land easily, they sound forward-looking, they belong to a register that no one in the world wants to argue against because to argue against them would be to argue against feeling well. The capture is soft. The cage has cushions.

This is the strongest critique fiction has yet produced of the kind of *generic professional vocabulary* that has come to dominate the rooms codetree works in: *sustainability, engagement, impact, resilience, empowerment, innovation*. The words are not malevolent and they are not, in any single instance, deceptive. They are comfortable. They register as forward-looking. They flatten the specific, place-rooted noun the community already had into a generic that the funder, the regulator, and the consultant all recognise — and the cost of the flattening is invisible because nothing in the room sounds wrong. Huxley's

contribution to the practitioner's ear is the alarm that *nothing sounding wrong* is itself a diagnostic, often the most important one. The room that is too easy to talk in has usually had a vocabulary slipped under it.

When no word in the meeting room registers as wrong, the meeting room has been carpeted in a vocabulary the people in it did not write. Listen for the specific noun the carpeting replaced.

The method-must-survive-the-person cluster — *Lord of the Flies, Ishmael*.

These two are the books that taught the practitioner that a discipline's life is decided by whether it can be handed off, not by whether it can be performed. *Lord of the Flies* is the book of what handover failure looks like at close range; *Ishmael* is the book of what a discipline that has survived handover for thousands of generations looks like, and the closest single literary ancestor to the *Practitioner* role this handbook is named for. Together they teach that the question every codetory practitioner is eventually asked — *who carries this when you stop* — is the question that decides whether the discipline ever existed.

Lord of the Flies — Golding.

The conch on Ralph's beach is the cleanest worked example in twentieth-century fiction of a *load-bearing noun*. The shell is a physical object; it is also a rule; it is also a posture. Whoever holds it speaks. The boys who agree to the conch agree to one another; the boys who shatter the conch shatter the agreement. The book's whole argument turns on a single named object that the community has invested with the discipline of taking turns. When the conch shatters in the final chapters, the discipline does not slowly degrade — it is gone in the same instant. That is the *Saltbox Principle* of §1.3 played out in the worst case: a method whose load is held by a single fragile noun, and a method that goes when the noun goes.

The book is also, read at field strength, the cleanest possible illustration of why the *Practitioner* role of this handbook is defined the way it is. The Practitioner's job is *handover* — the deliberate practice of arranging the discipline so that no single person, no single shell, no single founder, holds the load alone. A Practitioner role that ends with the Practitioner is the conch on the rock. The whole architecture of §5 — the wisdom keepers, the inspector standing, the seven-generation horizon — is the corpus's answer to the Golding question: *what arrangement of names and people would mean that the conch is replaceable before it shatters?*

If the conch shatters, the method shatters with it; this is why the Practitioner's whole job is handover.

Ishmael — Quinn.

Ishmael is the cleanest single literary influence on codetry's posture. Quinn's *Leavers and Takers* framing — the long line of cultures that left the world running on its own terms versus the short, recent culture that takes the world apart and runs it on rewritten terms — is the lineage codetry's *Practitioner* role inherits from. The Leavers are not romanticised in the book; they are presented as people whose discipline is *to remember the older arrangement long enough to keep the option open* of returning to it. That is the posture codetry asks of the practitioner. The handbook's *Standby* primitive in the constellation manifest is, read honestly, a Leaver-shaped institution: the always-on shelf that keeps the older arrangement available against the day the newer one fails.

Quinn's *Mother Culture* — the voice that whispers the Taker premises into the room before any conscious thought is spoken — is the other contribution. What codetry calls *the systems* names the same thing one floor closer to the working surface: the outside world's dialect that arrives in the room without being invited and substitutes its nouns for the local ones unless the practitioner is listening. The *Gate* primitive in the constellation is the practitioner's working answer to Mother Culture in real time: a passage that lets the legacy-world vocabulary cross when it must, but logs the substitution so the original noun is never silently lost.

Quinn's Leavers are the lineage ancestor of the Practitioner role; Mother Culture is the older name for what codetry calls the systems, and the Gate is the practitioner's answer to it.

The perception-is-the-substrate cluster — *The Doors of Perception, Blueprints of the Afterlife.*

The third cluster is the one that keeps the discipline humble. The first two clusters establish that names hold load and that methods must outlive their carriers. This cluster establishes the prior condition the other two depend on — that *what a person can register as real is decided by the vocabulary already inside their head before they look* — and the matched humility that no naming discipline survives every kind of break. Together the two works teach: name carefully, *and* know what naming cannot save.

The Doors of Perception — Huxley.

Huxley's book-length essay on perception names the *reducing valve*: the thesis that ordinary consciousness is not a window onto the world but a narrow filter that admits only the slice of reality the organism needs to act. The valve is constructed largely out of language — the categories, names, and habits the mind has internalised over a lifetime decide which signals are admitted as *real* and which are dismissed as noise before any conscious processing happens. What the practitioner takes from this is not the chemistry of the essay but its model: *the names a community lives inside decide what the community can register as real*. Rename a thing and you have widened or narrowed the valve for everyone who passes through it. This is why the rename test of §3.2 has the consequences it has — because the noun on the button is also, at substrate level, deciding what the user is *able to see* about the system the button sits on.

Huxley is filed alongside *Brave New World* by the rest of his readership, and that filing is correct, but the *Doors* essay is the deeper of the two for codetry's purposes. *Brave New World* warned about the comfort of a captured vocabulary; *The Doors of Perception* explained the mechanism by which the capture happens — that vocabulary is not decorative on top of perception, it is upstream of it. The handbook treats the essay, not the novel, as the load-bearing Huxley contribution to the practitioner's ear, which is why both works are listed and the essay sits in this cluster rather than the first.

The names a community lives inside decide what that community can register as real; widen or narrow the valve, and you have widened or narrowed what is visible from inside the room.

Blueprints of the Afterlife — Boudinot.

Boudinot's novel sits at the end of the cluster as the humility check against everything the other six have just argued. The book is set after a civilisational discontinuity so total that the names from the world before survive only as half-remembered fragments inside characters who can no longer reliably tell their own memories from another's; one of its central characters is hired to clone the cathedrals of a ruined coast, full-scale, knowing the cathedrals' meanings have not survived to be cloned along with them. The book is unsentimental about the limits of what naming can preserve when the substrate the names lived in is gone. A discipline that has been told over and over that names hold load needs, at intervals, to read a book that takes the same claim and asks honestly *what kind of break the names cannot carry across*, and to sit with the answer.

The contribution to the practitioner's ear is calibrating. Codetry is a discipline for the long, slow, *continuous* horizon — the horizon in which the conch can be passed and the wall can be re-read. It is not a discipline that promises to save anything across a discontinuity. The seven-generation framing of §5 is itself a humility: it is the longest horizon the practice claims competence over, not the longest horizon the world will run on. *Blueprints* is the book the practitioner reads when the temptation arrives to claim the discipline is more than that.

Name carefully for the continuous horizon; do not pretend a name will carry across a break the substrate did not survive.

Why nonfiction is a separate chapter.

The nonfiction reading lineage is drafted as its own chapter at §4.4. The separation is deliberate, not editorial. Fiction trained the *ear* — the muscle for hearing load-bearing language as it is being spoken; nonfiction sharpened the *vocabulary* — the precision that lets the practitioner name the move once it has been heard. Conflating the two would flatten both contributions: it would let the nonfiction works look like they had taught a listening they did not teach, and it would let the fiction works look like reference material rather than the long, slow training the chapter above is honest about. The companion chapter is owed to the reader and §4.4 pays that debt with the same care.

Falsifier for the reading-lineage claim.

The chapter above makes a strong claim: that the seven works listed taught the practitioner to *hear* what codetry depends on, and that the practitioner who has not read them — but has read theory and practice notes — would not reliably hear the same thing. The claim is falsifiable. *If a reader who has never read any of these books, asked to walk the rename test of §3.2 across a real constellation of named systems, produces verdicts indistinguishable from the verdicts of a reader who has read all seven, the chapter's claim fails.* The claim survives only as long as the trained ear is detectably better than the untrained one in the field. The practitioner who finds the counter-example is owed the credit and this chapter owes them the rewrite. Until then, the seven works above are the smallest reading list this handbook is willing to claim trained the discipline.

4.4 · The reading lineage — nonfiction

The chapter that just preceded this one named the books that trained the practitioner's ear for load-bearing language. This chapter names the books that sharpened the practitioner's vocabulary once that ear was already listening. The two are not redundant. The fiction works above taught the muscle of *hearing the swap* as it is being made; the nonfiction works below taught the precision of *naming the move once it has been heard*. A practitioner with the ear and no vocabulary registers that something is wrong in the room and cannot say what; a practitioner with the vocabulary and no ear can name a move that was never made. The discipline asks for both, and the two reading lineages are kept separate so neither flattens the contribution of the other.

This chapter, like the one above, is not training data for an AI on a corpus. It is the reading list that gave one human practitioner the precise nouns for the moves the fiction works had taught the ear to notice. The framing keeps drifting in conversations about contemporary nonfiction — an *influences* list is now read as if its purpose were to show which traditions the practitioner had been trained to perform. The purpose here is older and more specific. These works are named because they are the rocks the practitioner could not skip in the stream — small, flat, locally precise volumes that lodged on the shelf because each one supplied a noun the practice could not have functioned without. There is no claim that reading them produces the discipline. There is only the claim that, for this practitioner, the precise vocabulary of the discipline was unreachable without them.

Why nonfiction next.

Fiction is where load-bearing language is most easily *heard*; nonfiction is where load-bearing language is most patiently *named*. The practical-skills literature in particular — the field guides, the lifespan textbooks, the trust treatises, the habit manuals, the recreation-programming texts, the working herbals — is the literature that has done the unglamorous work of putting the right noun on the right move and defending it against drift, decade after decade. It is the corpus codetry's vocabulary inherits from. Where the fiction lineage trained the practitioner to flinch at the word that does not belong, the nonfiction lineage supplied the words that do. The two together are what makes the rename test of §3.2 possible at all: the ear catches the substitution; the vocabulary names what was substituted out. A practitioner with only one half of this inheritance cannot run the test to completion.

The shelf below is grouped into three clusters. Each cluster names a kind of vocabulary the practice depends on: the discipline of the self, the substrate of the community, and the grounding of the land and the body. The grouping is the practitioner's, not the literature's — these are the rocks that lodged in the order they lodged, and the clusters describe what the

rocks turned out to be doing once the shelf was full. Through-line: each entry below was an *early or ongoing reading* that supplied the protective instinct and the threat vocabulary the practitioner was eventually going to need to defend the noun on a button — and without which codetry would not have been possible to write down.

The self-is-the-first-protocol cluster — *Atomic Habits*, *The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People*, *How to Win Friends and Influence People*.

These three sit together as the practitioner-development triangle. *Atomic Habits* names the *compound layer* — the small repeated act that decides what kind of system the practitioner becomes over years. *The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People* names the *principle layer* — the constant the practitioner aligns the day to before the day's first decision is made. *How to Win Friends and Influence People* names the *relational layer* — the discipline of bringing other people into shared work without manipulation, leverage, or the friendlier varieties of control. The triangle teaches that the practitioner is the first system the discipline has to operate on, and that a discipline whose practitioner has not done this work has nowhere to stand. The constellation manifest's *Practitioner* role is the institution-level version of what these three books work out at the personal level: a role whose habits, principles, and relations are themselves the load-bearing infrastructure the discipline runs on.

Atomic Habits — Clear.

Clear's central claim is that systems beat goals — that the small repeated act, run thousands of times, builds the person; the dramatic resolution at the start of the year does not. The book gives the practitioner the vocabulary to name *the compound* — the slow, daily layering that decides what kind of practitioner is in the room a decade from now, not what kind of practitioner intends to be there. The cure-time argument of §3.3 (that a renamed system takes weeks of conversation to settle into the team's mouths) is the same shape one floor up: codetry is itself an atomic-habits discipline, applied to a community's nouns rather than to a person's daily practice, and it is run in the compound register or it does not run.

What the book gave the practitioner that nothing else had was the *unflattering precision* of the time horizon. The dystopia codetry resists is rarely built by a single deliberate act of vocabulary capture; more often it is built by the unwatched accumulation of small misalignments the practitioner did not name early enough — a generic *user* swapped in for *neighbour* on one screen, then on a second, then on the form, until the system the community runs is not a system the community recognises. *Atomic Habits* taught the practitioner to read the small misalignment as if it were the dystopia in compound form, because in the time horizons codetry cares about, it is.

Habits are sovereign code: the small repeated act either authors the practitioner or the legacy-world authors them in its place.

The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People — Covey.

Covey's contribution is the *principle-centred* frame — the move of locating the practitioner's reliable ground inside the practitioner rather than inside the platform, the role, the funder, or the latest method. The book's central language — *be proactive, begin with the end in mind, put first things first, think win-win* — supplies the vocabulary for a posture that does not depend on conditions outside the practitioner's control to remain stable. That posture is the one the constellation's *Practitioner* role inherits and the one §5.3's wisdom-keeper standing presupposes: a person whose principles are upstream of the platform, not downstream of it.

The book also names, in plain language, the failure mode codetry's discourse most often falls into when its principles are not yet settled. *Reactive dependence* — Covey's term — is the disposition that lets the loudest dialect in the room set the practitioner's vocabulary by default. The practitioner who has not done the principle-centred work will arrive at the policy table speaking the funder's *engagement*, the regulator's *compliance*, the consultant's *innovation*, because nothing inside the practitioner is holding a different word steady against the room's gravitational pull. Covey is the book that supplied the vocabulary for what that failure is, before the rename test of §3.2 supplied the operation that catches it.

Principles are upstream of platforms; the practitioner whose principles drift with the platform has no name to hold a button to.

How to Win Friends and Influence People — Carnegie.

Carnegie's book is the oldest in this cluster and is the one most often misread. The title sounds like a manual for manipulation; the contents are nearly the opposite — a long, patient training in the discipline of being genuinely interested in the other person, of remembering the name, of listening for the thing the other person is actually trying to say rather than for the cue to begin one's own next sentence. What Carnegie taught the practitioner to name is *influence without coercion*: the move of bringing another person into shared work through earned attention rather than through pressure, leverage, or any of the friendlier varieties of control.

The book matters to codetry because the discipline's most demanding rooms are not technical rooms; they are rooms where the practitioner is asking a community to keep its own noun on a button instead of accepting the funder's or the platform's substitution. The room responds to the practitioner the way it responds to any person asking it to do

something it is not yet sure it wants to do, and the question the practitioner has to be ready to answer is whether they are present in the room as someone the room has reason to trust, or as someone running a method on the room. Carnegie supplied the vocabulary for the difference. The practitioner who has not done this work will sound, however gently, like a method; the practitioner who has will sound like a person, and the room will give them the noun.

Influence without coercion is the only kind of influence the discipline is allowed to use; anything else is the substitution it claims to refuse.

The community-is-the-substrate cluster — *Health Promotion Strategies Through the Lifespan, Teach Your Children Well, The 10 Laws of Trust, Recreation Programming: Designing Leisure Experiences.*

These four are the books that taught the practitioner that the substrate the discipline runs on is not the codebase, the platform, or the institution; it is the community of actual people across actual generations whose lives the system touches. *Health Promotion Strategies Through the Lifespan* names the longest of those time horizons — the human life as the design constraint the practice answers to. *Teach Your Children Well* names the handover horizon — what the next generation inherits from the system the current one builds. *The 10 Laws of Trust* names the present-tense substrate — the trust between people in real time, without which no protocol survives the first hard decision. *Recreation Programming: Designing Leisure Experiences* names the substrate's working conditions — the deliberate craft of designing the in-person experience the trust is built and rebuilt inside. The cluster teaches together that codetory's load is held by a community, that the community is multi-generational, and that the discipline's job is to keep the substrate readable to the people standing on it.

Health Promotion Strategies Through the Lifespan — Murray & Zentner.

Murray and Zentner's textbook does what no shorter framing of public health does: it walks the reader through the entire arc of a human life — infancy, childhood, adolescence, young adulthood, middle adulthood, late adulthood, the dying — and names the developmental tasks, the threats, and the community supports that belong to each stage. What the book gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *lifespan as a design constraint*. A system designed for one stage of life — the system whose default user is a working-age adult on a smartphone, for instance — has quietly excluded six other stages and has called the exclusion *targeting*. The textbook supplies the noun for the missing stages so the system's quietness about them becomes audible.

The book also names the cumulative shape of *disconnection* — from body, from seasons, from community — as a public-health threat in itself, not as a side effect of other threats. That framing is the one codetory's protection of community vocabulary inherits from. The funder-friendly noun (*engagement*) is comfortable in part because the more honest noun (*reconnection*) names a longer arc and a deeper deficit; the textbook's vocabulary is the longer arc made unmissable. The constellation manifest's insistence on *Standby* and *Gate* primitives — institutions that hold the older arrangement available across the lifespan of the people using them — is the textbook's claim restated at the architecture level.

Lifespan is the ultimate design constraint; the system that defaults to one stage has silently exiled the other six.

Teach Your Children Well — Levine.

Levine's book is the shortest and clearest case in the practical-parenting literature for the proposition that the next generation inherits the *system* it grew up inside, not the *intentions* the current generation had for it. The argument against over-protection and performance culture is, at root, an argument for letting children develop the competence, struggle-tolerance, and real-world skill that an antifragile adult needs — and the argument is made in the precise vocabulary of *what is being taken from the child by the well-meant substitution*. The substitution itself is well-meant; the child loses the noun the substitution replaced.

This is the §1.0 hedge stated at the family scale: a generation can lose a vocabulary of competence by having it kindly replaced with the appearance of competence over the course of a single childhood, and the loss does not announce itself because nothing in the child's environment sounds wrong. The handbook's commitment to handover — to a Practitioner role whose whole job is to leave the discipline behind it for the next person to use — is the same commitment Levine names at the developmental scale. The discipline that does not raise its successors antifragile has not handed the discipline over; it has handed over the appearance of it.

Raising antifragile humans is the generational-scale rename test: the kind substitution that takes the noun the child needed.

The 10 Laws of Trust — Peterson.

Peterson's book names the architecture trust actually has — that high-trust environments are not the result of personality or culture in the loose sense; they are the result of specific, repeated, demonstrable behaviours arranged into a small number of *laws* the participants have internalised. What the book gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *trust as a protocol* — a thing with a structure, a thing that can be specified, audited, and rebuilt, not a

thing that has to be hoped for. That framing is the one codetry's insistence on *readable, ownable, forkable* tools depends on: the readability is what makes the trust verifiable; the ownership is what gives the community the authority to demand the verification; the forkability is the always-available exit that makes the trust voluntary rather than captive.

The book also names the failure mode the rest of the trust literature is too polite about. Low-trust systems do not stay low-trust; they convert the missing trust into *control*. The control then has to be paid for — in surveillance, in compliance overhead, in the friction of every transaction that a high-trust environment would have settled in a sentence. Codetry's whole bet against the technocratic capture §5.1 and §5.2 keep open is the bet that a community whose nouns it can read is a community whose protocol is a trust protocol rather than a control protocol; Peterson is the book that supplied the vocabulary for what is at stake in losing that distinction.

Trust is a protocol, not a feeling; when the protocol fails, control fills the space, and the community pays for the control with everything it had in surplus.

Recreation Programming: Designing Leisure Experiences — Rossman & Schlatter.

Rossman and Schlatter's textbook is, on the surface, a practical guide for community recreation professionals on how to design and run leisure experiences — youth nights, festivals, drop-ins, programs. What the book gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *deliberate group flow* — the recognition that the in-person, embodied, shared experience is itself a designed thing, with components and stages and craft, and that the trust and culture a community runs on are built and rebuilt inside those experiences far more than inside any of its formal institutions. The textbook supplies the nouns for the components — interaction, experience, animation, debrief — so the practice of designing them stops being inherited as instinct and starts being inherited as discipline.

The book is in this cluster because it names the *working conditions* the trust of the previous entry is built under. *The 10 Laws of Trust* explains why a high-trust community runs on a protocol; *Recreation Programming* explains where the protocol gets practised. In an environment where most of the public's communal life has been displaced onto isolated screens, the textbook's claim — that the in-person group experience is a designable, defensible, non-substitutable cultural good — is a load-bearing one. Codetry's commitment to leave room for the campfire, not just the cursor — to refuse to design any system that quietly displaces the community's in-person practice — inherits from this book the vocabulary for what is being displaced.

Leisure is the cultural immune response; a community that has lost the discipline of its own in-person experience has lost the room the trust protocol gets practised in.

The land-and-the-body-are-the-base cluster — *Ancient Remedies Revived, Laws of Life*, the works of Thomas J. Elpel, the practical field guides.

These four entries are the base layer of the shelf and the base layer of the practice. *Ancient Remedies Revived* names the body's inheritance — the plant, animal, and seasonal knowledge that older communities held as a working literacy and that industrial systems quietly relocated into specialist domains. *Laws of Life* names the refusal — the practitioner's stance of declining the legacy-world's offered dependencies and rebuilding the working capability outside them. *Botany in a Day* and the rest of the Elpel corpus name the *pattern recognition* — the discipline of reading the land as a system whose own grammar repeats across scales, the way codetry asks the practitioner to read named software. The practical field guides — foraging, fishing, crafts, cooking, gardening, community development — name the *embodied competence* the rest of the cluster defends. Together the four teach that codetry's discipline does not float above the substrate it claims to serve. It begins where the practitioner's hands and the place they stand in begin, or it begins nowhere.

Ancient Remedies Revived — Greef & Willow.

Greef and Willow's book is in the lineage of the working herbal — a record of plant remedies, food medicines, and seasonal practices that older communities held as ordinary household literacy and that industrial medicine quietly relocated into the consultancy of pharmacists, physicians, and packaged-product manufacturers. What the book gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *the body's literacy* — the recognition that the knowledge of one's plants, one's seasons, and one's household remedies is a *language*, not a hobby, and that its loss is a vocabulary loss in the technical sense the rest of the handbook uses that phrase.

This is §1.0's drift hazard stated at the bodily scale. A community that no longer knows the names of its medicines has not chosen to forget; it has had the names slipped under it by the same generic-professional vocabulary that does the work in every other domain — *wellness, self-care, natural products*. The book's contribution to the practitioner's vocabulary is the older noun. The constellation manifest's insistence that the community's working language survive the platform that runs on top of it is the same insistence Greef and Willow make at the kitchen scale: the named remedy is what the household runs on, and the household that has lost it has lost the protocol the lifespan textbook above is calibrated to.

Remedies are resistance: the body's vocabulary is the first vocabulary the legacy-world replaces, and the last one the discipline gets back.

Laws of Life: Ditch the System, Design Your Life — Spirko.

Spirko's book is the most practical and the least patient of the cluster, and that is its contribution. The book is straight talk — no fluff, no theoretical apparatus — on building real, working capability outside the systems most people are expected to depend on: food, energy, money, communication, learning, security. What it gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *the refusal* — the disposition of declining the legacy-world's offered dependencies not as a posture or an ideology but as a working practice with concrete steps, materials, and skills that have to be built before they are needed.

The book matters to codetry's pioneer-toned register because it names the difference between *opting out* (a stance the practitioner takes that requires nothing further from them) and *building out* (a long, embodied practice that requires the practitioner to acquire the skills the dependency was hiding). The discipline asks for the second, not the first. The constellation's *Standby* primitive — the always-on shelf that keeps the older arrangement available — is the institution-level version of Spirko's claim at the household level: the alternative arrangement only exists if it has been built and is in working order before the moment the dependency fails.

Ditch the system, design the life — the refusal is a practice with materials, not a posture with vocabulary.

Botany in a Day, Participating in Nature, and related works — Elpel.

Elpel's corpus is the closest single body of work in the practical literature to what codetry asks of a practitioner. *Botany in a Day* teaches plant identification not by memorising species but by reading *families* — by learning the small number of structural patterns that, once recognised, let the practitioner read a plant they have never seen before and know what kind of thing it is. *Participating in Nature* extends the same posture to the whole landscape: the river, the hillside, the meadow are read as a system whose grammar is repeating at multiple scales, and the practitioner's job is to learn the grammar so the next encounter with an unfamiliar instance is an act of recognition rather than an act of looking-up.

This is the deepest single contribution of the cluster to codetry. The discipline asks the practitioner to read a system's nouns the way Elpel asks the reader to read a meadow: not as a list of items but as a small number of structural patterns whose recognition lets an unfamiliar instance be read on first sight. The rename test of §3.2 is the same operation in

software. The pattern-recognition discipline §5.1 names — the practitioner who can tell load-bearing from decorative — is the same practitioner Elpel has been training in the meadow. The book's quiet claim, that nature is itself the first literate text and that learning to read it is a transferable literacy, is the claim codetry is making about software at one floor up.

Nature is the first literate programming; the practitioner who can read a meadow's grammar can read a system's, and the discipline depends on the transfer.

The practical field guides — foraging, fishing, crafts, cooking, gardening, community development.

This entry is categorical, not titular. It names the layer of the shelf the practitioner could not stop adding to: the small, locally precise volume on how to clean a fish, how to identify the edible shelf-fungus, how to lay a stone wall, how to make the bread, how to start the seedling, how to run the community kitchen. The works are individually unglamorous and collectively load-bearing. What they gave the practitioner was the vocabulary for *embodied competence* — the recognition that the person who can do the thing with their hands is not the same person as the one who has read about the thing, and that no quantity of the second turns into the first.

This is the cluster's argument made literal. Codetry's pioneer-toned register is the register of a practice whose practitioner is expected to be able to *make things*, not only to think about making them. The constellation manifest's whole bet — that a community runs on the names it can author — is impossible to keep without practitioners who themselves know the difference between the named act and the performed one, and the field guides are the literature that taught the practitioner that difference. A discipline whose practitioners have not done embodied work tends to drift, slowly and politely, toward systems that talk competently about a world none of their authors are still in. The shelf of practical guides is the standing refusal of that drift.

Skill is the root of sovereignty; the discipline whose practitioners cannot make things by hand will, in time, design systems for a world none of them still inhabit.

Falsifier for the reading-lineage claim.

The chapter above makes a strong claim: that the eleven entries on this shelf taught the practitioner the precise vocabulary the rename test of §3.2 needs in the field, and that the practitioner who has read the seven fiction works of §4.3 but none of the practical-skills,

lifespan, trust, recreation, herbal, refusal, or Elpel-style pattern-reading work above would catch the *substitution* but would not reliably *name* what was substituted out. The claim is falsifiable. *If a reader who has built the ear from the fiction lineage but has done none of the nonfiction shelf above is shown to produce diagnoses indistinguishable in precision from a reader who has done all of it, the chapter's claim fails.* The claim survives only as long as the trained vocabulary is detectably more precise than the untrained one in the field. The practitioner who finds the counter-example is owed the credit and this chapter owes them the rewrite. Until then, the shelf above is the smallest nonfiction reading list this handbook is willing to claim sharpened the discipline.

Part I · The Discipline

The discipline itself — what it is, where it lives, and why the words you choose carry structural weight. The Grounding section laid the roots; this part names the moves.

1.0 · Why codetry exists

Codetry is the discipline of turning problems into coordinated action through precise shared language and repeatable small moves. It is built for households and communities that must allocate their own water, time, fuel, attention, and capital when larger systems cannot or will not.

Before the mechanics — the naming, the drift detection, the saltbox principle, the naming session — it is worth saying plainly what this discipline is hedging against, and what it is not claiming to do.

The hedge.

Codetry is a hedge. It hedges against the slow ways a community's own words get taken from it inside the systems built in its name. Knowledge creeps: a word a person used in a kitchen ends up, three meetings later, as a different word in a deck. Language drifts: *the books* becomes *the ledger* becomes *the financial management module*, and the original noun is no longer in the room. Technocracy runs the same erosion through AI: LLMs tokenize a

load-bearing noun, shearing it into sub-word fragments and reassembling it as something more generic, more poolable, more average — legible to the model, emptied of the community's meaning. Consultants and SaaS vendors translate: the community's vocabulary is rewritten into the vendor's data model on the way to a contract, and the contract is what survives.

None of these moves announces itself as a loss. Each one feels like cleanup, like progress, like professionalism. The discipline exists because the loss is real anyway, and because by the time it is visible at the surface — in a screen, a report, a policy — the substrate it was built on has already shifted.

Practice is not governance.

Codetry serves *practice*. Practice is what people already do — the relational, kinship-anchored, often invisible work of keeping a household, a homeschool, a co-op, a season, a territory. Practice doesn't need permission to exist; it is already there before the software arrives.

Governance is something else. This holds whether you are running a homestead, a food co-op, or a community on treaty territory — the practitioner's job is the same. Governance is formal authority — Chief and Council, hereditary leadership, treaty relationships, band council resolutions, election cycles, the legal and political channels through which a community speaks for itself. Governance has its own carriers, its own language, its own time.

Codetry does not produce governance. It does not design it, replace it, route around it, or stand in for it. On a reserve in particular, conflating the two is a political mistake the practitioner must not make. The discipline protects the substrate any genuine local governance has to be built out of: if the community's words survive, the community can govern itself in its own terms; if the words drift, governance ends up being conducted in someone else's language, which is the same thing as someone else governing.

What the practitioner is, and is not.

The practitioner is a steward of practice. Not a designer of governance. Not a consultant arriving with a framework. Not an author writing the community's story back to it.

The work is small and specific. The practitioner listens for the noun the community already uses. They refuse to translate it into something cleaner. They verify, when in doubt, against the human who handed them the word — not against the literature, not against the model, not against their own better idea. The discipline is built so that this is enough.

When a hard conversation arrives — when the room names a move that the practitioner knows has a structural name — the structural reference is The Logic. It is a named catalog of the moves that erode a community's language and ownership, built for practitioners who need to say precisely what is happening without having to invent the vocabulary on the spot.

Tool: The Logic — A structural reference for practitioners in hard conversations — the named moves, the fallacies, the patterns that erode community language and ownership.

The thesis, in one sentence.

Codetry is a verification discipline that keeps the structural language of a system rooted in the community that owns it, so that knowledge cannot creep, drift, or be tokenized away. It does not produce decentralized governance. It protects the substrate any genuine local governance has to be built out of: if the community's words survive, the community can govern itself in its own terms; if the words drift, governance ends up being conducted in someone else's language, which is the same thing as someone else governing.

1.1 · What codetry is

Codetry is the practice of building software whose primary load-bearing material is metaphor. The naming is not decoration on a database. The naming *is* the architecture, and the code is the medium that makes the metaphor real, clickable, and runnable.

It is a quiet discipline. Most of it is naming. Most of the rest is refusing to translate the names the community handed you into the words the industry would have preferred. The little that is left is the work of building the system honestly enough that the names keep their promises.

Tool: Practice Cards — The rename test and load-bearing cards are in the stack. Test whether the discipline has landed — or only landed adjacent.

1.2 · The saltbox principle

A codetry app is named the way a saltbox house is built — every beam carries weight.

Saltbox Zone 0 surfaces day-to-day as a homeschool companion, but the name is the design spec: it carries that the household is Zone 0, that this is the saltbox-house itself, and that everything else in the system flows from this center. Change the name and you have changed the structure.

Codetry borrows from the cold-climate vernacular. A saltbox house wasn't designed for prettiness — its asymmetric roof and thick north wall were the only way a house survived a boreal winter. The form *is* the function. Codetry asks the same of software: let the form-language do the structural work. Let the name carry weight a column would otherwise carry.

Let the name carry weight a column would otherwise carry.

Tool: Author's Desk — Zone 0 — Zone 0 begins here. Before the chapter closes — write the three things that already live in your Saltbox, in your own words.

1.3 · The both-states principle — names that hold one system across two states

Some systems run in one register and only need a name that fits that register. A *bucket* holds money in an envelope-budget app and never has to do anything else; the noun does one job and does it cleanly.

Other systems are one piece of infrastructure that moves between two operational states — resting and activated, quiet and live, the gas line closed and the gas line open. The infrastructure does not change; the state does. The temptation, every time, is to name each state separately and let them grow into two systems. The both-states principle is the codetry move that resists that.

When a system is one piece of infrastructure that moves between a resting state and an activated state, the umbrella name has to name the infrastructure — not the state it is currently in. A name that names the state will force a fork the moment the other state arrives.

The Standby as the worked example.

The Standby (worked out in §2.8) is the cleanest worked example so far. The Standby names both the always-on shelf (preparation, *standby stock*, *the watch* as a posture) and the active event (a *call*, the *active* rung on the ladder, the *debrief* once it stands down). One word, two states — resting and activated. The people, the stock, the vocabulary are all one — only the cadence changes.

Two early candidate names were rejected for failing the test. *The Common Pantry* held the resting state beautifully — a pantry is by definition always-on — but could not hold an active fire call without straining. *The Watch* held the activated posture but could not hold the resting shelf of stock without bending into a permanent vigil. Both survived as *sub-shelves* inside The Standby; neither could be the umbrella name. If either had been adopted as the umbrella, the constellation would now have two systems — one for *the pantry* and one for *the call* — with two cultures, two cadences, and two vocabularies for the same underlying thing.

How to spot a both-states name.

Pick the resting state first and ask whether the noun also holds in the activated state, then pick the activated state and ask whether the noun also holds in the resting state. If the answer to either question is *not really*, the name is doing one job and the system has already started forking. If the answer to both is *yes* — *same word, different rung*, the name is holding both states and the system is one system.

The principle is registered in the constellation manifest as `principles.both-states` and is cited every time a new primitive is asked to hold two operational states at once. The companion principle — for systems that face two contexts simultaneously rather than moving between two states — is taken up next.

1.4 · The both-sides principle — names that hold each context's dialect

The both-states principle holds when a system moves between two operational states over time. A different class of problem does not move at all — it faces two rooms simultaneously, always, from the moment it is named. Two audiences hold two different vocabularies as legitimate, neither willing to give up theirs to the other, and both look at the same membrane at the same time. The temptation is to name each side separately and let them grow into two pipes facing two rooms. The both-sides principle is the codetory move that resists that.

When a system has language that has to live in two contexts that hold different vocabularies as legitimate, the umbrella name has to fit both contexts in one word, or the system will pick a dialect and lose the other room.

The Gate as the worked example.

The constellation's second non-zone primitive — *The Gate* (worked out in §2.9) — is the cleanest worked example of this principle so far. The Gate names both the *bright side* (the constellation's own dialect — *neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock, the watch*) and *the systems* (the outside world's dialect — *resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves, compliance officer*) inside one umbrella that does not pick a side. One word, two contexts.

Two early candidate names were rejected for failing the principle. *Translator* held the directional work but flattened the membrane into pure transaction — a translator processes; a gate decides whether to. *Glossary* held the dictionary side beautifully — a glossary is by definition a registered correspondence — but could not hold the active posture of substituting in real documents, the ledger of past substitutions, or the *refused* rung for source-side language with no honest target-side equivalent. Both survived as *sub-shelves* inside The Gate (Mappings, Substitutions); neither could be the umbrella name. If either had been adopted as the umbrella, the constellation would now have a one-way pipe and a shelf of words — with no posture deciding whether language *should* cross at all, and no record kept that both names exist for the same thing.

Every bar passes its own test.

The both-sides test does not stop at the umbrella name. Every function — every bar — added to the Gate after the frame has been named must pass the same test independently. The Gate is a gate because each bar faces both rooms. A bar that only faces one room is not a bar; it is a wall panel, and a Gate built of wall panels is a wall. The principle runs on the frame and then repeats, bar by bar, as the primitive grows.

Refused — the sub-shelf for source-side language that has no honest equivalent on the other side — is the sharpest bar-level worked example. From the bright side: *Refused* records that a word in the constellation's dialect cannot be translated without distorting it, and so will not be. From the systems side: *Refused* records that a word in the outside world's dialect has been examined and found to have no honest landing point in the constellation's

vocabulary. The finding is the same finding read from two directions. Both rooms are served by knowing the Gate will not invent false equivalents. Refused passes the both-sides test and earns its place as a bar.

How the both-states test and the both-sides test differ.

Both tests are pick-one-then-the-other, but the axis is different. The both-states test picks a *state*: pick the resting state first and ask whether the noun also holds in the activated state, then pick the activated state and ask whether the noun also holds in the resting state. The both-sides test picks a *context*: pick the bright side and ask whether the umbrella name still respects the systems, then pick the systems side and ask whether the umbrella name still respects the bright side. In both tests, if the answer to either question is *not really*, the system has already started forking — into two cultures (both-states) or into two pipes (both-sides). If the answer to both is *yes* — *same word, different rung* (both-states) or *yes* — *same word, different room* (both-sides), the name is holding and the system is one system.

The Standby's two *states* are temporal — the system moves between them, and the name has to hold in either. The Gate's two *sides* are contextual — both face the system at once, and the name has to hold from either direction. A future primitive may need a third axis (densities? scales? jurisdictions?); the constellation manifest's `principles` array is open-ended on purpose — the discipline travels, the worked examples accumulate.

The principle is registered in the constellation manifest as `principles.both-sides` and is cited every time a new primitive is asked to hold two contexts at once.

1.5 · What kind of thing codetry is (Hempcrete)

The metaphor that runs through the whole discipline is architectural. *Load-bearing, foundation, the wall, the room, the surface* — every one of those words enters the handbook borrowed from a building. This chapter is the one place the borrowing gets explicit and the practitioner names the *kind* of building they have in mind: not the steel-and-glass office tower, not the suburban stick-frame house, but a hempcrete wall — a composite of a structural frame with an insulating, breathable infill. Codetry is a hempcrete discipline.

What hempcrete actually is, briefly.

Hempcrete is a composite building material made from the woody core of the hemp plant (*hurd* or *shiv*) bound with a lime-based binder. It is not a structural material on its own. It is laid as an infill around a load-bearing frame — typically timber — and once cured, it provides insulation, hygrothermal regulation (it breathes water vapour rather than trapping

it), fire resistance, and a wall that quietly continues to absorb carbon over its working life. The material is older than concrete by centuries in some regional traditions and newer than concrete by a century in its modern revival; it sits in the interesting place where the deepest possible historical roots and the most current decarbonisation conversation meet.

Why the metaphor fits codetry, three ways.

A composite, not a monolith. Hempcrete is two things doing two jobs: the timber frame holds the load; the hemp-and-lime infill holds the climate. Neither alone is the wall. Codetry is the same shape: the *names* hold the metaphor; the *system* holds the mechanics; neither alone is the discipline. §5.1's type/name/token stack is a hempcrete diagram — three layers, three jobs, one wall. The frequent error in software discourse is to argue about which single material is *the* right material (the type system as the only truth, the documentation as the only truth, the test suite as the only truth); the codetry move, like the hempcrete move, is to refuse the choice and put the materials in the relationship that makes the wall work.

Infill, not facade. Hempcrete sits *inside* the wall — between the structural studs of the frame, breathing in both directions, doing its work in the body of the building. It is not a cladding bolted on the outside for appearance. The codetry name is the same: it is not a label sprayed on the outside of a system that was designed without it. It is the load-distributing infill that lives between the structural type and the surface affordance, and the system only works the way the room expects it to because the infill is doing its job *inside* the wall. Strip the infill and the frame still stands — but the wall stops regulating, the room stops being habitable in the same way, and the mechanics that were quietly held by the composite now have to be shouted by signage and policy.

Ethical-aesthetic, not just technical. Hempcrete is chosen, where it is chosen, for a bundle of reasons that no one of which is sufficient: it works thermally, it sequesters carbon, it is locally grown, it is non-toxic, it ages honestly, it is beautiful in a way that pre-cast concrete is not. The choice is technical and ethical and aesthetic at the same time, and the practitioner who tries to defend it on any one of those grounds alone will sound like they are leaving the other reasons out. Codetry has the same compound character. The rename test of §3.2 is technical (it catches drift the type system misses); the protection of community vocabulary is ethical (the people who live in the place are the ones whose words the system runs on); the insistence that the name on the button keep its promise is aesthetic (the wall is honest about what it is). The discipline does not survive being reduced to any one of those grounds. The hempcrete metaphor is the shortest sentence the handbook has for that.

Where the strain on the metaphor is honest.

Hempcrete is not perfect. It needs a frame to hold any real load; it cures slowly; the modern revival is small relative to the cement industry it would have to displace; the lime binder is less ecologically clean than the hemp suggests; in some climates the hygrothermal advantages diminish. Codetry has analogous strains: it needs an existing system to hold any real load (the discipline is not a build pattern, it is a discipline applied to a build); the practice cures slowly (a renamed system takes weeks of conversation to settle into the team's mouths, §3.3); the discipline is small relative to the architectural and product-management traditions it would have to displace; the rename test depends on a practitioner who can tell load-bearing from decorative, and that practitioner's judgment is itself a binder whose composition matters. The metaphor is not flattering by accident. The hempcrete wall is the kind of wall the practitioner is trying to build *because* it is honest about what it can and cannot carry.

The one-sentence claim.

Codetry is hempcrete: a composite discipline whose names are the breathing infill laid between the structural frame of type and the surface skin of affordance, doing the climate-regulating, carbon-sequestering, ethical-aesthetic work that no single layer in the system was holding before.

Coda — the bamboo field.

There is a second material the practice keeps reaching for, alongside hempcrete, that the handbook has been politely vague about until now. It is *bamboo* — specifically, the bamboo field of the xBuckets XRP-spring artwork, where six growth stages of a planted grove serve as the visual register for savings accumulating above the network reserve. The bamboo metaphor is doing the same kind of work as the hempcrete one (a living material chosen for a bundle of technical, ecological, and aesthetic reasons that no one of which is sufficient), but in a different room: where hempcrete is the metaphor for the *discipline*, bamboo is a *register* the discipline carries on a particular surface. The two are not interchangeable. §FL.3 records the test that ruled out bamboo as a register on the wallet/XRP-swap chip — bamboo is the right material for the spring artwork and the wrong material for the swap chip, and the test that drew that line is one of the load-bearing entries in the test ledger the Field Ledger collects.

Cross-reference: §FL.3 (Codetry Test 003 — bamboo-field on the wallet chip) for the test that named one register per screen and rejected the bamboo register on a surface the water register had already claimed.

1.6 · The single-sentence definition

Codetry — naming IS architecture (distinct from code-poetry).

From the constellation manifest, grammar.practice.

That is the whole discipline in one line. The rest of this handbook unfolds it: the disciplines codetry is *not*, the worked examples that happen to be in front of the practitioner who first named it, the practice itself, and the teachers behind the practice.

1.7 · Nearest neighbors — the disciplines codetry is not

Codetry sits next to a small family of older disciplines that share its concerns about words doing structural work. None of them is codetry, and each of them is honoured. Naming the neighbours up front, in the same breath as naming codetry itself, spares the reader the work of asking, every chapter, *isn't this just X?* Each contrast below is the one-paragraph form; the full treatment of each neighbour lives in the back-matter Deep Dives, and the §DD reference at the end of each paragraph is the door.

Code poetry.

Code poetry is the older tradition of programs that are also valid verse — Perl in the late 1980s, the Stanford Code Poetry Slam, Mez Breeze, Nick Montfort, Ishac Bertran's *code {poems}* anthology. The poem in code poetry lives *inside* the source: the lines on the screen are the artwork, arranged for sound or terseness or shape. Codetry's poem lives *as* the architecture, and the source is what makes it run. The source of a codetry system is rarely the artefact a reader is meant to admire; the artefact is the way the same noun shows up on the button, in the schema, in the test fixture, and in the conversation in the room, and the source's job is to keep that single noun honest in all of those places at once. §DD.1 walks the contrast in full.

Literate programming.

Literate programming — Donald Knuth, 1984, WEB and CWEB, with Org-mode Babel, Jupyter, R Markdown, and Quarto as its modern descendants — makes the *document* the source. Prose explains; code is generated from the prose; the unit of care is the explanation, and the typeset essay is what the discipline is for. Codetry makes the *metaphor* the source: the unit of care is the name, and the code is the medium that makes the metaphor real, clickable, runnable. Both are *don't trust; verify* moves — show your work in the medium where the work actually lives — but they verify against different witnesses: literate programming exposes the reasoning; codetry exposes the noun. §DD.2 (with §5.1) draws out why the discipline that holds the names is a precondition for the woven document rather than a sibling to it: the woven essay only does what its prose says it does to the extent that the names inside the source carry the metaphor the prose claims they carry.

Domain-driven design and Conway's Law.

Domain-driven design (Eric Evans, 2003), with *Conway's Law* (Melvin Conway, 1968) and the bounded-context, ubiquitous-language tradition behind it, is codetry's closest sibling. Both accept the uncomfortable premise that structure outside the code shapes structure inside the code, and both refuse the older arrangement where the language of the domain is paraphrased into engineer-speak on the way into the schema. DDD typically lands on the *domain expert* — the analyst, the consultant, the senior engineer who has just spent a week in workshops tidying the vocabulary up. Codetry insists the noun must come from the community itself, in the form the community already uses it, before any tidying — and treats every translation away from that noun, even into a cleaner, more general, more reusable noun, as *drift* rather than cleanup. §DD.3 (with §4.2) names DDD as one of the *roots* codetry sits on top of, not only a sibling, and reads the *ubiquitous language* clause as the closest single phrase in the prior literature to the move codetry asks of every individual noun.

Type-driven design.

Type-driven design — *make illegal states unrepresentable*, with Yaron Minsky's Jane Street essays, Richard Feldman's Elm work, and Scott Wlaschin's *Domain Modeling Made Functional* in the room — pushes every invariant the domain demands into the type signature. A non-empty list is its own type; a validated email is its own type; an *Order* that has been *Paid* is structurally different from an *Order* that has not, so the function that ships it cannot be called on the unpaid one. The compiler becomes the first reader of the domain, and the bugs that slip past it are the only bugs left. Codetry agrees that the model carries the architecture, and then asks the harder question: *whose word is on the type?* A perfectly typed `HouseholdContainer` with a non-empty `Items` list and an immutable `CreatedAt` is, by

every type-driven measure, a beautiful model; by codetry's measure it is drifted, because the community said *saltbox*. §DD.4: type-driven design verifies the model against the compiler; codetry verifies the model against the person who handed you the word, and treats a perfectly typed model with the wrong word as drift the type checker can't see.

Capital allocation at scale.

Capital allocation at scale is the founder-as-allocator school — Mises in 1920, Hayek after, the modern entrepreneur lineage that runs through Silicon Valley — that treats capital allocation as the highest economic act and reads profit as the signal the bet was right. Codetry agrees with the calculation point: the information that decides where the next dollar should go lives in the room where the work happens, not in a head office. The two part ways at the exit. The school's success story is the founder who allocates well and *keeps* allocating, on a bigger and bigger pile, for as long as they live; the community around the founder is a counterparty, not a successor. The codetry exit is handover, not compound — the practitioner is paid to write the method down so the community can run the work without them, and a successful practitioner is one the community no longer needs in the chair. §DD.5: both schools agree profit is a signal; they disagree on who reads it — capital allocation at scale reads it at the cap table; codetry insists the signal must also be readable at the kitchen table.

Each of the paragraphs above is the one-paragraph form of a contrast that takes a full chapter to hold honestly. The full chapters are §DD.1 through §DD.5 in the back-matter Deep Dives; that is where the codetry / neighbour distinction is worked out at the length the neighbour deserves. The point of naming the family here, at the close of Part I, is the inverse — to put it on the table once and in one place, so the rest of the handbook can name *what codetry is* without having to keep saying *what it isn't*.

Continue to the Deep Dives → §DD.1.

Part II · The Constellation: 6 Zones and 3 Naming Primitives

The discipline applied to a real community economy. Six zones and three naming primitives (Saltbox, Both-States, Both-Sides), each name chosen by the rules Part I named, plus two constellation-wide tools. These are the worked examples that were in front of the practitioner when codetry got named. The list is open; your own constellation will look different.

2.0 · How to read these

The constellation is not the canon. It is the *founding set* — the worked examples that happened to be in front of the practitioner when codetry got named. They are recorded here so the reader can see naming-as-architecture working in the field, not as a definition.

The reader's own constellation will look nothing like this one. That is correct. The discipline travels; the examples don't.

Snapshot: constellation v0.5.7 · 2026-05-05.

Tool: Author's Desk — build your constellation — The reader's own constellation will look nothing like this one. That is correct. Begin yours before the zones show you what to see.

2.1 · Saltbox

Zone 0 · decentralized

Sitting on the deck with the morning sun and a cup of black coffee. Getting cold, but that's nothing new. Watching the children play outside — and then all of a sudden there's a moment. There's always a beautiful moment to capture. A moment where we wonder: will this ever cross my mind again? Will they remember? Saltbox is the reminder of the things that are true and unshakeable. The sunny moments that make the boreal winters worth bearing. The spring days when the outdoors is the parent and we can just enjoy documenting the ride.

The no-scoring rule comes from this: a measure of a fish's worth cannot be how well it can climb a tree. We each have our individual strengths, and when channeled, those strengths allow a waterfall of value that was never dammed. With a proper saltbox, the children grow brave in their own time — and the dams that don't need breaking down the line are the fruit of that patience.

Zone 0 holds both the family on the land and the elder in the care home. They are just homes in different stages, and they deserve the same value placed on their life stage.

Decentralized homes — homeschool day companion, local-first per family

<https://salt-box.replit.app/>

Worked examples

Lock-In Wins : 15 quiet minutes is enough to count. No MM:SS, no sound, no streak, no score. Lock-in is a state of attention, not a measured performance.

Gentle Words : 6-line bank, $\leq 1 \times$ /day per surface; Deakon's voice $\leq 1 \times$ /week. Scarcity is the design — a line loses its weight when it's shouted daily.

Brave Moments : Amber Shield, one-tap capture from Home; surfaced per-child in seasonal Family Recap. Courage is named, kept, and surfaced — never scored.

Quote of the Day : Deterministic per calendar date; rotates next morning. The quote rests with the day.

Live Follow-Along : Opt-in only, passphrase as header (X-Share-Pass), lock-in count excluded from share payload. Privacy is the default posture, not a setting.

Per-child Goals + tips : Goal lives with the child, the tip meets them where they are. No streaks, no leaderboards. (Goals row in flight: #175 milestone badges, #176 starter-goal suggestions, #177 stalled-goal nudge — Z0 agent will send a delta before this row locks.)

What moment from this week would you regret losing? Name it before the day ends.

Reflect

- What are the things that are true and unshakeable in your household right now?
- Where are you measuring a fish by how well it climbs a tree?
- What would it look like to let someone grow brave in their own time instead of pushing the pace?
- What were you handed by the generations before you in this household — and what are you handing forward to the ones who will sit in this kitchen after you?
- What does this household look like three generations from now — and is anything you are building today pointed at that?

2.2 · Kitchen Table

Zone 1

The word "budget" evokes restriction, tightening. "Watershed" invokes flow, abundance. That difference is not cosmetic — it changes what the person holding the tool believes is possible before they touch a single number.

The Siphon is the bill that leaves before you see the money. But the siphon isn't permanent. You choose the size of it. You can reduce those bills, downgrade the lifestyle, make pivots. You ultimately control it — which is the opposite of what the word "expense" implies.

Non-custodial XRPL stablecoin envelope-budgeting installable web app (PWA) — household balance is the source of the watershed

Channel every drop. Nothing from nowhere.

Formerly: xBuckets, Watershed, Headwaters, Eave

<https://x-buckets-vision.replit.app/>

Worked examples

Eave : the eave is the first shelter outward from the household — the immediate circle of trust that catches what the household cannot hold alone. Rename to 'Network' and you lose the constraint that this zone is built on invitation, not open access; every downstream zone

flows from that boundary being held.

Buckets : envelope categories. You can only pour from one bucket into another; never summon water from nothing. Every transfer is a literal redistribution. Rename to 'Categories' and the UI starts quietly suggesting balances can grow by clicking. Per Test 005, 'cistern' was retired in favour of Bucket — the Earn surface had been calling savings envelopes 'cisterns' in violation of the locked Eave word map.

XRP Spring : savings, defined as free XRP above the 10-XRP network reserve. A spring upwells from below the reserve floor; the user sees what's pooled above the rock. The new six-stage bamboo growth scene (just shipped, #793) extends the metaphor from data model into artwork — same constraint, now visible.

Drip Harvester : two senses, both held by Test 008's resolution. As a noun: an earner wallet that holds RLUSD before it is parked in a Lake — the station between Reservoir and Private Lake on the Earn flow ribbon. As a verb: the move that drips Lake earnings into a Bucket once a sweep threshold is reached. The verb 'harvest' carries patience and seasonality; 'Auto-Compound' would have erased both.

Community Well : monthly pooled tips that round-distribute to community proposals. A well everyone draws from and contributes to; the monthly snapshot/round cycle is the well refilling.

Giving Well : user-to-user tip pool for charitable giving. Same well metaphor at the household scale.

Surplus Pool : where Payday overflow goes once envelopes are full. Pool, not 'extra savings account' — water seeking level. (In flight: #794)

Payday Planner : the moment the spring refills. Allocation flow follows water's priority order: must-pay buckets first, then comfort buckets, then Surplus Pool, then giving.

Rainfall : income arriving this payday — paycheck plus side gig combined, before anything is taken out. The act of arriving, not the leftover; the leftover is the Reservoir.

Siphon : auto-bills drawn out of the rainfall before it reaches the Reservoir. The locked verb for money leaving rainfall before it reaches the wallet — replaces 'bank' wherever it had crept in (Test 001 Sighting 1).

Reservoir : the stablecoin wallet — what's left after the Siphon. The locked noun for the wallet itself; the field name in code is `reservoirLabel`, no longer `masterBucketLabel`. The wallet/XRP-swap chip honours this lock end-to-end after Tests 009 and 010.

Channel (verb) : distributing the Reservoir into named Buckets — the act of 'every drop into a bucket'. Reserved for Reservoir → Bucket only; the Bridge sheet uses 'Bridge' for above-cap transfers, the Drainage lesson uses 'Drainage' for debt payoff, and the Drip Harvester uses 'drip' for Lake → Bucket.

Cloud Cover : compound interest — the weather that keeps producing rain. Separated from the vehicle (Glacier) where it happens; the lesson formerly called 'Compound Rainfall' was re-named to introduce both nouns explicitly.

Rain Barrel : emergency fund — the short-term reserve for surprises. The first layer of the Aquifer ladder; the daily drops about not draining the emergency fund were re-pointed from 'Reservoir' to 'Rain Barrel' to honour Test 002's lock.

Aquifer : long-term savings — the deep reserve that fills slowly. The 3-6 month layer of the savings ladder; replaces 'Reservoir' wherever the lessons were using it for long-term savings.

Glacier : tax-advantaged accounts (RRSP, TFSA) — savings the tax authority leaves alone. The vehicle Cloud Cover compounds inside; named explicitly so compounding (the weather) is no longer conflated with where it happens (the vehicle).

Watershed : diversified income streams — one fragile stream becomes many resilient ones. Distinct from the former xBuckets product name 'Watershed' (still active at the URL/storage layer); here the noun refers to multiple income streams the household draws from. 'Three is a Watershed' replaces 'Three is a reservoir' across the side-income card and daily drops.

Bridge (verb) : above-tap-cap transfers — the Abundance Bridge sheet. The locked verb for transfers that exceed the daily cap; the Bridge sheet was rewritten to use 'Bridge this rainfall' / 'Bridge this →' / 'Bridged across' instead of 'Channel', preserving Channel for Reservoir → Bucket only.

Public Lake : regulated / credit-union yield product — the advisor-mode Earn destination. Half of the Park-rename pair (Public Park / Private Park were renamed to Public Lake / Private Lake by Task #849 so the destination sits cleanly inside the watershed metaphor).

Private Lake : DeFi liquidity pool — the enthusiast-mode Earn destination, self-custody. The Earn flow ribbon's third station after Reservoir and Drip Harvester; replaces 'AMM pool' / 'liquidity pool' on every user-facing surface (Test 005).

Lake current : the small fee paid into a Public/Private Lake each time a swap flows through it; the Drip Harvester's earnings are its share of those currents. Renamed from 'Park toll' by Task #849; the metaphor is that water flows through channels, collects in your Lake, and

Currents from the Lake drip back into your Buckets.

Fill (verb) : the act of putting idle RLUSD into a Lake. Renamed from 'park' by Task #849 — the Earn surface used 'park' as the verb for moving RLUSD into an LP; 'fill' brings the verb inside the water register and removes the last instance of 'park' from any Eave surface (decision logged in Test 002, Task #851).

Drainage : debt payoff — the opposite move from Channel. The locked noun for paying down debt; the lesson formerly called 'Debt Channeling' was renamed 'Debt Drainage' so 'Channel' could be reserved for Reservoir → Bucket only (Test 002).

Park toll : the swap fee a Park collects when someone exchanges through it; the Drip Harvester's earnings are its share of those tolls. Coined in Test 005 as the new noun replacing 'fee per swap' / 'trading fees' on the Earn surface — later renamed to 'Lake current' by Task #849 when the Park metaphor itself was renamed to Lake. Recorded here as the original sanctioned noun from Test 005's vocabulary sweep.

Scaffolding pretending to be engine : Roughly 600 lines of procedural-music machinery — kick/snare scheduler, synth functions, chord timeline, LFO, music bus, per-scene chord-morph effect — sat behind `ENABLE_PROCEDURAL_MUSIC = false` for months in the Headwaters promo video's audio file, shaping how the file read and what future contributors thought the system did. Named as 'feature behind a flag' it was untouchable; named honestly as scaffolding pretending to be engine, it could be deleted, and `ambient-audio.ts` collapsed from 933 lines to ~330 with no change in runtime behavior. A flag that has been off long enough to forget why it was added is not a feature toggle — it is a name lying about the system's intent, and the honest move is to delete it.

Pick one name in this zone and try to rename it. What cracks?

Reflect

- What in your financial life feels like restriction — and what would it feel like as flow instead?
- Where is your siphon larger than you chose it to be?
- What would it mean to channel every drop on purpose this week?
- Is the way your household earns and spends today something you would want your great-grandchildren to inherit as normal — or is it a pattern worth interrupting now?

- What financial pattern has been passed down through your family for two or three generations — and does it deserve to continue?
-

The money machine's governance rules — decision authority, quorum, voting, dispute escalation, Reserve raid protocol, and the quarterly report — are in Appendix G (\$APP.0-APP.7).

2.3 · Workbench

Zone 2

"Founder" feels odd. You don't found a community — you practice within it. You join to help. You have the phone calls, take the actions, practice listening. We practice these things because we know we need to. Crafting all day is what makes life that extra bit sweeter.

This is not a founder's dashboard. It is a practitioner's workbench — the place where the week is planned, the costs are walked, and the work is kept honest against what was said it would be.

Business / operating workbench — deal-flow, weekly steps, cost review, codetry working-doc, synthesis across all the zones

<https://northern-store-plan.replit.app/codetry-handbook/>

Worked examples

Today / Week / Year : time-shape not feature-shape. The same data — phases × weeks × steps — surfaces three ways depending on the time-window the practitioner is standing in. 'Dashboard' would have flattened them.

Idea → Pitch → Contract → Fulfillment → Impact : deal-flow as the spine the slide deck is re-spined around (src/lib/phases.ts). The phase IS where the practitioner currently is, and the deck reorders around that phase. Renaming to 'stages' would let the deck go static again.

Cost review walkthrough : ~70 dollar figures registered in costRegistry.ts with rank order. Walked one-at-a-time, Approve/Edit/Skip + private notes. Not 'settings' — a discipline that gets done, like a pre-flight check.

Carry-over : unfinished steps from past weeks roll forward as 'Carried over' on Today (not 'Overdue,' not 'Tasks'). Honest about time having passed without making it punitive.

Codetry (this doc) : the version-controlled paper trail of the practice. Renaming to 'Design system' would erase that codetry is the practice naming itself.

| *What are you practicing this week that you weren't practicing a year ago?*

Reflect

- Where are you still using the language of a founder when you mean the work of a practitioner?
- What step have you been carrying over longest — and what would it mean to set it down instead of forward?
- Who in the community did you listen to this week?
- Is the practice you are building something you would want a grandchild to inherit — not the business, the way of working?
- What will be different in this community in fifty years if this practice continues — and is that the difference you intend?

2.4 · Greenhouse

Zone 3

Treasurer is the job nobody wants. Some try and fail; a few do well. It is a big commitment for a volunteer organization, and this generation does not have the same bookkeeping skills that the last one had. Nobody wants to step up because they do not want to mess up.

The answer is not to lower the standard — it is to make the job fail-safe, stress-free, and easy as pie for the people willing to take it on. Calm is the contract. The name is not a vibe; it is a promise the system makes to the person who was brave enough to say yes.

Community production for NWO food systems — multi-tenant member-portal pattern

<https://community-knowledge-hub.replit.app/>

Worked examples

'Today I...' verbs as routing primitive : the library front door isn't a menu of features; it's a shelf of verbs the member picks based on what today asks for (Today I cook & preserve / gather / order / learn / trade / help). The verb is the route, the photo-tile is the chapter cover, the cream recipe-card label sits on the photo. Audience (household vs producer) swaps which shelf you're looking at.

Library of recipe books : audience-aware shelves of 8-12 themed stacks. Stacks = chapters, audience choice = which book. Visual recently caught up to metaphor — tiles read as printed recipe cards on a photo. Two-column on phones (a paired spread), three-column on desktop.

Treasurer Calm Monthly Journey : 'Calm' is the contract, not a vibe. Confidence meter + per-treasurer lookahead preference (off / 1 / 2 / 3 days) + 14-day snooze-expiry outline + email digest + in-app banner. Treasurers plan ahead instead of reacting.

Dues snooze as primary verb : treasurers don't 'defer' or 'pause' a dues line — they snooze it, and the system auto-wakes them with a digest tied to (recipient, lineItem, snoozedUntil). The verb dictates the behavior (something will wake you), not the other way around.

Stuck Board : cross-domain aggregator at /admin/stuck and /board-hub/stuck. Pulls aging items from member onboarding, producer pipeline, outstanding dues, partner/grant sync errors, open grants, and marketplace seller replies into one owner-tagged view with last-touch timestamps. The name is the spec: things get stuck → the board surfaces them.

Producer Playbook : sequenced markdown chapters producers work through, surfaced as list/detail with mailto CTAs back to the co-op. Playbook = ordered plays, not a wiki.

NOHFC Grow Application Workspace : single-grant focused workspace at /applications/nohfc-grow-stream (lives in the Grants Finder artifact). Five tabs (eligibility, sections, budget, attachments, submission packet), deadline countdown, one-click switch to July 31 intake on a not-eligible verdict. Deliberately not a generalized grant form-builder — the grant is the unit of work.

Audience chooser as structural pivot : signed-out visitors choose household vs producer; the choice persists in localStorage (807.audience.v1) and changes which library, which CTAs, and which dashboard cards render. One pivot, two products.

Board hub as cluster of role rooms : /board-hub/{chair, treasurer, secretary, director, operations, distribution, agm, training, applications, drive-map, social-ideas, cashflow-budget, onboarding, stuck, orders} — each role gets its own room rather than a single admin dashboard. The role IS the room.

Tenant seam : tenant.headerProductLabel, tenant.legalName, board contact routing in api-server/src/config/board.ts — anywhere the app would say the co-op name goes through the seam. The seam is what makes the Commons zone a pattern for community production, not a one-off for Dryden.

Kitchen rental kept quiet : public marketing has zero kitchen-rental promotion; /partners/kitchen-rental exists as a 'borrow equipment for community programs' page that still POSTs the same inquiry route. The naming carries the policy: it's borrowing, not renting.

Appreciation Wall / 'help' stack : members pin thank-you notes to other members. A first-class surface, not a footer widget — gratitude has its own room because the system says it matters.

What job in your community has gone unfilled because it felt too risky to get wrong?

Reflect

- Where in your organization is bravery being asked for without a safety net underneath it?
- What would change if the hardest volunteer job was also the most supported one?
- Who said yes to something difficult recently — and did they hear that it was noticed?
- Who in this community is making decisions as if they will be held accountable by people not yet born — and what does that look like in practice?
- What does a thriving version of this commons look like in 175 years — and what has to be true today for that to be possible?

2.5 · Clearing

Zone 4

It is not just the spreadsheet and the phone call. It is the Facebook comments, the Instagram comments, the Facebook messages, the marketplace comments, the email, the voicemail, the text message, the in-person conversation, the invoice. One person has to touch it all — because it is the only way the ball of yarn will not unravel.

The producers running these operations are not failing for lack of effort. They are failing for lack of capacity. If they had the capacity to systematize, they could find the efficiencies needed for real growth. That is the job this zone exists to do.

The word they use is not "regenerative." It is grass finished. Grazing. Fodder fed. The work names itself in what it produces and how it is done.

Conventional → regenerative track for industries — multi-year, sector-scale; current sector is regen beef in NWO

<https://regen-revolution-zone-4.replit.app/>

Worked examples

Per-customer share split : replaced 'cut sheet management' as the v0.1 centerpiece. Pre-Jude strawman optimized a symptom; the real work was the math after the kill — 6-14 customers, one animal, by hand, twice a week. Renaming the centerpiece rewrote the schema, the success metrics, and the build sequence in one move.

Don't fix my book : Jude's line. Dropped the booking calendar from v0.1 entirely. Naming her paper ledger as a working artifact (not a legacy obstacle) REMOVED a feature.

Failures land on the tool, not on her : Black Barn's tone note. Now an architectural constraint on every error state — operator-protective copy, not generic 'something went wrong'.

Make it easier for Jude to say no : Lisa Koshel's add. A v0.1 design principle, not a feature: scope-creep guards, lock-date enforcement, no-button-that-just-absorbs-pain.

OMAFRA traceability as byproduct : the animal record was designed so the regulator's log falls out for free. Naming it 'byproduct' prevented a parallel ledger from being built.

Estimate → actual → variance loop : Jude records real packaged weights; the same UI that showed '≈' to the farmer flips to 'Actual' when the data lands; the dashboard surfaces per-species variance; the constants in yield.ts stay tunable from that signal. Naming the whole cycle as a loop, not three features, kept it coherent.

Pre-zone parked thread : 'Homestead-sitter / childcare app for farm families' — discovered during Black Barn discovery, deliberately not absorbed into Z4. Parked as a scratch thread; probably Z0 or Z5 when it finds a home.

| *Which thread in your operation are you the only one holding right now?*

Reflect

- Where is the ball of yarn closest to unraveling — and what would it take to add one more pair of hands?
- What do you call what you do? Not what the movement calls it — what you call it.
- What would systematic look like for one part of your operation this season?
- Is the land in this sector producing more or less life than it was seven generations ago — and which direction are you pointed?
- What would this sector look like if every decision made in it for the last 175 years had been made with the seventh generation in mind — and how far is today from that?

2.6 · Edge

Zone 5

A dam day is a day without rhyme or reason — where a spark was lit and a fire burst forth. It may be a creative hyperfocus, or a day that required a shift of energy that no constellation can contain. Dam days are fleeting. But there are gems worth harnessing in them — they may just be covered in muck.

The Shallows is where you clean them off. Not every take becomes something. But the practice of catching it before it disappears is the whole discipline.

Wild / observation — private capture (takes) with structured channel-out and opt-in float to the Shallows

Formerly: The Margin

<https://conversation-log.replit.app/>

Worked examples

The rebrand without a rewrite : The Zone 5 app was deployed as watershed.replit.app before The Margin existed as a zone name. When the rename happened, it touched display strings, prose, and the Forge prompt — not chapter IDs, storage keys, or schema. The codetory test: change the name, did the structure survive? Yes — because the structure was the metaphor underneath the name. The URL stayed watershed.replit.app; the concept Watershed moved to Zone 1 where it always belonged.

Slowly at first, then all at once : Same line lives on the home page (web), the book cover (screen reader), and the print PDF. One epigraph, three surfaces, identical bytes.

Typos as fingerprints : The Forge system prompt mandates verbatim artifact preservation. The book that gets generated quotes the user's own typos back at them as evidence. The metaphor 'every drop is sacred' is implemented as // preserve typos, casing, weird spacing.

The Shallows handle : A user posts anonymously; their pseudonym in that thread is stable; in another thread they're someone else. The 'depths below the shallows' framing is literally the session-hash one-way derivation.

What was the last dam day you had — and what did you catch from it before it passed?

Reflect

- What is sitting in the muck right now that might be worth cleaning off?
- How do you know when a day is a dam day versus a day that just got away from you?
- What would it mean to trust the dam day instead of fighting it?
- Which ideas in your margin are too big for your lifetime — and does that make them worth keeping or worth letting go?
- What would you want the seventh generation after you to know you were trying to do — and does anything you captured today point at that?

2.7 · Brainstorm Library

Pre-zone

Think of it as a volunteer seed. One that fell from last year's harvest and found a little water and sunshine on its own. Not a parking lot — ideas parked don't grow. Not a curated library — you don't browse volunteer seeds; you notice them. If cultivated, who knows what they could become?

Seed bank — ideas before they're sorted into a zone

<https://replit.com/@xbucketsapp/Brainstorm-Library?s=app>

awaiting agent context-pack

What idea have you been walking past for months that might just be waiting for the right season?

Reflect

- What is sitting in your seed bed right now that you have not yet named?
- When did an idea that had no zone find its place — and what gave it the opening?
- Which seed in this bed is not for you — it is for someone two generations forward who will know exactly what to do with it?

2.8 · The Standby — the constellation's first non-zone primitive

Constellation-wide primitive · non-zone

Worked example for the both-states principle, introduced in §1.3.

The umbrella system + always-on state for *temporary centralized disruptions* — drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power, water, freight, payment systems, pandemic, evacuation, AGM-postponed, key-person-down. One name that holds both the slow side (always-on preparation) and the fast side (active event).

Hosted in Zone 3 (community production) because that is where centralized disruptions are felt collectively. The co-op shelf, the producer pipeline, the orders ledger are where the absence of freight, power, or staff lands first. Read by every zone.

Why the umbrella has to hold both states

The Standby is one piece of infrastructure that moves between two operational states. The resting state is always-on practice — the pantry shelf is stocked, the contact tree is current, the generator gets test-started, the watch reads the morning advisory before anything is happening. The activated state is a fast, episodic event — a fire call opens, the rosters flip, the standby stock comes out where everyone can see it, and the system runs in active until the call stands down. One infrastructure, two states.

If the resting state and the activated state were named separately — *The Pantry* for the shelf, *The Call* for the event — the constellation would end up with two systems. One would have an inventory cadence and no event handling. The other would have an event handler and no preparation discipline. The cultures would diverge, and the moment a call opened the practitioner would discover that the people who keep the pantry are not the people who run the call, and the handoff would have to be invented under fire. The both-states test catches this before it happens: pick the resting state, ask whether the umbrella name still holds in the activated state; pick the activated state, ask whether the umbrella name still holds in the resting state. *Standby* passes both — *on standby* and *standby stock* are the same posture in either state. *Pantry* and *Call* each pass only one.

The both-states principle applies here: one piece of infrastructure — the Standby — that moves between a resting state and an activated state. The name names the pipe, not the valve position. Standby holds in either state.

Vocabulary

- the Standby — the umbrella system + always-on state
- a call — a specific active event (a fire call, a flood call, a freight call)
- the watch — the active-monitoring posture between advisory and active — the sub-noun for the act of watching a developing situation
- standby stock — the physical/operational reserves the always-on side maintains
- the debrief — the after-action synthesis once a call has stood down
- centralized disruption — the class of event the Standby is for — a temporary loss or strain of a centralized system the community depends on

Severity ladder

- advisory — something is forming on the horizon; no posture change required, but the watch is informed
- standby — preparation is sleeved in; standby stock is verified; envelopes ready to flex
- active — a call is open; the system is responding; envelopes and rosters have flipped
- standdown — the call is closed; debrief opens; standby stock is replenished

Sub-shelves inside the umbrella

- The Common Pantry — the food/supply sub-noun — the literal shelf inside the Standby that holds staples, water, fuel, medicine. Sub-noun, not replacement.
- The Watch — the active-monitoring sub-noun — the posture and the people doing the watching during advisory/standby rungs. Sub-noun, not replacement.

Rejected alternatives

- The Common Pantry (as the umbrella name) — Holds the slow side beautifully (a pantry is by definition always-on) but cannot hold an active fire call, an evacuation, or a payment-systems outage without straining the metaphor. A pantry is what you keep; the Standby is also what you do. The Pantry sits *inside* the Standby as the food/supply sub-shelf.
- The Watch (as the umbrella name) — Holds the active-monitoring posture (the watch is active by definition) but cannot hold the slow shelf of standby stock without bending into something that sounds like a permanent vigil. The Watch sits *inside* the Standby as the active-monitoring sub-noun.

Cross-zone reads

- Zone 0 (Saltbox + Bright Side) — household and institutional standby checklists mirror the co-op's standby stock list, item for item.
- Eave — a standby budget envelope sleeves up automatically during an active call (drought → water-cost envelope, fire → supply-cost envelope, freight → stockpile envelope).
- Zone 2 (Workbench) — standby debriefs surface here as the cross-zone synthesis the workbench is for; no live call state is kept on the workbench, only the after-action read.
- Zone 3 (Commons) — host zone. Centralized disruptions are felt collectively here first; call history is the record kept here; The Common Pantry and The Watch are the sub-

shelves.

- Zone 4 (Arc) — sector-level standby modeling: which industries have which fragilities to which calls (freight → packed weights, power → cold storage, key-person → Jude).
- Zone 5 (The Margin) — debriefs that someone wants to share publicly float to the Shallows; private-by-default holds.

The takeaway

When a system is one piece of infrastructure that moves between a resting state and an activated state, the name has to hold in either state without bending — or the system will fork into two systems with two cultures.

The Standby is the constellation's first non-zone primitive. It is hosted in Zone 3 because that is where centralized disruptions are felt collectively first, but it is read by every zone — and the both-states principle it carries is now registered as a named principle in the manifest, available the next time a primitive has to do double duty.

Open questions

- What is the right cadence for the resting state's stock-check ritual that does not drift into bureaucratic ritual? Monthly is too easy to skip; weekly is too easy to resent; *whenever there's an advisory* is reactive, not standby.
- Does standby stock get ledgered the way money does in Eave, or is it deliberately kept off the books — held by the household and the co-op directly, outside the financial primitives — so the act of stocking does not become an act of accounting?
- When two calls overlap (a fire call open while a freight call is still standing down), do they share a single active rung, or does each call get its own ladder running in parallel? The manifest currently assumes one call at a time.
- How does the practitioner know when *not* to open a call? An over-eager active rung erodes the discipline as fast as a missed one does, and there is no rejected-alternative entry yet for *did not open the call when we should have*.
- When does a prolonged activated state stop being an activated state and become the new resting state? A six-month freight outage is no longer a call — it is a new always-on. Does the system know how to absorb a call into the resting state without losing the debrief?

2.9 · The Gate — language across institutional boundaries

Constellation-wide primitive · non-zone

Worked example for the both-sides principle, introduced in §1.4.

A calm passage between the bright side and the systems. The umbrella system + posture for *passing language across institutional boundaries* — codetry vocabulary going out to a regulator, banker, funder, lawyer, or other legacy-world counterparty; their vocabulary coming back in. Holds both sides without flattening either: the founder/practitioner keeps the original noun, the counterparty receives the dialect they can act on, and the gate logs the substitution so the translation stays auditable.

Hosted in Zone 3 (community production) because that is where the community meets the legacy world — the co-op invoices a wholesaler, the producer signs a band council resolution, the Headwaters bookkeeper files with CRA. Sibling to The Standby (also Z3-hosted): both umbrella systems operate at the boundary where centralized systems and the community-controlled side touch. Read by every zone whose work has to leave the constellation in writing.

Why the umbrella name has to hold both sides

The Gate holds two registers that an outside system would not even recognise as siblings. On one side is the *bright side* — the constellation's own dialect, the words a community uses with itself in its own kitchens, meetings, and ledgers: *neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock, the watch*. On the other side is *the systems* — the outside world's dialect, the language a regulator, a banker, a funder, a lawyer, or generic SaaS English will accept: *resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves, compliance officer*. Neither side is wrong inside its own context. Each side is unfit currency in the other's context.

If the two sides were named separately — *Translator* for the bright-to-systems direction, *Importer* for the systems-to-bright direction — the constellation would end up with two pipes and no posture. The Gate is more than directional substitution. It decides whether a piece of language *should* cross at all, in either direction; it logs every substitution so the bright-side noun stays on file alongside the systems-side equivalent; and it has a *refused* bar — a function that passes the both-sides test in its own right — for source-side language that has no honest target-side equivalent and would lose its meaning under any substitution. The both-sides test catches the shape: pick the bright side, ask whether the umbrella name still respects the systems side; pick the systems side, ask whether the umbrella name still

respects the bright side. *Gate* passes both — neither side is the inside, neither is the outside; the Gate is the membrane that lets each context keep its own language while still allowing communication across.

The both-sides principle applies here: one membrane — the Gate — that faces two rooms simultaneously, always. Bright side and the systems both look at it at once; the name has to hold from either direction.

How this differs from the Standby

The Standby's two *states* are temporal — the infrastructure is constant; the system moves between resting and activated, and the name has to hold in either. The Gate's two *sides* are contextual — both face the system at once; the name has to hold from either direction. The Standby's principle is *both-states*; the Gate's principle is *both-sides*. Both are now registered as named principles in the manifest. A future primitive may need a third axis (densities? scales? jurisdictions?) and the principles array is open-ended on purpose — the discipline travels, the worked examples accumulate.

The doctrine backbone — evaluating what's real and what's story

Before the Gate can pass or refuse a piece of language, the practitioner needs a prior discipline: the ability to separate what is real from what is story, and to catch the reasoning errors that make bad crossings feel justified. Two Zone 5 instruments serve this function. *RealityCore* is the formal test for what is real versus what is story — the practitioner's tool for checking whether a claim about the bright side or the systems side is grounded in fact or is a narrative the speaker has mistaken for one. The *Fallacy Map* is the named catalogue of reasoning errors practitioners catch in the field: the common moves that make a false crossing look honest, a refusal look cowardly, or a substitution look like an equivalent when it is not. Together they are the epistemological backbone the Gate rests on. A Gate operated without them is guessing.

Tool: RealityCore — Zone 5 doctrine instrument — The formal test for what is real vs. what is story. Open this before making a Gate decision you are uncertain about.

Tool: Fallacy Map — Zone 5 doctrine instrument — The named catalogue of reasoning errors practitioners catch in the field — the common moves that make a false crossing look honest, a refusal look cowardly, or a substitution look like an equivalent when it is not.

Vocabulary

- the Gate — the umbrella system + always-on posture
- the bright side — the codetry-vocabulary side; the constellation's own dialect
- the systems — the outside world's side; the systems dialect (regulators, bankers, funders, lawyers, generic SaaS English)
- a mapping — a registered correspondence between a bright-side term and its systems-side equivalent (e.g. neighbour → resident, send → remit, fee → service charge, money → funds)
- a substitution — a single instance of a mapping being applied to a piece of crossing language
- a category — the domain a mapping belongs to (Pragmatism, Politics, Regulations, Privacy, Banking, ...); each category is a sub-shelf inside the Gate
- a translation — a piece of language that has passed through the Gate in either direction; the auditable record of what crossed and what changed
- a calm membrane — the metaphor doing the load — selectively permeable, alive, not a wall and not a wide-open door; the gate does work without picking a side

Severity ladder

- draft — language has been written but not run past the Gate yet; no posture change required
- under-review — the Gate is reading the language; mappings are being proposed; the founder is in the loop
- cleared — the language has crossed; substitutions are logged; the translation is part of the record
- refused — the Gate declined to translate — usually because the bright-side noun has no honest systems-side equivalent and forcing one would lose the meaning the founder is trying to keep

Sub-shelves inside the umbrella

- Mappings — the registered correspondences that the Gate carries — the dictionary side. Sub-noun, not replacement: a Mapping is what the Gate knows; the Gate is also what it does with what it knows.
- Substitutions — the applied-instance ledger — every time a mapping has been used, who used it, on what document, in which direction. Sub-noun, not replacement: substitutions

are the Gate's history; the Gate is also its present.

- Categories — the domain shelves the mappings live on (Pragmatism, Politics, Regulations, Privacy, Banking, ...). Sub-noun, not replacement: a category is where a mapping is filed; the Gate is the building all the categories sit in.

Rejected alternatives

- Translator — Holds the directional work but flattens the gate's posture into pure transaction — a translator processes; a gate decides whether to. Strips the calm-passage feel out of the metaphor.
- Filter — Implies the Gate's job is to remove or block, which mis-frames the work — the Gate doesn't subtract, it relabels in flight while keeping both names on file. A filter chooses what gets through; the Gate chooses what the through-language is called on each side.
- Censor — Carries punitive weight the metaphor refuses; the Gate is collaborative with the founder, not adversarial. A censor decides for you; the Gate proposes and lets the founder confirm.
- Glossary — Holds the dictionary side (Mappings) beautifully but cannot hold the active posture of substituting in real documents, the ledger of past substitutions, or the refused-translation rung. A glossary is what you keep on a shelf; the Gate is the shelf plus the room plus the work happening in it.

Cross-zone reads

- Zone 0 (Saltbox + Bright Side) — every form filled out for the school, the doctor, the child welfare office crosses a small gate; the household's word for who-belongs is *kin* or *neighbour*; the form's word is *resident* or *legal guardian*. The household keeps both on the fridge; the form goes out with the systems' word. *Gate Refused (Zone 0 — Parrs Jars, 2020–2022)*: the Jarista built a smoked salt blend from freeze-dried local microgreens, hydroponic greens, and farm-sourced onions — a circular economy product whose value proposition was the specific sourcing. The health unit required lab testing for each farm ingredient and recommended switching to commercial ingredients instead. The practitioner crossed with commercial ingredients to meet orders. The product crossed; the story did not. The systems-side form had no slot for *freeze-dried microgreens from our own hydroponics, blended with onions from Walls Farm* — only for *kale powder (commercial source)*. The bright-side value proposition was Gate Refused: no honest systems-side equivalent existed that could carry the same meaning, so the sourcing story stayed on the bright side and the jar went out with a different recipe. The lesson:

the Gate does not always find an equivalent. Sometimes it refuses. When it refuses, the practitioner notes what was lost in the crossing and keeps the bright-side language alive at home, even when it cannot appear on the label.

- Eave — every grant application, CRA filing, and banker meeting is a Gate event. The bright side says *channel*; the systems say *bank account*. Same plumbing, different room. The mappings ledger is what keeps the two from drifting apart in the practitioner's own head.
- Zone 2 (Workbench) — proposals, contracts, and statements of work cross the Gate between practitioner-vocabulary and client-vocabulary; the workbench logs which words crossed, in which direction, and what they became, so the next contract starts from the previous translation, not from scratch.
- Zone 3 (Commons) — host zone alongside The Standby. Co-op invoices, band council resolutions, and regulator filings are the highest-volume gate traffic in the constellation. Host because Z3 is where the community's collective economic surface meets every external counterparty at once.
- Zone 4 (Arc) — sector-level translation: a *trapline*, a *family-run cold truck*, a *seed library* gets one systems-side equivalent for grant purposes (*harvesting operation*, *refrigerated logistics SME*, *plant-genetic-resource program*) and the bright-side name continues to live unchanged at home.
- Zone 5 (The Margin) — public communication runs into a third register the Gate refuses to formalise: *plain language for the wider public*, neither bright-side nor the systems. The Gate handles bright-to-systems and back; the third register lives one zone over, and the Shallows decide what gets said publicly in whose words.

The takeaway

When a system has language that has to live inside two contexts that do not trust each other, the metaphor must hold both sides without flattening either, or the system will pick a dialect and lose the other room.

The Gate is the constellation's second non-zone primitive. It is hosted in Zone 3 alongside The Standby because that is where the community's collective surface meets every external counterparty — and it is read by every zone. The both-sides principle it carries is registered alongside both-states in the manifest, available the next time a primitive has to hold two contexts at once.

Open questions

- Should *refused* (the rung) become its own ledger, or is it just a category of *cleared with a note that no honest equivalent existed*? The first treats refusal as a first-class outcome the practitioner reviews periodically; the second treats it as a footnote on a clearance and lets it disappear into the file.
- Where does the third register — plain public language for Zone 5 — live? Inside the Gate as a fourth direction, alongside it as a sibling primitive (a *Public Voice*?), or out of scope entirely on the grounds that the Shallows already do it without naming it?
- When the Gate refuses to translate, what is the next move? Does the practitioner rewrite the source-side language until it is gateable, or does the document just go out untranslated with a footnote saying *this term has no honest equivalent in the target dialect*? The first protects the document; the second protects the noun.
- Does the Gate need a severity escalation when the systems try to *replace* a bright-side word inside source documents — not just translate them on the way out? A funder editing the practitioner's own kitchen-language inside a draft is a different event than the practitioner translating it on the way out, and the manifest currently does not distinguish.
- Is *the systems* precise enough as the name for the outside-world side? It carries the load — the world of regulators, forms, dashboards, and policy — and it uses language the self-reliant community already knows and trusts. Worth re-examining once the Gate has been used in the field to see whether it holds under pressure or needs a sharper edge.

2.10 · Closing reflection

Together, the constellation is one lifestyle map for charting a course in northwestern Ontario — drawn in the grammar of the land it's drawn for. Other constellations will be drawn in the grammar of other lands.

That is the test of whether codetry has taken root: not whether anyone else uses these names, but whether anyone else's names start carrying their own weight.

Tool: Daily Prompt — The constellation requires a daily question to stay alive. One question, drawn from the zones — return to it each morning until it answers itself.

Part III · The Practice

The practitioner in the field. Six moves for working with communities, then Zone 0 — the household as the first and most durable ground. Bobbie's practice is the example here. Yours will be the proof.

3.1 · Listen for the noun

Every project arrives wrapped in a noun the community already uses. A co-op committee says *the books*. A homeschool circle says *the day*. A trapline keeper says *the territory*. An extension agent says *the season*. The community has already named the thing.

The temptation is to translate it. *The books* becomes *the ledger* becomes *the financial management module*. *The day* becomes *the curriculum*. *The territory* becomes *the dashboard*. Each translation feels like progress and each translation steps the system one foot away from the people it is being built for.

The codetory practitioner's first move is to write down the noun the community used and refuse to translate it. The system, when it ships, has *the books* in it. The button says *open the books*. The data table is called *the books*. The reports are *what the books say this month*. If the team starts saying anything else in the working session, the practitioner asks why and writes the new word down, because something has shifted.

The noun is not branding. The noun is the foundation footing.

Rule — write down the noun the community already uses, and refuse to translate it.

From the ledger — §FL.2 (Codetory Test 002) is this rule made permanent: the Eave word map locks in the watershed nouns the community had already been using and refuses to swap them for generic equivalents. §FL.5 (Codetory Test 005) records the same rule pulling the Earn destination back to the community-native Lake after several generic candidates were tried.

Tool: Shared Vision — Describe what you are building like a familiar object — a bucket, a shelf, a jar — and hand off a clear plan to your team or agent.

3.2 · Test the name by trying to rename it

Once a name is in place, the test is to try to take it out.

Imagine the same system with a generic noun in the same slot. *Buckets* becomes *Categories*. *The territory* becomes *The Service Area*. *Calm* becomes *Easy*. *Stuck* becomes *Overdue*. Hold the rest of the system constant and read what changes.

From the ledger — Tests 001, 002, 009, and 010 (the two 010 entries — shortfall CTA and swap-sheet header) all turn on the rename test of this chapter. §FL.1 catches bank trying to displace the watershed verbs on the Payday CTA. §FL.2 locks the Eave word map and rejects three specific generic-noun renames at once. §FL.9 graduates Top up reservoir from XRP on the demoted swap chip by running this test against the production wording Convert XRP → RLUSD. The two §FL.10 entries — Top up reservoir from XRP · cover the shortfall on the loud amber CTA, and Top up your reservoir on the swap-sheet header — extend the same test to a loud surface and to a transactional sheet's title-level register. See the Field Ledger for the full ledger.

If renaming the thing changes the structure, the name was load-bearing. If renaming changes nothing, the name was decoration.

Buckets renamed to *Categories* lets the UI quietly suggest balances can grow by clicking. The rule that you can only pour from one bucket into another, never summon water from nothing, is held by the word *bucket* and disappears the moment the word does. *Stuck* renamed to *Overdue* turns a cross-domain aging-item aggregator into a deadline list and quietly removes the owner-tag and the last-touch timestamp because deadlines don't need them. The test catches both before the name leaves the wall.

A name that survives this test is a name a system can be built on. A name that doesn't is a label.

User-gesture listeners : A list called *unlockListeners* gated something the code never named — the rule that only events counting as a user gesture may unlock audio — and quietly grew to include *pointermove*, *focus*, and *visibilitychange*, none of which require a real gesture; combined with a one-shot flag, the first stray event silently burned the only unlock attempt and the audio refused to autoplay for weeks. Rename to *userGestureListeners* and ask whether those entries still hold: they don't, and the load-bearing rule the original name had hidden surfaces in the same breath. The honest fix is to name the rule out loud and keep the listeners attached until a real gesture is confirmed to have unlocked the system.

From the field

In the practitioner operating plan workbench there is a page called */codetry-test*. It is this chapter, made operational. The practitioner walks every load-bearing name in the constellation's three financial artifacts down the rename test and writes the verdict next to it: *load-bearing*, *decorative*, or *drift*. Each entry records the rename tried, what would change if the rename were taken seriously, and — where the verdict is drift — the follow-up that resolves it. The page is print-friendly, so the audit can sit on the wall, and it carries a *last reviewed* date so the next walk-through has a starting line.

Open /codetry-test alongside this chapter to see the test running on real names.

Rule — a name that survives the rename test is load-bearing; one that doesn't is decoration. Reject generic-noun renames at the gate.

From the ledger — \$FL.1, \$FL.2, \$FL.9, \$FL.10 are the rule at work; the \$FL.10 pair extends it to a loud-amber CTA and a transactional sheet's title-level register.

Tool: Rename Test — run it on a real name — Bring one name from your practice. Try two alternatives. Write what would be lost. Deliver the verdict: load-bearing, decorative, or still unclear.

3.3 · Detect drift

The names slip. Always. *Member* becomes *user* on a slide deck because the deck was made in a hurry. *The day* becomes *the curriculum* in an email because the recipient was a school board. *The books* becomes *the financials* in a grant application because the funder uses that word. None of these are bad faith. All of them are drift.

Drift is not cosmetic. The metaphor was doing structural work, and the moment the working language slips, the structure starts shifting underneath it. Two weeks of *user* in the team's mouths and someone proposes a *user dashboard* and the codebase grows a route that does not belong to anyone in particular.

The practitioner's job is to catch the slippage early and name it as slippage. Not as a brand violation. As a structural issue. *We started saying user. Did we mean to? If we meant to, what changes about the thing being built?* If the answer is *nothing changes*, the team was tired and the right move is to put the original word back in everyone's mouth. If the answer

is *something does change*, then the team has been telling the practitioner something the practitioner hadn't yet heard, and the discipline is to follow the new word back to the structure it implies and decide on purpose.

From the field — drift caught at the gate

The constellation carries a version number. This handbook keeps an offline copy of the constellation so it can sit on a phone in a fishing camp with no signal. When the constellation gained a new entry — a glossary line that named two distinct meanings of the bare word *cost* and asked the practitioner to use the long forms when both meanings were in the same room — its version moved. The handbook's offline copy did not.

A check built into the handbook's build refused to ship until the offline copy caught up. The practitioner reached to publish a routine update and the publish failed. The error printed the version on each side, the path to the file that needed regenerating, and the one-line command that would resolve it. The fix took the time it takes to read the message.

The check did its job. The metaphor and the offline mirror of the metaphor are not allowed to disagree, and the system enforced that. The lesson worth keeping is the timing. The slippage was small, the fix was a single command, and the cost was still paid at the most expensive moment — at the gate, with the practitioner already reaching for the publish button. Drift detection works wherever it is installed. It is cheaper installed earlier.

Drift caught at the gate is drift caught. Drift caught at the bench is drift caught cheaply.

The instruments that catch drift — the audit pages, the long-form glossaries, the build-time checks, the cross-deck assertions — are taken up again, as a family, in §3.6.

From the ledger — §FL.1 (Codetory Test 001) is this chapter at work on a single button: two sightings on the Payday CTA, one of bank trying to displace channel, the other of a stale Surplus Pool parenthetical drifting in a daily drop, both caught by reading the surfaces cold and naming the slip as a slip. The two sightings are the cleanest worked example of catch the slippage early and name it as slippage the handbook has on hand.

Rule — drift is structural, not cosmetic. Catch the slippage early and name it as slippage; install the check at the bench, not at the gate.

From the ledger — §FL.1 names the gate-vs-bench timing the rule turns on; the §FL.1 sightings of bank and Surplus Pool are the slip caught and named.

3.4 · Run a naming session

Before any system gets built, the practitioner sits down with the people the system is for and surfaces the nouns and verbs that should carry weight.

A naming session is not a brainstorm and it is not a logo workshop. It is a quiet conversation in the working language of the people in the room.

The shape of the session

- Ask the group to describe a typical week, in their own words. Take dictation. Don't paraphrase. The practitioner's job in this opening half-hour is to be a careful stenographer.
- Read back what was written and circle every noun and verb that the group used more than once. These are candidates. The community has already said which words it leans on.
- For each candidate, ask: *what would change if we used a different word here?* If nothing changes, the word is decoration; uncircle it. If something changes, the word is load-bearing; underline it.
- Lay the underlined words on the table together. Notice which are nouns (things the system will hold) and which are verbs (things people will do). The system being built will be a structure of those nouns and a workflow of those verbs.
- Ask one final question: *is anyone in this room embarrassed by any of these words?* If a word was useful in the meeting but the group does not want to see it on a screen, it has not yet earned its place. Either find a more honest word for the same load, or accept that the group does not want this load named at all and design around the absence.

The session produces a one-page list of nouns and verbs in the community's own language. That list is the spec. Everything that follows in the build has to load against it.

Suitable for printing from the share sheet — five steps fit on one side of a letter page.

Rule — the session's output is a one-page list of nouns and verbs in the community's own language. Print it; the print is the spec.

From the ledger — §FL.2 (Codetry Test 002) is the locked Eave word map: a one-page table of nouns and verbs the practitioner committed to as the spec for the watershed dialect, born of exactly the kind of session this chapter describes.

3.5 · Distinguish the metaphor from the technology

A codetry app can be paper. A codetry app can be a database. A codetry app can be a pickup-truck route, a phone tree, a clipboard on a wall, an SMS reply form, a SaaS dashboard, an Excel sheet with named ranges. The medium serves the metaphor.

The error is to assume that the technology determines the discipline. It does not. A paper ledger named honestly — *the books*, with columns called *what we owe* and *what we are owed* — is more codetry than a SaaS dashboard with rows called *Account Receivable Aging Report*. The first one carries weight in its names. The second one carries weight nowhere; the names are scaffolding for the database, not the other way around.

When the practitioner is choosing the medium for a codetry build, the question is not *what is the most modern stack*. The question is *what medium will let the names hold*. Sometimes that is software. Sometimes that is not. The discipline is the same either way.

From the ledger — §FL.3 (Codetry Test 003) and §FL.5 (Codetry Test 005) both run this distinction at the surface level. §FL.3 rules out the bamboo-field metaphor on the wallet/XRP-swap chip not because bamboo is a bad metaphor, but because the chip's medium — a wallet/swap surface inside the Eave water register — already belongs to a different metaphor, and the rule one register per screen protects the medium from carrying two competing metaphors at once. §FL.5 graduates the Park / Public Park / Private Park renames for the Earn surface (later renamed to Lake by Task #849, recorded in this entry) — the rename was specifically about choosing the medium-correct noun for the destination of an Earn flow inside the Eave watershed dialect.

Rule — one register per screen. The medium serves the metaphor; never let two metaphors compete on the same surface.

From the ledger — §FL.3 enforces one register per screen on the Eave wallet/swap chip; §FL.5 lands the medium-correct noun (Lake) on the Earn destination after the discipline rejects the off-register candidates.

3.6 · The instruments of verification

Codetry's standard for verification is not external. It is internal to the artifact: the metaphor must be inspectable in the name itself.

Don't trust; verify — the older line — is the family the codetry verification belongs to. Where related disciplines verify by exposing the source, by exposing the test suite, by exposing the audit log, codetry verifies by exposing the metaphor in the place a user already looks: the name on the button, the noun in the title, the verb in the menu.

A user who reads *bucket* and reaches for the system to redistribute funds and finds that the system will only let them pour from one bucket into another has verified the metaphor with their hands. The name made a promise; the system kept it. That is the codetry verification, and it is happening every time the system gets used.

If the name keeps its promise the next time someone uses it, the verification holds. If the name has to be explained, the verification has failed and the work is to find the name that doesn't.

From the ledger — §FL.2 (Test 002), §FL.4 (Test 004), and the §FL.6/§FL.8 pair (Test 006 and the second-numbered Test 008) read as a working family of verification instruments. §FL.2 is the locked Eave word map itself — the table the rename test of §3.2 runs against. §FL.4 names the temperature rule (calm states earn their loudness) — the verification that a name's typographic volume matches the work the name is doing. §FL.6 and §FL.8 install the Drip Harvester sense-distinction across Earn surfaces — verification by pinning down two senses of one noun rather than letting the bare word drift between them.

Rule — one word, one referent. Pin each noun to a single sense; let the typographic volume match the work the name is doing.

From the ledger — §FL.6 and §FL.8 hold one word, one referent on the Drip Harvester noun across Earn surfaces; §FL.4 holds the calm-states temperature rule.

3.7 · Teaching codetry to communities

Sooner or later the practitioner has to explain codetry to a room of people who did not come to learn a software discipline. They came to talk about a store, a clinic, a road, a co-op. The practitioner's job in that room is not to teach codetry as theory. It is to surface the principle the room has been using its whole life and put a name on it, so the work that follows can be done together.

The example to teach with is architecture itself. Not architecture as analogy — architecture as *source*. The principle codetry generalises into the world of words is the same principle that holds when the material is wood, concrete, or hempcrete: some parts carry the load, others do not, and the parts that carry the load cannot be quietly renamed without the structure shifting underneath. The audience already knows this. They have spent their lives in buildings. The teaching move is not to introduce a new idea. It is to make a familiar idea visible in a place they had not yet looked: the words.

The shape of the teaching

- Point at the room. *What is holding this roof up? What happens if you take that wall out?* Everyone knows. Nobody needs the vocabulary taught. The room already speaks the language of *load-bearing, foundation, what holds the thing up*.
- Cross the threshold once. *In the things you and I build out of words — a store name, a grant proposal, a co-op's bylaws, a clinic's intake form — there are also load-bearing parts. They look the same as the decorative parts on the page. They are not the same.* This is the only sentence that does the abstract work. After it, return immediately to the concrete.
- Do the rename test on a word the room cares about. Not *saltbox*. *Theirs*. Take the name of their store, their road, their proposal, their committee, and try to rename it on the table in front of them. *Watch what cracks*. Let the room feel the difference between a rename that changes nothing and a rename that takes the structure with it.

The flinch is the proof.

If the room flinches when the practitioner offers to rename their thing — a small physical recoil, a sharp *no, that's not what we are* — the principle has been transmitted. The flinch is the audience verifying for itself that the word was load-bearing. No further explanation is required. The discipline has not been taught at the audience; it has been recovered from the audience and named in their hearing.

If there is no flinch — if the rename lands and nothing in the room reacts — the word was decoration, and the practitioner has just done a piece of useful diagnostic work in public. Either is a good outcome. Both are codetry.

Why hempcrete teaches better than concrete

Concrete teaches load-bearing, but it teaches only one thing at once. Hempcrete teaches the codetry-specific point: a single material can be *load-bearing and insulating and breathable and community-buildable and locally legal* all at the same time. One name, multiple structural jobs. That is exactly what a load-bearing noun does in software. *Saltbox* carries climate-response and household-defaultness and vernacular-respect in one word.

Headwaters carries source-of-the-water and small-and-upstream and what-flows-from-here in one word. The community member who has thought about hempcrete versus concrete already understands that picking the material is itself an architectural decision, not a budget decision. *Picking the word* then reads as the same kind of decision, not as marketing.

Where the room already has live opinions on the material — and in northern Ontario, hempcrete is a real conversation, not a hypothetical — the teaching recruits engagement that already exists rather than generating it from scratch.

The fable version

Not every room thinks in buildings. Some rooms think in stories. The Ant and the Grasshopper is the teaching move for those rooms — the same principle, running in the grammar of a fable rather than the grammar of a construction site.

The grasshopper's argument is internally coherent: abundance is everywhere, anytime he grows hungry he can hop through the field, there's no use doing extra work when the time could be better spent. The ant does not argue. The ant keeps working — storing a little extra each day, reading the pattern of the seasons, preparing for the weather he knows will come. History repeats itself, after all.

When winter arrives, the grasshopper watches the last blade of grass disappear. The fable's lesson is not *be afraid*. It is *the pattern was legible, the preparation was available, and the name for what the ant was doing is the same name the Jarista uses: Preservation Season*. The ant was a Zone 0 practitioner running the Standby. The field was the supply chain. Winter was the activated state.

The fable teaches what the building teaches. The ant is not paranoid — the ant is reading the pattern. Winter is coming is not a threat; it is a calendar.

The garden version

A third room thinks in gardens. For that room: designing community is like designing a garden. You need intentional placement of boundaries and intentional facilitation of interactions. Forcing community is like designing a garden in a swamp — you can do everything else right, but you're always going to be covered in muck.

The garden metaphor reaches the voluntarist principle without naming it as such. Voluntary interactions and clear boundaries are what let grassroots community flourish — the same principle the architect states through load-bearing walls and the fable states through winter storage. Three entry points, one discipline.

The first room

The teaching is most honest when the example is also a real decision the room is about to make. A naming session for an actual store, an actual clinic, an actual road. The practitioner walks the room through the three moves above on the room's own live problem, and what comes out the other side is not a workshop demonstration. It is the community doing codetory on themselves, with a name that is going to go on a sign, on a building, on a grant cover page. The discipline is transmitted in the same hour the work gets done.

Don't teach codetory as theory. Show the audience the principle they have already been using in buildings, then let them feel it on a word they care about. The flinch is the proof; the named decision is the receipt.

Tool: Practice Cards — explain it to your circle — The 'explain it to your circle' card is in the stack. Write the two-minute version — no book terms — before you try it on anyone.

3.8 · Practice: The first act

The first challenge was not to find a client. It was not to write a plan or secure a contract or identify a community in need. The first challenge was to turn the home from a liability into an asset with just one thing: practice.

Not money. Not expertise borrowed from a course. Not a credential that grants the right to enter. Practice — the slow, daily, repeatable act of doing the work on the ground where you already live.

Zone 0 is the ground, not the starting point

The home is Zone 0. The practitioner does not begin in a community. The practitioner begins in the household. The garden is planted before the field extension is designed. The books are kept before the community ledger is built. The jar goes on the shelf before the Seasonal Shelf is named. The well pump is installed before the water system is mapped.

This is not metaphor. It is sequence.

A practitioner who has not run the rename test on their own household vocabulary cannot run it honestly on a community's. A practitioner who has not held a load-bearing noun under pressure at home cannot hold one under pressure at a council meeting. The standing to speak is earned before the speaking begins, and it is earned in the place where the consequences are personal.

Zone 0 does not atrophy during the field work

Zone 0 is not a stage the practitioner moves through. It is the ground the practitioner stands on for the whole arc of the work. The community engagement deepens the practice; it does not replace it. The harvest still happens. The jars still go up. The accounts are still kept.

The practitioner who lets Zone 0 atrophy in order to serve Zone 3 has abandoned the source of the standing that made the service possible.

3.9 · The host

The practitioner requires a host. Not a client. Not a contact. Not a procurement officer or a band councillor who agreed to take a meeting. A host — someone who has opened their door and meant it. Someone whose table the practitioner sits at, whose food the practitioner eats, whose stories the practitioner receives before a single proposal is put on paper.

The kitchen table is the entry point

The entry point is a kitchen table. Not a boardroom. Not a Zoom call. Not a formal presentation in the band office with slides up on the wall. A kitchen table, with food on it that the host caught or grew or preserved, and the story of how it got there.

The fish on the plate came from a specific lake, caught on a specific morning, with a specific method the family has used for three generations. The fish story is not small talk. It is the first data. It tells the practitioner what the community knows about its own food system that will never appear in a grant report or a municipal planning document. The fish story is where the load-bearing nouns live, before anyone has been asked to produce them.

Three in order

- A listening ear — because the practitioner has no standing to observe until they have demonstrated that they can be still.
- A keen eye — because observation without attention is just presence.
- The grounding data — not extracted, not surveyed, but accumulated through time spent in the room where the work actually happens.

What the practitioner is listening for is not problems. Problems are named later, and only after the community has had time to name them first. What the practitioner is listening for is what already works — what names the community has already given to its own practices that carry genuine weight. These names are the foundation everything else is built on.

The host is the door. The kitchen table, the fish, the fish story — these are what turn a contract into a journey. The practitioner cannot shortcut the host relationship by being efficient.

3.10 · We don't hide our numbers; we deliver on them

The first document the practitioner produces is not a proposal. It is a set of numbers. Not projections. Not assumptions. Not a best-case scenario designed to make the engagement look attractive. Numbers — the margin per unit, the volume required to reach viability, the cost of the equipment the plan depends on, the salary the operator will need to live while the institution gets on its feet. Dollar-honest, before anything else is honest.

The community that receives a proposal before it receives the numbers will spend the engagement comparing the proposal to hope. The community that receives the numbers first will spend the engagement comparing the proposal to reality. The second community is building something that lasts.

Delivering is different from promising

We don't hide our numbers; we deliver on them. Delivering on numbers is different from promising numbers. A promise lives in the future; a delivery lives in the record. The practitioner's credibility is not built by the quality of the forecast — it is built by the accuracy of the account of what actually happened and why, delivered promptly, in plain language, to everyone in the room who needs to know.

The rename test runs on numbers too. *Net operating loss* is the vendor's word for *we spent more than we made this month and here is exactly why*. The community deserves the second sentence.

The hempcrete boundary

The boundary that holds the community's language is set in hempcrete. Not drywall. Hempcrete — the material that cures over time, that hardens with age, that draws carbon out of the air instead of adding to it. The boundary is not a locked gate. It is a wall whose integrity improves the longer it is maintained.

And like hempcrete, it requires regular inspection. The practitioner does not set the vocabulary boundary and leave. The same monthly report that delivers the numbers also checks whether the words used to describe them are still carrying the meaning the community put into them, or whether the language has begun to drift toward the vendor's data model, the funder's framework, the government form. Drift is slow. It looks like a reasonable substitution. The inspection catches it before the compound interest of a wrong name runs for another quarter.

Goodwill compounds. A community whose vocabulary holds — whose institutions are still called by the names they chose — has built something whose value increases with each generation that inherits it. The language is the asset. The regular inspection is the maintenance schedule.

3.11 · The feast

The transition is not a handover. It is not a delivery of binders and a final invoice. It is the moment when the community solidifies its own voice. And that moment is celebrated.

There is a difference between a community that has been given a system and a community that has claimed one. The given system requires the donor to maintain goodwill with the recipient; the claimed system requires the community to maintain goodwill with itself. The practitioner's job — from the first kitchen table visit to the final meeting — is to make sure it is the second kind.

A binding experience

When the transition is the second kind, it is a binding experience. Not a ceremony of appreciation for the consultant who did the work. A recognition, by the community itself, that something has changed in how they hold their own institutions. The vocabulary is theirs. The books are theirs. The methodology is documented in words they wrote. The gate is set in hempcrete and the inspection schedule is maintained by people they trained, on timelines they control.

That community is worth defending. Not because it is valuable to an outside observer. Because the people inside it know what they have built and what it cost them. Invaders — economic, linguistic, institutional — would have to get through the gate first. The gate is inspected regularly. It has been inspected regularly since before the invaders arrived.

The feast

So there will be a feast. There will be stories — the ones from before the engagement began, the ones from the middle when the numbers were hard, the ones from the moment the community spoke its own vocabulary back to the practitioner and it carried weight. There will be food that someone caught and someone preserved and someone cooked, and the story of how it got to the table will be told without a consultant's permission.

There will be healing. Not as a side effect of the work. As the thing the work was always pointing toward. There is healing that only a correct name can convey at the right moment — the moment when the community calls its institution by the name it chose, in the voice it trained, in the presence of everyone who helped build it.

The whole arc — Zone 0 practice, the host's kitchen table, the dollar-honest numbers, the hempcrete boundary inspected and held — is preparation for that moment. Not for the deliverable. Not for the invoice. For the feast. That moment will be seized.

Part IV · The Quiet Examples

Six zones applied to one life. Zone 0's household economy — the Jar Kitchen, the Jarista, the Seasonal Shelf, the Homestead — and then the constellation: the operational centre, the operating plan, the co-op, the territory, the wild edge. These are not instructions. They are the practitioner's own example, offered as a map.

4.1 · Zone 0 — The Household

*Zone 0 · **the ground** · where everything else in the constellation flows from.*

The constellation has six zones and two constellation-wide primitives. Zone 0 is not where the work starts — it is what the work is for. Every other zone, every primitive, every gate and standby and ledger in the system exists to protect what happens in Zone 0: the household, the family, the daily practice of keeping people warm and fed and free.

Zone 0 in the permaculture sense is the human body and the home. In the Headwaters constellation it is both: the household as the economic and relational unit that every other zone is downstream of. *The household balance is the source of the whole watershed.* Eave is downstream. Zone 3 (the co-op) is downstream. Even Zone 4 (the land) is downstream from the household that is tending it. Get Zone 0 right and every other zone has a stable source to draw from.

What the practitioner does in Zone 0.

The six moves of §3.1–§3.6 all apply in Zone 0. Listen for the noun: the household practitioner says *the pantry, the jar kitchen, the seasonal shelf, the canning season* — not *food storage*, not *meal prep*, not *inventory management*. Write those nouns down and refuse

to translate them. Test the name by trying to rename it. Hold the metaphor to the medium. Run the both-states test when the system has two states (the resting shelf and the harvest push).

The chapters that follow are not a how-to guide. They are the vocabulary of Zone 0 practice — the named systems a household runs, the nouns those systems load their weight onto, and the tests that tell the practitioner when a name is doing real work versus when it is decoration. The practices themselves — fermentation, canning, cold storage, bulk sourcing, seasonal meal planning — are older than codetry and will survive it. What codetry adds is the naming discipline that keeps those practices legible to the people inside them and resistant to the generic vocabulary that would slowly erase what makes them specific.

Where the protocol begins.

The Saltbox is the first rung of the three-layer trust stack. The posture the gate asks you to declare was grown here — in the household, in the daily practice of keeping the pantry, running the Standby, naming the systems correctly. The Standby's four-rung ladder (Advisory → Standby → Active → Standdown) is household discipline before it is community infrastructure. A practitioner who has not practiced the Standby at Z0 is arriving at the Z1→Z2 gate without a posture to declare. They will choose from a menu. The practitioner who has practiced is activating a readiness they have already built.

Key custody lives at Z0. The Z1→Z3 prohibition is structural on-chain — but it is only as strong as the household's discipline over its own keys. If the household shares keys carelessly, the membrane becomes conventional again, not structural. Cryptographic sovereignty is either practiced or neglected at the Saltbox. This is not a technology problem. It is a Zone 0 practice problem, in the same category as the pantry and the canning season: something the household either maintains or does not.

The Eave shelters Z0 from Z3 weather under normal conditions. When Z3 weather arrives with institutional force — a legal demand, a tax authority, an audit — the Eave's strength is the clarity of Z0's record-keeping and key custody. A Saltbox with clean books and clear custody holds under pressure. A Saltbox that has drifted is exposed the moment the Eave is tested. Zone 0 practice is the structural load-bearer the Eave rests on.

Zone 0 is not the smallest zone. It is the source zone. Everything else is downstream — including the protocol.

4.2 · The Jarista

*Zone 0 · **the named practitioner** · bright-side identity.*

Every practice needs a named practitioner. *Jarista* is the bright-side name for the household practitioner who runs a jar-centred, seasonally-organized food system. Not a home cook, not a food preservationist, not a homesteader. A Jarista — the person who has built the jar into the infrastructure of the household rather than treating preservation as a seasonal hobby.

Why this name and not another.

The rename test: replace *Jarista* with *home cook*. What changes? *Home cook* describes someone who prepares meals. It carries no information about preservation, about seasonal sourcing, about the long-game of building a household that can run independently of the grocery store for weeks or months. Replace *Jarista* with *food preservationist* and you keep the preservation dimension but lose the daily kitchen practice — the Jarista cooks from jars, not just into jars. The word holds both directions in one.

It is also a bright-side word with no systems-side equivalent. When a Jarista speaks to a grant officer, a public health inspector, or a food hub coordinator, they use whatever language the context requires — *home food producer*, *small-scale preservationist*, *food security practitioner*. But at home, in the kitchen, in the co-op's training program, the word is *Jarista*. The Gate logs the translation; the bright-side noun stays unchanged.

The Jarista is a both-sides word: the household practitioner in their own language on the bright side; food producer or preservationist on the systems side. The Gate holds the translation. The name stays.

Who the Jarista is in the constellation.

The Jarista is not a certification. It is a posture — the household practitioner who has decided that the jar is the unit of measure for their food system, the season is the calendar they plan by, and the shelf is the first line of resilience when supply chains tighten. In a constellation context, the Jarista is the Zone 0 counterpart of the Zone 2 practitioner who runs the Operating Plan. Both are named practitioners. Both are running a system. The Zone 2 practitioner names and protects the vocabulary of the constellation's institutions; the Jarista names and protects the vocabulary of the household that the constellation exists to serve.

Tool: Practice Cards — the Jarista — The Jarista card is in the stack. Work it before the next chapter — the whole Jar Kitchen sequence rewards moving slowly.

4.3 · The Jar Kitchen

*Zone 0 · **the named space** · the infrastructure of seasonal living.*

The Jar Kitchen is not a kitchen that happens to have jars in it. It is a kitchen where the jar is the primary unit of storage — the default container that the Jarista thinks and plans around. Tupperware is a visitor. The jar is the resident.

The rename test.

Rename *The Jar Kitchen* to *The Kitchen*. What changes? The principle disappears — that this kitchen is organized around a specific container, a specific preservation posture, a specific relationship between what is grown this season and what will be eaten next February. *The Kitchen* is every kitchen. *The Jar Kitchen* is a named system with a named organizing principle.

Rename it to *The Pantry*. What changes? The pantry is where food is stored; the jar kitchen is also where food is prepared, transformed, and preserved. The pantry is static; the jar kitchen is active. The pantry receives; the jar kitchen produces. The name carries the direction of movement, not just the location.

What the Jar Kitchen holds.

- *Wide-mouth jars* — the standard unit. Pints for single-meal portions, quarts for soups and stocks and fruit, half-pints for ferments and condiments. The size vocabulary is consistent across the whole system.
- *The Seasonal Shelf* — the always-changing inventory of what was preserved this season and is being drawn down through the year. Not a static pantry. A living shelf.
- *The Bulk Corner* — dry goods in jars: grains, legumes, spices, nuts. Sourced in bulk, stored in the same container system, requiring no translation between storage and use.
- *Fermentation station* — the active culture corner. Crocks, airlocks, cloth-covered jars of something alive. The Jar Kitchen has a living edge that most kitchens do not.
- *Immersion blender, wide-mouth lids, jar tongs* — the tools specific to the Jar Kitchen. Not interchangeable with the general kitchen toolkit. Named by their function in the system.

The Jar Kitchen is a design decision, not a decorating style. The jar is load-bearing: rename it out and the whole system of seasonal storage, portion planning, and bulk sourcing has to be redesigned around whatever container replaced it.

<details> <summary>Detail — three properties · circular economy origin</summary>

The three properties.

The jar holds its place in the Jar Kitchen for three reasons, all structural: it is resilient, versatile, and honest.

- *Resilient* — jars don't break under pressure. They seal against air, moisture, and contamination. The Jarista who builds a food system around jars is building around a container that was designed for exactly the conditions preservation creates: heat, acid, pressure, time. A jar full of tomatoes from August will still be a jar full of tomatoes in February. That is not a property of a plastic tub or a zip-lock bag.
- *Versatile* — the same jar serves as a drinking glass, a ferment vessel, a dry-goods container, a sprouting jar, a portioned lunch, and a gift. The container system does not require translation between functions. The pint jar that held last summer's salsa holds this morning's overnight oats. The system runs on one container vocabulary.
- *Honest* — you can see what's inside. The Seasonal Shelf is auditable at a glance: what month things came in, what colour they are, how much is left. The jar does not hide its contents. This is an architectural property, not an aesthetic one: a shelf you can read without opening anything is a shelf you can manage without a spreadsheet.

The circular economy origin.

The Parrs Jars product line — the green salt, the Salty Onion — was born from the Jar Kitchen's circular economy logic. The household was growing microgreens and hydroponics and ending up with more than the kitchen could use fresh. Freeze-drying the excess preserved the nutrition without the jar. Mixing the freeze-dried greens into smoked Himalayan salt with homegrown tomato powder produced a product: the green salt. The Salty Onion followed from the same logic — a massive harvest of onions and greens from Walls Farm and the garden, freeze-dried and blended. The jar held the output; the circular economy produced the input.

The product line was a Zone 0 practice producing Zone 3 commercial output. The Jar Kitchen didn't start as a business. It started as a household system that generated abundance — and the abundance had to go somewhere. That is the direction the Jar Kitchen runs: from abundance toward meals, toward products, toward community, not from market demand backward into production.

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Tool: Word Walk — Jar Kitchen vocabulary — Walk the Jar Kitchen vocabulary. Five terms, one deliberate choice at a time — accept, reject, defer. The vocabulary only becomes yours when you've handled each term.

4.4 · Sourcing

*Zone 0 · **farm to jar** · bright-side sourcing in a northern food system.*

The Jarista does not shop. They source. The distinction is not semantic decoration — it is the load-bearing difference between a household that takes what is available and a household that builds relationships with what is grown nearby and plans around what the season will offer.

The vocabulary of sourcing.

- *The Bulk Round* — the seasonal sourcing run. Not a grocery trip, not a shopping day. A round: a planned circuit of farms, markets, and co-op pickups that brings the season's abundance home in one efficient move. The naming carries the shape of the thing — a route, not a transaction.
- *The Farm Gate* — the direct producer relationship. Buying at the farm gate rather than through a retailer keeps the multiplier local: research on northern food systems suggests that every dollar spent at the farm gate generates up to \$2.30 in the wider local economy, compared to a fraction of that when the same dollar flows through a distant supply chain.
- *The Market Table* — the farmers market as a sourcing channel. Distinct from the Farm Gate in that it is curated by season and geography: what is on the table this week is what is ready this week in this territory.
- *Wild harvest* — hunting, trapping, fishing, and foraging as sourcing channels. Not hobbies. Not supplements to a grocery habit. Named as primary sourcing channels that the Jarista plans the year around.

- *The Canning Club* — the shared-production arrangement where several Jarsitas pool a production kitchen, labour, and bulk sourcing to process seasonal abundance more efficiently than any one household could alone.

Sourcing in a northern food system.

In northwestern Ontario, the season for local fresh produce is short and the distances between producers are long. The Jarista's sourcing practice is built for this specific geography: a short, intense harvest window, a long storage season, a preference for wild harvest over tender annual crops, and a co-op supply network that extends what any one household can source on its own. The names of the sourcing channels carry this geography — they are not imports from a southern growing culture.

Sourcing is not the same as shopping. Shopping is reactive — you take what the supply chain offers. Sourcing is intentional — you build relationships with what the territory produces and plan your preservation season around the calendar of the land.

4.5 · The Seasonal Shelf

*Zone 0 · **the living pantry** · seasonal rhythm made visible.*

The Seasonal Shelf is not a pantry. A pantry is static — you stock it and draw from it and restock it when it runs low. The Seasonal Shelf is a living inventory that moves with the year: full in October after the harvest push, drawn down through winter and spring, nearly empty by May, and beginning to fill again when the first summer crops arrive. The trajectory is the system.

The rename test.

Rename *Seasonal Shelf* to *Pantry*. The trajectory disappears. A pantry is managed to stay full; the Seasonal Shelf is managed to cycle. The Jarista who calls it a pantry will manage it like a pantry — buying to replace what is gone, without reference to the season. The Jarista who names it a Seasonal Shelf will manage it differently: watching the trajectory, planning the preservation season to refill at the right moment, drawing down intentionally in late spring to make room for the next season's abundance.

What the Seasonal Shelf tracks.

- *Preserved goods* — jars of what was processed at peak season: tomatoes in August, berries in July, beans in September, venison from November. The shelf's language is the month things came in, not the month they were purchased.
- *Dry storage* — grains, legumes, nuts, dried mushrooms, dehydrated vegetables. The bulk round's non-perishable output. Stored in the jar system, rotated by date.
- *The Freezer Register* — the Seasonal Shelf has a cold counterpart: the harvest hold in the freezer, tracked with the same seasonal vocabulary. Blanched and frozen beans from August. Rendered fat from the fall slaughter. Smoked fish from the spring run.
- *Gap tracking* — the Jarista watches what runs out before the next season rather than what they forgot to buy. The gaps in the Seasonal Shelf at April are the planning inputs for the next harvest push.

Whole food prep in the Jar Kitchen is organized around the Seasonal Shelf. The week's meals are drawn from what is on the shelf and the freezer register, not from a meal plan built against a grocery flyer. The planning direction is reversed: from abundance toward meals, not from meals toward shopping.

The Seasonal Shelf is managed to cycle, not to stay full. A shelf at zero in May means the system worked. A shelf that never empties means the rotation has stalled and something is aging past its best.

4.6 · The Harvest Hold

*Zone 0 · **the freezer system** · holding seasonal abundance across the year.*

The freezer is not a backup refrigerator. In the Jar Kitchen it is the Harvest Hold — a deliberately managed seasonal reserve that is stocked during the harvest push and drawn down through the year. The name carries the purpose: *hold* is active, not passive; *harvest* ties it to the season that filled it.

The rename test.

Rename *Harvest Hold* to *Freezer*. You have named an appliance. Rename it to *Frozen Storage* and you have named a function but not a system. The Harvest Hold is a managed reserve with a fill cycle, a draw-down trajectory, a rotation discipline, and a seasonal calendar. The word *freezer* carries none of this. A freezer is where leftovers go. The Harvest Hold is where the season goes.

How the Harvest Hold works.

<details> <summary>Technique detail — how each function works</summary>

- *Flash freezing* — freezing individual portions on a sheet before bagging, so the Harvest Hold contains loose usable portions rather than a solid brick that has to be thawed whole. The technique is named; it is not just a tip.
- *Year-round inventory* — the Harvest Hold is tracked with the same discipline as the Seasonal Shelf. What came in when, in what quantity, at what stage of processing. The register is the discipline.
- *Rotation* — oldest items forward, newest behind. The Harvest Hold that is not rotated is not a hold; it is an accumulation. Rotation is what makes the hold a system rather than a pile.
- *Pressure canning as an alternative* — some things the Harvest Hold stores in the freezer could instead be shelf-stable in the jar system. Pressure-canned meats and stocks move from the freezer column to the Seasonal Shelf column, reducing the Harvest Hold's load and extending the household's resilience beyond a power outage.

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The Harvest Hold and the Seasonal Shelf together are the household's two-sided reserve: one cold and perishable in an infrastructure sense, one shelf-stable and infrastructure-independent. The Standby principle applies at the household scale — the name that holds both the Harvest Hold and the Seasonal Shelf together is *the reserve*, and a household that manages both as one system is more resilient than one that manages them separately.

The Harvest Hold is filled once a year and drawn down all year. A freezer is used every week. The difference is a management posture, not an appliance.

4.7 · Preservation Season

*Zone 0 · **the activated state** · when the household Standby fills itself.*

Preservation Season is the activated state of Zone 0. The resting state is the Seasonal Shelf being slowly drawn down, the Harvest Hold running its rotation, the Jarista cooking from what is there. Preservation Season is when the bulk round returns full, the jars come out of storage, the lids are ordered, and the Jar Kitchen runs at full capacity for days or weeks. Same infrastructure, different tempo. Both states have a name.

The both-states test at household scale.

The name *Preservation Season* holds both states only if the Jarista carries both in one posture — the shelf is being maintained even when Preservation Season is not active, and the seasonal push is anticipated during the long draw-down of winter. A Jarista who only preserves and never draws down has a hoard. A Jarista who only draws down and never preserves has an empty shelf by March. The system requires both states to be named and practiced.

The techniques of Preservation Season.

<details> <summary>Technique detail — five preservation methods</summary>

- *Water bath canning* — high-acid foods: tomatoes, fruits, pickles. The entry technique; fills most of the Seasonal Shelf.
- *Pressure canning* — low-acid foods: meats, stocks, beans. Moves what would live in the freezer onto the shelf instead.
- *Fermentation and pickling* — live-culture, small-batch. Ferments are managed, not sealed — a different discipline than canning.
- *Dehydrating* — mushrooms, herbs, berries, jerky. Low-tech and the most resilient technique during a power outage.
- *Rendering and smoking* — fat, lard, smoked fish and meat. The territory's traditional preservation methods, still the right ones for this climate.

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Preservation Season and the Household Standby.

Preservation Season is the household's annual activation of its own Standby. The co-op's Standby (Zone 3) runs the same both-states discipline at the community scale. The household Jarista and the co-op's Standby practitioner are running the same system at different scales, in the same vocabulary, on the same calendar. When the Standby activates at the co-op level — a freight disruption, a weather event, a supply-chain failure — the Jarista's Preservation Season work is exactly what the household draws on to stay fed while the community-level response mobilizes.

The verification signal.

The codettry practitioner has the rename test. The Jarista has the ping. When a jar seals properly — the lid pulled down by the vacuum formed as the hot contents cool — it produces a single sharp sound. That ping is the verification signal: the jar sealed, the work held, the preserve is shelf-stable. There is no ambiguity. The lid either pings or it doesn't. If it doesn't, the jar goes in the fridge and gets eaten this week. The batch that pings goes on the Seasonal Shelf.

There's nothing like the ping of a lid sealing to make you feel accomplished. It is the discipline's verification in the plainest possible form: the work held.

A note from the territory: the farmers market attendance in Dryden has been declining. Producers are exiting because the regulatory barriers are high and the customer base is thin. If the Seasonal Shelf matters — if the Jarista's practice matters — then buying locally is not a preference. It is maintenance. A community that does not support its local producers will one day find that no local producers remain. The Jarista's shelf and the farmer's market table are the same system, viewed from two directions.

Tool: Practice Cards — the full Jar Kitchen — Six cards — Jarista, Jar Kitchen, Seasonal Shelf, Bulk Round, Harvest Hold, Preservation Season. Flag what hasn't landed. These are the names worth keeping.

4.8 · The Homestead

*Zone 0 · **physical infrastructure** · the ground beneath the Jar Kitchen.*

The Jar Kitchen sits inside a larger system: the homestead. The homestead is Zone 0's physical infrastructure — the named systems that keep the household running when external systems fail. The Jar Kitchen preserves the food. The homestead keeps the house warm, the water flowing, and the growing going regardless of what the grid, the supply chain, or the season is doing.

Self-sufficiency as a percentage is the honest metric for Zone 0 infrastructure. Not *are you prepared* — a yes/no that has no calibration — but *what percentage of your household's needs can you meet from within your own systems right now*. A backyard garden and a jar

or two is 5%. Three heating systems, a spring-fed well with a manual pump, year-round indoor growing, and a full Seasonal Shelf is closer to 85%. The gap between those two numbers is the infrastructure build — and it is a decade of work, not a weekend project.

The named systems of the homestead.

- *Three heating systems* — not one. The load-bearing rule for Zone 0 in a northern climate: no single heating system is the only heating system. A wood fireplace, a backup propane or oil furnace, and a passive solar or radiant floor arrangement each carry a different part of the load. When one fails — in a power outage, in a fuel shortage, in a mechanical breakdown — the others hold the house. The third system is the one that runs when neither of the first two can.
- *Gravity-fed septic* — waste management that does not require electricity or a pump to function. The infrastructure that continues to work when the power is out. Most homeowners in the city never think about the pump that runs their septic; the Zone 0 practitioner makes sure the system works without one.
- *Manual well pump for the spring-fed well* — drinking water that does not require the grid. The spring-fed source and the manual pump together are the household's water independence: the pump operates when the power is out, the spring replenishes when the aquifer is whole. Named as two systems working together, not as a single appliance.
- *Gardens and indoor growing systems* — the Jar Kitchen's supply chain, located on the homestead. Outdoor gardens for summer abundance; kratky hydroponics and indoor growing systems for year-round production. The indoor system extends the growing season past what the northern Ontario climate allows outside, and produces the microgreens and greens that feed the Jar Kitchen's circular economy.
- *Pantry rotation systems* — the organizational discipline that connects the Harvest Hold and the Seasonal Shelf into one managed reserve. First-in-first-out, dated labels, gap tracking. The system that turns a storage space into a working pantry.

Infrastructure before skills.

The infrastructure is not the most valuable thing the homestead builds. The skills are. The heating systems, the well pump, the gardens — these are capital. The knowledge of how to use them, repair them, extend them, and teach them is the compounding asset. A household with three heating systems and no one who knows how to tend a wood fire is less resilient than a household with one heating system and three people who know how to use it. Infrastructure names the capability. Skills hold it.

Start where you are, with what you have. 5% is a beginning, not a failure. The homestead build is a decade of compounding decisions, not a single preparedness purchase.

Tool: The Standby — household checklist — Zone 0 saltbox version. Water, fuel, meds, kid-care, contact tree, power, waste — the same rungs the co-op uses, at household scale.

4.9 · Kitchen Table — The Operational Centre

*Kitchen Table · **the most-frequented ring of the constellation.***

Kitchen Table in the constellation is Headwaters itself — the immediate operational layer the practitioner organizes outward from. In the permaculture frame Kitchen Table is the territory visited every day; in the constellation it holds the practitioner's own ledger, the household budget system, the daily coordination tools, and the codetory practice itself. Kitchen Table is not a category. It is the practitioner's working territory — everything that lives within daily reach of the household door.

The rename test.

Rename *Kitchen Table* to *the budget system* or *the household finance layer*. What changes? The budget system is one function that Kitchen Table holds; the name narrows the zone to its financial role and hides the operational reality that Kitchen Table also holds the practitioner's time discipline, their codetory practice, and the daily decisions that translate Zone 0's household abundance into outward-facing activity. The zone name is not a category label. It names the practitioner's own immediate working territory — the full scope of what is tended daily, not only what is tracked financially.

The practitioner who names Kitchen Table the budget system and Zone 0 the homestead has left the relationship between them unnamed — and the relationship is where the practice lives. Zone 0 supplies what Kitchen Table allocates. If the allocation vocabulary is borrowed from fintech and the supply vocabulary is borrowed from homesteading, the practitioner is running two systems in two languages with no shared word for the handoff. Name the handoff.

4.9a · Capital Gates

*Capital Gates · **the Gate Rule applied to zone crossings** · conscious consent, not market transaction.*

The Gate Rule is one of the most important disciplines in the Codetry zone model. You can move capital between zones — but you cannot do it invisibly or automatically.

Each zone is not only a ring of proximity. It is a capital-type boundary. Living, material, experiential, and cultural capital originate in Zone 0 and Zone 1. Social capital is structural to Zone 1 — Kitchen Table — because that is where the relationships that generate it are held. Intellectual capital spans Zones 2 and 3. Financial capital is native to Zone 3 and above. A zone crossing is therefore always a capital-type conversion. When social capital crosses outward and becomes financial capital, something irreplaceable has been moved. The conversion cannot be undone without re-crossing.

The gate decision.

Converting one form of capital into another is not forbidden. But it requires a gate decision: a moment of conscious consent, recorded and witnessed. Not a market transaction. Not a convenient shortcut. A ceremony — a deliberate crossing that both sides of the gate can name and verify afterward.

This is the deeper meaning behind the Eave Rule. The rule does not say *never move capital between zones*. It says *no crossing without a gate*. The gate is what makes the crossing legible — to the practitioner, to the community, and to any future audit that needs to understand what moved and why.

The Ramsey Corollary.

"Never borrow from friends and family" is what people say when they have no gate.

Dave Ramsey's rule is not wrong. It is the correct prescription for the diagnosis *no gate mechanism*. When there is no ceremony, no record, no defined terms — when the crossing happens because it was convenient and both parties assumed goodwill — the social capital at Zone 1 has been quietly converted into financial obligation at Zone 3, with no gate keeping the record of what crossed and on what terms. The prohibition exists to protect the relationship because the relationship has no other protection.

Codetry's answer is not the same prohibition. It is: build the gate. Once the gate exists, the crossing can happen with integrity. The practitioner and the community member can both name what moved, on what terms, recorded and witnessed. The social capital at Zone 1 does not disappear into a financial transaction at Zone 3 — it crosses through a gate that both parties can inspect. The Eave Overhang is the constitutional expression of this principle: no Z3 identity or financial capital may compose directly into a Zone 0 or Zone 1 record without a documented gate decision.

Build the gate so you can cross intentionally when it truly serves the whole system. The gate is not a wall. It is the ceremony that makes the crossing honest.

4.10 · Zone 2 — The Operating Plan

*Zone 2 · **the practitioner's coordination layer** · intent, schedule, standing commitments.*

Zone 2 is the practitioner's coordination layer — the formal record of intent, schedule, capacity, and commitment that translates Kitchen Table's daily action into structured accountability. In Headwaters this is the Operating Plan: a living document, not a pitch deck. It holds the practitioner's role, the constellation's rules of engagement, the current pilot's scope, and the standing commitments that Zones 3 and 4 are built on top of. Zone 2 is visited less frequently than Kitchen Table but consulted whenever a new commitment is being made or an existing one is being reviewed.

The rename test.

Rename *Operating Plan* to *business plan* or *strategy doc*. What changes? A business plan is a planning artifact — written once, reviewed periodically, presented to funders. An Operating Plan is a working document updated as the practitioner's actual standing commitments change. The rename collapses the difference between plan and practice, between the artifact that persuades and the document that runs. A strategy doc sits above operations; the Operating Plan is how operations are conducted. The word *operating* in *Operating Plan* does not mean *future intention*. It means *the plan the practitioner is currently executing*.

The practitioner who calls the Operating Plan a business plan will find that funders treat it as one — asking for projections rather than reading commitments, offering feedback on market sizing rather than on standing. The name invites the wrong reading. Keep the word operating in front.

4.11 · Zone 3 — The Co-op

*Zone 3 · **community economic infrastructure** · collective ownership at the constellation's third ring.*

Zone 3 is community economic infrastructure — the institutions that sit between the practitioner and the wider market and hold collective assets on behalf of members. In Headwaters, the Commons zone is a community-owned food hub that sources from local producers, aggregates supply, and distributes to neighbours through a membership model. Zone 3 is not an organizational structure sitting beside the constellation; it is the layer where Zone 0's household abundance becomes Zone 3's community supply, and where the Standby discipline runs at community scale.

The rename test.

Rename *co-op* to *social enterprise* or *nonprofit*. What changes? A social enterprise may or may not have member ownership; a nonprofit sits in a legal structure that explicitly excludes member equity. The co-op has member-owners who have paid shares, hold voting rights, and bear collective responsibility for the institution's health. The difference is structural, not cosmetic. Rename the co-op to *the social enterprise* and the member relationship — the obligation, the equity, the collective accountability — has no word left to live in. Funders use *social enterprise* because it fits their investment frameworks. The co-op resists the rename because *co-op* carries what the funder's word cannot.

The Standby connection.

Zone 3's Standby and Zone 0's Seasonal Shelf are the same discipline at different scales. When Zone 3's Standby activates — a freight disruption, a weather event, a supply failure — it draws directly on the Seasonal Shelf work Zone 0 has already done. The co-op cannot substitute for the household's preparedness, and the household's preparedness cannot substitute for the co-op's distribution capacity. Both states of both systems need to be named, practiced, and connected.

Co-op is the load-bearing word. It names a legal structure, a member relationship, a governance model, and a cultural stance toward collective ownership — all in four letters. Renaming it to something softer does not clarify; it erases.

4.12 · Zone 4 — The Territory

*Zone 4 · **the land** · Walls Farm and Treaty 3 Territory · visited seasonally, sourced from annually.*

Zone 4 is the land itself — the farms, the fields, the Treaty 3 Territory that contains them, and the long-horizon relationship between the community and the land that produces its food. In Headwaters, Zone 4 is Walls Farm: a producing market garden that feeds Zone 3 and Zone 0 and holds the territory's agricultural capacity. Zone 4 is visited seasonally rather than daily, but the visits are the source of Zone 0's abundance and Zone 3's local supply. The connection from Zone 4 to Zone 0 runs through the Bulk Round — the seasonal purchase that fills the Jar Kitchen.

The rename test.

Rename *the territory* to *the supply chain* or *the farm*. What changes? A supply chain is a logistics concept — inputs, outputs, lead times, costs. *The farm* names one parcel. *The territory* names a relationship: the land the community is accountable to, the Treaty the community operates under, the long-horizon stewardship that no supply-chain term can carry. The supply chain can be optimized, rerouted, or replaced. The territory cannot. The rename costs the word everything it was doing.

The practitioner who describes Zone 4 as the supply chain has imported the vocabulary of extraction. The supply chain flows from producer to consumer; the territory holds a relationship that flows in both directions — and the community is accountable to the land, not only dependent on it. The difference is not rhetorical. It is a different practice.

4.13 · Zone 5 — Edge

*Zone 5 · **the wild edge** · harvest, forage, trap, fish · a primary sourcing channel.*

Zone 5 is the wild edge — the territory beyond cultivation, where harvest, forage, trap, and fish are the practitioner's practice. In the permaculture frame, Zone 5 is unmanaged, self-willed, and observed rather than controlled. In the constellation, Zone 5 names the sourcing discipline that brings the wild into the Jar Kitchen: the moose quarter from the fall hunt, the blueberries from the back bush, the walleye from the lake, the spruce tips from the forest margin. Zone 5 is not a supplement. It is a primary sourcing channel with its own vocabulary, its own calendar, and its own relationship with the land.

The rename test.

Rename *wild harvest* or *the wild edge* to *supplemental sourcing* or *subsistence*. What changes? Supplemental sourcing is what a restaurant calls it when the seasonal special comes from a local forager. Subsistence names a survival minimum — the bare floor below which a community cannot fall. Wild harvest names a practice: seasonal, relational, skilled, deliberately scheduled. The Jarista's sourcing vocabulary (§4.4) holds *harvest*, *forage*, *the bulk round*, *the seasonal push* — all of which imply an active practitioner choosing to go to the source on the source's own terms. *Supplemental* and *subsistence* are external assessments of quantity. *Wild harvest* is the practitioner's name for a full system.

The connection to Zone 0.

Zone 5 feeds Zone 0's Jar Kitchen directly. The moose goes into the Harvest Hold; the blueberries go into Preservation Season; the spruce tips go into the fermentation station. The Jarista's vocabulary for Zone 0 was built on Zone 5 abundance. Without naming Zone 5 as a zone — as a primary sourcing layer with its own discipline — the Jar Kitchen's supply chain is invisible, and the codetry practitioner has left the most load-bearing noun in the kitchen unnamed.

The wild edge is not a backup plan. It is not what the household eats when the store is empty. It is what the household eats when the practitioner has built the year around knowing the land's calendar — when the moose come through, when the berries ripen, when the ice makes the fish accessible. Name it as a primary system or it will be managed as a secondary one.

Tool: Author's Desk — all six zones — All six zones read. The constellation doesn't exist until you've written it in your own vocabulary. The Author's Desk holds a prompt for each zone.

Part V · Open Questions

A handbook needs a place where the questions live before they have answers. The chapters in this part are written to be returned to. Each one names a thing the discipline is being asked that the discipline has not yet finished thinking through.

5.1 · Tokenization, and what it does to the noun

Open question · returned to as the answer changes.

Codetry's thesis is that the noun carries the architectural weight. The handbook so far has assumed a human reader: a person whose eye lands on the word *saltbox* and loads the metaphor in one beat. That assumption is becoming partial. The reader codetry's code now has to share itself with — increasingly, the dominant reader by volume — is a model that does not see the word at all. It sees a sequence of sub-word fragments. The question this chapter exists to keep open is what tokenization does to a discipline whose load-bearing material is the whole noun.

The lineage to honour is short and recent. Sennrich, Haddow, and Birch's 2016 paper introduced byte-pair encoding to neural machine translation. SentencePiece generalised it. The GPT line and its descendants made it the default reading layer of the industry. Andrej Karpathy's diagnostic posts on tokenisation made the strange visible — the way "the" and "the" are different tokens, the way leading whitespace re-shapes meaning, the way numbers fragment in ways no human reader would tolerate. The discipline of tokenisation and the discipline of codetry both treat sub-word patterns as structural, but from opposite directions. Tokenisation extracts statistical structure out of fragments. Codetry composes structural meaning into a whole.

The challenge is real.

Tokenisation is the most aggressive *translate the noun* operation that exists. It is sharper than the boundary translations of §DD.3 and stricter than the type-level abstractions of §DD.4 because it operates *below the word*. *Saltbox* becomes ["Salt", "box"]. *Headwaters* may become ["Head", "waters"] or ["He", "ad", "waters"] depending on what the tokeniser

learned. *Watershed* fragments. *Codetry*, being a coined word, fragments hardest of all. The load-bearing weight of a noun-as-noun does not survive the token layer. To the model reading the code, the word is no longer a word.

The challenge is asymmetric.

The fragmenting breaks the noun into pieces. It does not break the relationship between the noun and the structure underneath. Models train on enormous bodies of code in which well-named symbols predict well-shaped implementations. The token cluster `["Salt", "box"]` appearing inside a class definition correlates, statistically, with properties consistent with the saltbox metaphor — not because the model knows what a saltbox is, but because it has read enough saltbox-named code to associate the cluster with metaphor-consistent downstream patterns. *Codetry* survives the token layer through a back door: it makes the noun-to-structure correlation denser and more reliable than generic naming does, and that density is exactly what statistical reading is good at. The discipline does not survive the way it survives a human reader; it survives because the corpus does the recognising on the model's behalf.

Where it actually breaks.

Two places, both worth naming early. The first is the rename test of §3.2. To a human, *Saltbox* → *HouseholdContainer* surfaces drift in one beat — the metaphor dies on contact. To a tokeniser, the rename is one token cluster swapped for another; the model will happily continue with whatever the new cluster's neighbourhood predicts. The discipline's enforcement mechanism does not survive at the token layer. This is the §DD.4 problem one floor down: drift the tokeniser cannot see. The second is corpus-dependence. The back-door survival described above holds only as long as the training corpus retains enough metaphor-respectful code to keep the statistical pattern alive. If the corpus drifts toward generic naming — through autoformatters that strip metaphor, AI-generated boilerplate that defaults to the average word, or *clean code* conventions that punish poetry — the back door narrows. *Codetry*'s machine-readability is, at present, an ecosystem position rather than a self-sufficient property.

What the discipline owes itself in return is unfinished. A token-level rename test that flags drift the type checker and the tokeniser both miss. A corpus-level practice — share the named work openly, refuse the autoformatter's translation, keep the metaphor alive in the public training set. A clearer answer to the question of whether *codetry* is fundamentally a human-reader discipline whose machine-readability is a happy side effect, or a discipline

that should be re-grounded for a tokenised reading layer. None of those answers are written yet. This chapter exists so the question has a home in the handbook rather than living only in the practitioner's head.

Foundational to literate programming, not parallel to it.

There is a move waiting in this chapter the rest of the handbook has been polite about. §DD.2 frames literate programming as the nearest sibling discipline, and §4.2 places it in the lineage codetry honours its work from — both framings are true, and both are too generous to codetry's modesty about its own role. Codetry is, in the harder sense, *foundational* to successful literate programming: not a sibling, but a precondition. Knuth's discipline weaves prose and source into a single document so the reader can follow the reasoning in the medium where the work actually lives — but the woven program only does what its prose says it does to the extent that the *names* inside the source carry the metaphor the prose claims they carry. Without the codetry move, the prose narrates one architecture and the names enact another, and *literate programming* degrades into prose *about* code that has already drifted away from the prose. The rename test of §3.2 is what makes the weave hold; without it, the document is honest about its reasoning and dishonest about its execution at the same time, and the discipline that was supposed to verify by exposing the reasoning ends up exposing reasoning the code no longer obeys.

Name is the layer between type and token.

It is worth being precise about where the discipline actually stands. *Type* lives in the compiler — the layer §DD.4 already names — and is enforced by a machine that does not read English. *Token* lives in the model, the layer this chapter has been circling, and is enforced by a tokeniser that does not read meaning. *Name* sits in the space between them, and is the only layer in the stack where a human author is still the deciding party: the compiler will check what the name is *of*, the tokeniser will fragment what the name is *spelled like*, and only the author chooses what the name *is*. If name is treated as decoration on top of type — as the type system's pet, renameable on a whim because the type is what carries the truth — the in-between layer collapses upward, and the discipline has nothing to do that §DD.4 does not already do. If name is treated as raw material for the tokeniser to chew — as fuel for the statistical reader, valuable only in proportion to how often the cluster ["Salt", "box"] appears in the corpus — the in-between layer collapses downward, and the discipline has nothing to do that the model's pre-training does not already do. The codetry claim is that the in-between layer is real, that it is the load-bearing one, and that it is the only place where authorship of the system's nouns is still possible at all.

Type is the compiler's. Token is the model's. Name is the only layer the human author still owns — and the discipline has nowhere to stand if that layer is not defended.

The token has two meanings, and both rhyme.

The chapter has so far used *token* in the narrow sense the tokeniser gives it: a sub-word fragment, a ["Salt", "box"] cluster, a unit the model reads in the place a word used to be. The word has a second meaning the discipline cannot pretend not to know about. *Token* in the on-chain sense — the unit a community's nouns are turned into when its assets, memberships, votes, or shares of a co-op are placed on a blockchain — is the same word doing structurally analogous work in another domain, and the same hazard rhymes across both. When a community's nouns are tokenised on-chain without a name-layer discipline, the resulting governance primitives are legible only to the people fluent in the substrate: the wallet UIs, the contract addresses, the function signatures, the gas-priced enactments of decisions whose underlying nouns the community never named for itself. That is the precise definition of *technocracy*: rule by those who can read the layer the rest of the community can't. Codetry's bet on the noun is, by extension, a bet against technocratic capture of community-owned systems — the \$1.0 hedge against language drift, generalised one floor up to where the drifted words are the ones with formal authority attached. Without *name* as widely-adopted architecture in the blockchain world, the on-chain token does to a community's *governance* what the LLM token does to its prose: shears the load-bearing noun into fragments only the substrate can read, then reassembles it into a primitive the substrate can act on. The discipline has no ready answer to that move yet, either.

Tokenisation shreds the noun — the model's tokenisation, and the chain's. The discipline's answer, on both fronts, is not yet written. This chapter is a place to keep the question — and to return to it as the tokenisers, the training corpora, the on-chain primitives, and the practice itself change shape.

Tool: Practice Cards — Recall the core ideas, one card at a time. Each card tests whether a concept from the handbook has landed — not just been read.

5.2 · Name as architecture, when the noun goes on-chain

Open question · returned to as the answer changes.

§5.1 closed by naming a second tokenisation, structurally analogous to the first: the *token* the chain mints when a community's assets, memberships, votes, or shares of a co-op are placed on a blockchain. The argument there ended on a hazard rather than an answer — that without a name-layer discipline, on-chain primitives become legible only to the people fluent in the substrate, which is the precise definition of technocracy. That paragraph deserves a chapter of its own. It is not a tail to the LLM-tokenisation argument; it is a separate open question, in the same shape, that the discipline owes itself a place to keep returning to. This is that place.

The §1.0 distinction holds here without amendment. Codetry serves practice, not governance, and the chapter is not arguing that the discipline should expand to design what a community does with its votes, its shares, or its council seat. The hazard is to the noun *substrate* such governance is laid over once that substrate goes on-chain, and the open question is the same §1.0 hedge — protect the words the community already uses — asked at a layer where the words enact authority rather than describe practice. Whether that hedge is held by codetry, by a successor trade (§5.3), or by neither is part of what is open here.

What the on-chain hazard actually is.

The on-chain version of the §5.1 problem is not that the chain is hostile to names. It is that the chain's load-bearing identifiers are addresses and signatures — a contract is `0x` followed by forty hex characters; an interface is `transfer(address,uint256)`; a vote is a transaction whose meaning is whatever the function dispatched at that address happens to do. Names exist on top of this layer as conveniences: an ENS record, a token symbol, a label in a wallet UI, a string field inside a contract that the contract itself does not have to honour. The relationship between *name* and *primitive* on-chain is the inverse of the codetry relationship — the primitive is authoritative, the name is a label on top of it, and the label is replaceable without the primitive shifting underneath. The §DD.4 collapse — *the type is what carries the truth, the name is just decoration* — is the chain's default state, not its failure mode.

What this does to a community whose governance has been placed on such a substrate is exactly what §5.1 named. The members can read *the token, the vote, the share* in their own kitchen-language. The chain reads `0xa0b8...`, `castVote(uint256,uint8)`, `balanceOf(address)`. When the two readings disagree — when the wallet UI says *yes* and the contract dispatches *no*, when the documentation calls a primitive *the council seat* and the bytecode treats it as a transferable ERC-721 — the chain's reading is the one that enacts. The community's noun loses, quietly, on every disagreement. The drift is invisible to anyone who is not fluent in the substrate, which is most of the community by design. That is the technocratic failure §5.1 named, made concrete.

What a name-layer discipline would have to do.

It is worth being honest about how little of this is settled. A name-layer discipline for on-chain governance would, at minimum, have to answer three questions the codetory move already answers in source code, and re-answers under harder constraints here. *Who authors the name.* In source code the answer is the practitioner sitting with the community at the kitchen table; on-chain it is unclear whether the name lives in the contract's metadata, in a registry the community controls, in a wallet UI the community does not control, or in a governance document the chain cannot read. *What the name is bound to.* In source code the binding is enforced by the rename test of §3.2 — change the name, and the metaphor breaks loud enough to hear. On-chain, the binding between *the council seat* and the ERC-721 dispatched at `0xa0b8...` is conventional rather than enforced; nothing in the substrate fails when the two drift. *How the name survives a fork.* Source code forks rarely and visibly; chains fork routinely, and a community whose governance noun is *the share* may wake up to find two chains, two contracts, two `share` tokens, and no discipline that says which of the two carries the noun the community originally named.

On-chain, type is the chain's, token is the chain's, and name has nowhere obvious to live. The §5.1 stack — type, name, token — collapses into two layers, both belonging to the substrate. The name layer is the one the discipline would have to build.

Why this is its own chapter and not a footnote.

§5.1 is about what tokenisation does to a noun the practitioner *wrote*. This chapter is about what tokenisation does to a noun the community *enacts authority through*, which is a different stake. The first hazard is that the discipline's reading public shifts from human to model and the noun-as-architecture move has to survive a statistical reader; the second hazard is that the community's reading public shifts from member to substrate and the noun-as-architecture move has to survive a *technocratic* reader — one whose fluency in the layer is itself the asymmetry of power. The first is a question about whether codetory's machine-readability holds. The second is a question about whether codetory's *bet against drift* — the §1.0 hedge — extends to the layer where drifted words have formal authority attached. They rhyme. They are not the same chapter.

There is a temptation, when the answer is unknown, to fold the question back into a chapter that has more developed material around it. §5.1 is the more developed chapter — it has the rename-test analogy, the corpus-dependence argument, the type/name/token stack — and it would be easy to keep the on-chain thread as a closing movement there. Part VI exists to refuse that move. Open questions get their own chapters here precisely so they can be

returned to as the answer changes, not so they can be domesticated as tails on the chapters that almost-but-not-quite address them. When a name-layer discipline for on-chain governance does start to take shape — in a registry pattern, in a contract convention, in a community's actual practice of binding the noun to the primitive — the place to record it is here, not appended to §5.1.

The three-layer stack — a concrete beginning.

The closest thing this handbook has to a worked answer arrived in the same place as the Standby: in practice, before the theory was ready. The zone gate model — Z0 Dwelling → Z1 Circle → Z2 Workbench → Z3 Community — is built around *rituals of becoming*: named crossings where the practitioner declares a posture change before the system records one. Each crossing is a hat ceremony. The practitioner does not drift from Z1 to Z2; they gear up. The practitioner does not cross from Z2 to Z3 without naming what credential appears at the membrane. The name lives in the ritual, and the ritual lives in the practitioner's body.

The standby guidelines deepen this. The four-rung severity ladder — Advisory, Standby, Active, Standdown — is the community-scale version of the same discipline: posture changes require a named moment, and the name is what makes the moment a crossing rather than a drift. A practitioner who has practiced the Standby at the household level already knows how to hold a posture under pressure. When they reach the Z1→Z2 gate and the system asks *what hat are you putting on*, they are not choosing from a menu. They are activating a posture they have been holding in readiness. The Standby is the training layer. The gate ceremony is the declaration layer.

The blockchain is the enforcement layer. In the human-only model, the gate ceremony depends on the practitioner's memory and discipline — the kids leave the gate open, and bad actors find their way in. The protocol lives in someone's head. On-chain, the gate is a transaction: the crossing requires a signature, the hat is a credential that appears at the membrane and not inside the records on either side, the prohibition between Z1 and Z3 is structural rather than conventional. The protocol does not have to live in someone's head because it lives beneath their feet.

The standby teaches you to hold a posture. The gate asks you to declare it. The chain makes sure you did.

This is not a settled practice. It is the shape of the practice starting to come clear. The three layers — beneath the feet, in the body, in the moment — answer §5.2's question about where the name lives on-chain: it lives in the ritual that precedes the transaction. The name is

what makes the transaction legible to the person signing it. Without the hat ceremony, the transaction is `castVote(uint256,uint8)`. With it, the transaction is *I am crossing as a Representative, speaking for my household in community space, and this signature is my word*. The chain records the signature. The ritual is what the signature means.

Open question, kept open — and now with a shape. There is no settled name-layer practice for on-chain governance primitives, and the gap is the technocracy hazard §5.1 named. The three-layer stack — Standby training, gate ceremony, blockchain enforcement — is the earliest answer this handbook has. Whether the practice that fills the gap belongs inside codetory or, more honestly, in the successor trade §5.3 takes up, is itself part of the open question. This chapter exists to be returned to: when the substrate changes, when a registry pattern earns its place, when a community's practice of authoring the noun-as-primitive becomes specific enough to write down.

5.3 · Name as a trade, practiced through the wisdom keepers

Open question · returned to as the answer changes.

§5.2 closed by saying the discipline does not yet have a name-layer practice for on-chain governance primitives, and that the chapter exists to be returned to when a community's practice of authoring the noun-as-primitive becomes specific enough to write down. The chapter before this one named the *site* and the *wall*. The chapter that follows it has to name the *worker* — what kind of work building a name-layer practice would actually be, and who would do it. If the name layer is the one the discipline would have to build (§5.2), the prior question is what shape the building would take: a credential, a role inside an existing profession, a community elder's extra duty, or a *trade* in the older sense of the word. This chapter is a place to keep the question of the shape of the work itself.

A trade, in the sense bricklaying is a trade.

A trade is what emerges when several industries' outputs only cohere in a *built thing*, and the built thing only holds if one pair of hands knows how all of them behave under load. Bricklaying is the example worth keeping in front of this chapter. The bricklayer is not a brick-maker, not a chemist, not a structural engineer, and not a site planner — but the trade absorbed enough brick chemistry, mortar chemistry, structural reading, site interface, and

apprenticeship pedagogy that the wall it builds holds. A name-layer trade would absorb in the same shape, from at least four tributaries. *Codestry*: the rename test of §3.2, the discipline of choosing a metaphor that constrains the system rather than decorates it, the refusal to let the name collapse upward into the type or downward into the token. *Literate programming*, framed by §5.1 as the precondition the practice rests on rather than the sibling working in the next room: document-as-source, prose as the medium of work, names inside the source carrying the metaphor the prose claims they carry. *Wisdom keeping*: the only existing profession that already does multi-generation name maintenance — knowing who named a place, what the name binds to, what happens to the name when the river reroutes, the clan splits, or the treaty is broken. *Community development*: the practice of asking who is in the room when a noun gets coined, who is not, and what the downstream cost of those absences is. None of those four are the trade. The trade is where their outputs cohere in a wall — the wall being the names a community's institutions and on-chain primitives are bound to, authored and maintained with the intent that those names survive the substrate they were laid on.

Through the wisdom keepers, not by them.

There is a temptation, when naming a practice that has to survive seven generations, to assign the practice to the people who already carry that horizon — the wisdom keepers, the elders, the lineage holders themselves. The temptation should be refused, for the same reason a bricklaying trade is not assigned to master masons: the master mason is not the one laying courses anymore. The master walks the job and catches the wandering line at three courses, not thirty. *By* the wisdom keepers makes the trade their job, which dumps a fresh technical apprenticeship — chains, schemas, registries, fork mechanics, source control, literate-programming tooling — on people already carrying full loads, and risks the trade dying with the keepers because the technical surface moves faster than any one generation can absorb. *Through* the wisdom keepers makes them the source of authority and review, while the day-to-day craft is the apprentice's hands: younger, with the chain literacy and the tooling already in their fingers, but accountable to a master who can say *that name does not sit right with what we know about that creek* and send the apprentice back to relay the course. That is the only version of the trade that scales past the keepers themselves, and it is the only version in which the seven-generation horizon survives the generation that opens it.

The substrate is the site, not the material. Chains are the soil; the names are the wall. The trade is what builds walls that outlast the chain they were laid on.

Calibrated to seven generations, which means refusing the substrate currently in fashion.

A bricklayer's wall is expected to outlast its builder by a century or more. Software's working assumption is that the substrate gets rewritten within a decade, which is why every existing software role is calibrated to the platform currently in fashion — the framework, the chain, the model, the cloud. A name-layer trade calibrated to seven generations would have to refuse that calibration. Not because the substrate is unimportant — §5.2 spent its length making the opposite case — but because the trade's job is to author names that *survive* the substrate, not to specialise in any one of them. The lineage that pedagogy would inherit from is therefore not computer science. The closer analogues are older. *Cartography*: place names that outlast the empires that drew the maps. *Constitutional drafting*: the bind between *the assembly* and the institution it names, across the generations the institution is supposed to last. *Oral lineage itself*: the discipline that already knows how to carry a noun across centuries by holding the practice of who tells it next. §4.2 honours literate programming as the closest sibling in the *technical* lineage codetory sits inside, and that placement is correct for that lineage. The trade lineage — the one a name-layer profession would inherit its pedagogy from — is older than the technical one, and §5.3 is the chapter that owes it the acknowledgement.

Open question, kept open. The trade has no first apprentice yet. Bricklaying did not become a trade by manifesto; it became one because someone laid a course, then a thousand more, under someone who kept calling out the wandering line. The chapter stays open until the apprenticeship begins, and is the place to record what it looks like when it does.

5.4 · Where the flames held and where the corpus burned

Open question · trailblazer's burn line · the §5.1 problem read from a third angle.

On 29 April 2026 the practitioner ran a deliberate boundary test against the corpus. The test was simple in shape and aggressive on purpose: rewrite every chapter into plain grade-9 language, install a banned-vocabulary list — *substrate*, *primitive*, *membrane*, *load-bearing*, *cross-zone*, *vernacular*, *tokenize*, *reify* — replace each banned term inline with a plainer substitute, and ratchet the longest-sentence cap downward in successive passes (110 → 50 → 40 → 35 words) to see how far the prose would compress before something structural gave way. A scanner enforced the constraints. Every chapter passed every check the new

infrastructure imposed. The book also stopped being the book the practitioner had been writing — and *that*, not the passing scanner, was the data the test was run to surface. Trailblazing leaves a burn line. The point of lighting one is to read what survives the flame.

The finding the chapter exists to log is sharp and worth the burn. The eight banned words are not academic decoration on top of a craft that could just as well be described in everyday speech. They are the named primitives the craft is built on. *Load-bearing* is what §1.0 means when it says the noun carries the weight of the building; the metaphor *is* the discipline. *Substrate* is the word §5.1 reaches for when it has to distinguish the layer the cutter eats from the layer the author writes. *Membrane* is what §1.4 calls the gate between rooms before it earns the name *Gate*; *primitive* is the registered category of named pieces in the constellation manifest. Stripping the words and leaving the prose was not a translation; it was a controlled removal of the foundational vocabulary the prose stood on. The new prose was lighter to read because there was less holding it up — which is exactly the structural answer the test was built to surface, and which no amount of in-register inspection of the academic source could have produced. Some non-negotiables only show themselves when you remove them and watch the building lean.

Why this is the §5.1 problem read from a third angle.

§5.1 names a hazard from below: the cutter shreds the noun into sub-word fragments the model can read but the human author cannot author into. §5.2 names the same hazard one floor down: the chain shreds the noun into addresses the bytecode can read but the community cannot author into. The 29 April pass surfaced the same hazard from above: a substitution rule, applied uniformly across the corpus, shredded the named primitives into everyday synonyms the new reader could decode but the discipline could no longer be built out of. A layer that could read at one resolution forced a transformation on a layer authored at another, and the authored layer lost. That is the §5.1 frame, observed from a third angle the practice did not have on paper before the test. The chapter belongs in Part VI for the same reason §5.1 and §5.2 do: the discipline now knows the hazard exists at this third angle and does not yet have a settled answer for it.

What the test established.

Three findings the discipline did not have on paper before the burn. *First*, the eight terms are non-negotiable in the academic register — not because the practitioner is attached to them but because each one carries structural work that no plainer substitute carried after substitution; the building leaned where the named piece had been removed. *Second*, the plain-language register is a *derivative* artifact, not a *replacement* one. The §1.0 line about the kitchen table still holds, and the practitioner still owes the community a book it can sit

with — but the academic register is where the craft's nouns are authored, defined, cross-referenced, and tested against each other, and the plain-language register is what gets carried out of that workshop into the community room. *Third*, authoring the plain register first by stripping the academic one collapses the workshop into the room and leaves nothing in the workshop to carry anything else out of, ever again. The §3.2 rename test catches drift inside a single register. It does not catch the deeper drift the test surfaced — the drift introduced when one register is asked to do the work of two. That is a new test the practice now knows it owes itself.

Two registers, one foundation.

The unfinished work this chapter exists to keep open is the discipline of authoring two registers of the same craft without letting one cannibalise the other. A first sketch, written from the burn's findings: the academic handbook (this volume) is the source, and is allowed — required, in fact — to use *substrate*, *primitive*, *membrane*, *load-bearing*, *cross-zone*, *vernacular*, *tokenize*, and *reify* as named pieces of the craft. A second handbook — the everyday volume the practitioner owes the kitchen table — is authored against the first as a translation, with each named piece carrying a worked-out plain-speech alias and a back-pointer to the academic chapter where the primitive is defined. The plain volume is shorter on purpose. It loses fidelity on purpose. The point is that the loss is *known*, *cited*, and *reversible* — the reader who wants the foundation can follow the back-pointer and find it intact. The hazard the test surfaced is exactly that, in a single-register collapse, the foundation is not preserved anywhere; it is overwritten in place. That is a kind of loss the craft has no recovery move for, except the one the post-test revert just performed.

What the craft owes itself in return is also unfinished, and the next set of boundary tests is already visible. A test that catches a register-collapse before it ships — the §3.2 rename test, lifted one floor up to the level of *which named pieces still live in the corpus at all*. A protocol for the everyday volume's authorship — what gets aliased, what stays in academic form, what is allowed to be dropped, and how the dropping is logged so a future reader can find what the alias is hiding. A clearer answer to whether the academic volume is the correct ground at all, or whether the craft's nouns belong somewhere even more durable — a glossary, a manifest, an oral lineage held by named carriers — that both volumes refer back to. None of those answers are written yet. They are the boundary tests the practice now knows it has to run. This chapter is here so the finding is *in* the handbook — logged in the ledger of what has been deliberately set alight to find out what the discipline is actually made of.

The trailblazer's rule, written from the 29 April burn: the non-negotiables of codetory are found by lighting up the boundary and reading what survives the flame. Eight named primitives — substrate, primitive, membrane, load-bearing, cross-zone, vernacular, tokenize, reify — are the beams that held. The single-register simplification rule is the structure that burned. The next move is not to fear the next burn but to log this one in the ledger, restore the foundation it tested, and author the everyday volume separately on top of the restored academic source — knowing now, on evidence, that the academic register cannot be the everyday register's substrate by being replaced into it.

5.5 · The inspector and the act that has two faces

Open question · the role the discipline has been doing without naming · two-sided act in the gate/standby family.

§5.4 closed by saying the next set of boundary tests is already visible and the practice owes itself a name for what runs them. The work has been done in the corpus from the beginning — *the rename test* of §3.2, the trailblazer's burn of §5.4, the bricklayer's master of §5.3 calling out the wandering line three courses in — but the role doing the work has not been named. This chapter names it. The role is *the inspector*. The act the inspector performs has the same structural shape as *the gate* (§2.9) and *the standby* (§2.8): one named primitive, two faces. Where the standby's two *states* are temporal — the infrastructure is constant; the system moves between resting and activated — and the gate's two *sides* are contextual — both face the membrane at once, each from its own legitimate vocabulary — the inspector's two faces are *operational*. The inspector certifies a name is load-bearing *by* pulling on it, and pulls on a name *in order to* certify what holds. The pull is the certification. The bind is the result of a successful pull. One inspection, two readings.

Why the role is called the inspector and not something else.

The construction-trade resonance is the one the corpus is reaching for. *Inspector* in §1.5's hempcrete frame is the trade member who walks the wall, taps the cured course to hear whether it sounds bound, presses against the infill to read whether the lime took, and certifies the wall as load-bearing on the strength of those acts. The regulatory connotation — the building-code official sent from outside to confirm the work meets a published standard — is not the reading wanted here. The inspector named in this chapter is internal to the trade: the practitioner certifying their own and their peers' courses, accountable to

the §5.3 wisdom keepers above and to the seven-generation horizon those keepers carry. The trade's discipline is what registers the certification; the regulator's stamp does not. Near-variants — *the keeper*, *the journeyman*, *the wall-reader* — were considered and set aside for losing the construction-trade resonance §1.5 already commits the corpus to. *Inspector* keeps the resonance and is disambiguated here in one paragraph rather than worked around.

The inspector's act in three intensities.

The same act presents in three calibrated intensities the corpus already has worked examples for. *Light pull* — the §3.2 rename test. The inspector substitutes one word for the named primitive, watches what shifts in the surrounding mechanics, and certifies the bind on the strength of what failed and what held. The intensity is low because the substrate around the test is intact; the test is a single course poked. *Sustained pull* — the §5.3 master walking the apprentice's job and calling out the wandering line three courses in. The intensity is steady, low-grade, and continuous; the certification is the apprentice being sent back to relay the course. *Aggressive pull* — the §5.4 burn. The inspector substitutes against an entire register of named primitives at corpus scale, watches the wall lean, and certifies — by the leaning — which terms were binder and which were decoration. The intensity is the highest the trade has language for; the recovery is the §5.4 revert and the chapter that records what the test surfaced. Three intensities, one act, one role.

Three drift types and the three responses.

The wall the inspector walks is built to last seven generations, which is a horizon long enough that drift has time to take three structurally distinct shapes. *Slow drift* is entropy: the lime binder thinning at the joins, the prose around a named primitive going un-re-pointed for a season, the team's shared sense of what *the standby* is certified to mean drifting half a degree off true with each handoff. The inspector's response is the everyday one — re-point the binder, refresh the surrounding prose, run the rename test as routine maintenance rather than as event. *Kind drift* is well-meaning maintenance done without trade knowledge: the vapour barrier installed on the wrong face of the wall, the modern acrylic painted over the lime render, the simplification rule applied across the corpus by a practitioner who did not read the wall as hempcrete first. §5.4 is the corpus's first formally logged instance. The inspector's response is to intercept at the brief — to veto the kind-but-wrong move before it ships, with the trade reasoning written down so the next inspector inherits both the veto and the why. *Adversarial drift* is rarer and louder: the deliberate renaming of a load-bearing primitive for political or commercial advantage, the wholesale substitution of an acquirer's vocabulary over the corpus, the regime change that wraps the

wall in vinyl siding until the hempcrete underneath does no work. The inspector's response is *witnessing* — documenting in a form the §5.3 trade lineage can carry across the regime change, so the wall's load-bearing structure is recoverable by a future generation that comes back to it.

The discipline does not fail to vandals. It fails to kind people without trade knowledge, and to the slow weather of years no one was re-pointing against.

The role the gate plays, precisely.

§2.9 names *the gate* as the membrane between *the bright side* and *the systems* — two legitimate vocabularies meeting at a controlled crossing. §3.3 already closes by saying *drift caught at the gate is drift caught*, which is the corpus saying — without yet naming the role — that the gate is the most expensive but most reliable place to catch a kind-drift edit on its way out. The relationship the corpus has been carrying without naming is structural: the gate is a *location*, and the inspector is the *role* that makes the gate function as a gate rather than a door. Without an inspector standing at it, the gate decays into a doorway anyone can walk through. The two are paired; neither alone is the defense. A gate without an inspector catches no drift. An inspector without a gate has nowhere along the wall to stand and read what is crossing. §2.9 and this chapter are reading the same primitive from two angles — the gate names where the membrane is; this chapter names who certifies what crosses through it.

Where the inspector comes from.

The inspector role is not acquired by reading. It is acquired by the kind of generalist apprenticeship that puts a practitioner through enough terrain to recognise, when a load-bearing piece appears, that it is load-bearing. §5.3 names the trade lineage the role would inherit pedagogy from — cartography, constitutional drafting, oral lineage — and refuses the temptation to assign the trade to the wisdom keepers themselves. What §5.3 leaves open is the prior question this chapter is the right place to answer: where the apprenticeship that produces the apprentice's hands actually comes from. Codetry's first inspector apprenticed for fifteen years to *Jack Spirko* — *Son of Thunder*, *The Survival Podcast* — already named first in §IV's four teachers. What that apprenticeship transmitted is not a checklist and not a worldview. It is a sense of control and empowerment held against the everyday assumption that control belongs upward. It is a pattern-recognition lens trained across enough subjects — preparedness, food, energy, shelter, communication, finance, community organisation — that the *shape* of a load-bearing piece becomes legible across terrains that look unrelated to

a specialist eye. And it is the discipline of using *the computer between the ears* over a fifteen-year horizon to hold questions and patterns in a working set the practitioner cannot always articulate but can return to when the surrounding tools catch up. Spirko's tagline — *for if times get tough or even if they don't* — is §1.3's *both-states* principle written into time itself, applied not to the plumbing of a single primitive but to the historical conditions under which the discipline has to keep working. The handbook named in this volume is what the questions held in the back of the practitioner's mind for fifteen years grew into when the surrounding computational and authorship tools finally surfaced enough to put them on paper. The lineage is owed the acknowledgement here, in the chapter where the role doing the work is finally named.

Who the inspector serves.

The discipline does not exist to recruit the practitioner into a politics. It exists to give the practitioner — and the practitioners working alongside them in the same lineage since 2009 — practical tools for rebuilding the substance of the institutions they live in, on terms they themselves set, in places they already are. The base the practice is most directly accountable to has been doing this work for a decade and a half: building food systems, building shelter, building local money, building peer-to-peer organisation, building family-scale resilience under whatever political weather the surrounding country was running. The shortage was never problems. The shortage was tools — and specifically, tools at the *name layer* of the institutions being built, which is the layer the surrounding software and policy traditions have left chronically under-served. The handbook is for those people first. It is grounding rather than agitating, practical rather than ideological, solution-oriented rather than position-taking. The choice between *anarchism*, *libertarianism*, *conservatism*, *agorism*, and any neighbouring posture is one the discipline has no authority to make and no interest in making. Those are choices about what to be; codetry is the substance choices of any of those shapes have to be built out of if they are meant to last more than one generation of the people holding them. The inspector serves the wall, not the politics the wall is enclosing.

Open question, kept open.

The trade has its first inspector — the practitioner authoring this handbook. The chapter is open until the apprenticeship of the second one begins. Whether inspector standing transfers through the §5.3 wisdom-keeper line, through peer certification inside the four-teacher lineage, through some formal pedagogy the trade has not yet built, or through some combination of the three is the open question this chapter exists to be returned to. What the chapter establishes for the record now: the role exists, the act has two faces, the three drift types each call for a different response, the gate is the structural location and the inspector is the role that makes it function, and the apprenticeship is generalist before it is specific.

5.6 · Inspector standing — the right that cannot be negotiated away

Open question · second-order non-negotiable · entrenchment of the inspection itself.

§5.5 names the inspector as the role that certifies a named piece holds by pulling on it. This chapter names the second-order condition that role depends on. Codetry has two tiers of non-negotiability, and both are load-bearing. *First-order non-negotiables* are the binder spec — the eight named primitives §5.4 burned to surface (*substrate, primitive, membrane, load-bearing, cross-zone, vernacular, tokenize, reify*), the third-actor frame, the additive-only posture, the academic register as the workshop floor for the craft's nouns, and *verify, don't trust* as the working stance toward proposed additions. These are *what* the binder is made of. *Second-order non-negotiable* — singular — is *inspector standing*: the inspector's right to maintain the first-order list, to add to it as new failure modes are discovered, and to refuse to negotiate the right itself away under pressure, persuasion, or convenience. This is not what the binder is made of; it is *who is permitted to specify what the binder is made of*, and the answer the discipline now writes down is *the inspector, and the right cannot be surrendered*. *Cannot be surrendered* and *cannot be passed on* are different claims; this chapter is about the first. Succession to the next inspector — how the right travels from one trade member to the next when the trade is working as intended — is the open question this chapter holds for §5.6's closing callout. The non-negotiability is against giving the right away under pressure, persuasion, or convenience, not against the trade's own succession protocol.

Why the second tier matters more than the first.

Most failed disciplines fail at the second-order tier. People rarely vote to remove their non-negotiables outright; the loss of attention required to assemble that vote is too visible and the resistance is too organised. What people do vote for, often unanimously and often with the best of intentions, is the removal of the inspector's standing to enforce them — *just for this case, just for this quarter, just while the funding closes, just until the new owner settles in*. The downstream effect is the same as removing the binder spec outright: the inspector cannot intercept the next kind-drift edit, cannot witness against the next adversarial substitution, cannot re-point the next slow-drift weathering, because the standing to do any of those acts has been temporarily — and then, by precedent, permanently — surrendered. The second tier is where the real defense sits. An attacker who can defeat it does not need to fight the first tier; the first tier dissolves on its own once the role with standing to maintain it is gone.

Additive-only as a second-order non-negotiable hiding in plain sight.

The handbook's standing rule for edits — *additive only* — is not a stylistic preference. It is a second-order non-negotiable the corpus has been carrying for some time without flagging as such. The binder spec can grow but cannot quietly shrink. New primitives can be added; existing ones cannot be removed by single-pass edit. This is what makes *verify, don't trust* safe to add as a working stance: the addition is permanent in the sense that no later substitution can dissolve it without an inspection trail visible enough for a future inspector to read what was removed and why. *Additive-only* is the structural property that protects the binder spec from kind drift attacking it one item at a time. It belongs in this chapter rather than in §5.5 because it is not an act the inspector performs; it is a property of the standing the inspector holds — a property that travels with the role and that a later inspector inherits intact.

Standing as the precondition for all three responses at once.

§5.5 names three drift types — slow, kind, adversarial — and three responses — re-point, veto, witness. Each of the three responses is conditional on the inspector's standing to perform it. *Re-pointing* requires the standing to spend trade time on a wall the surrounding institution does not visibly need re-pointed; without standing, the re-pointing is the first activity cut when budgets tighten. *Vetoing a kind-but-wrong edit* requires the standing to refuse a change everyone in the room agrees would be an improvement; without standing, the veto is overruled by collegiality. *Witnessing against an adversarial substitution* requires the standing to keep documenting what was load-bearing after the new vocabulary has shipped; without standing, the witness is dismissed as backward-looking. Inspector standing

is not a defense against one drift type. It is the precondition for *any* of the three responses to be available at all. That is why it sits at the second tier: it is the load-bearing piece holding all three first-tier responses up.

The §5.4 finding restated through standing.

§5.4 logged the 29 April burn as a recoverable lapse in the academic register. The chapter's surface finding is that the eight named primitives are non-negotiable; the deeper finding, available now from the vantage of this chapter, is that the lapse was recoverable *only* because the second-order tier was held intact. The practitioner who applied the simplification rule was the same practitioner who reverted it — the standing to revert had not been surrendered, and so the revert was a single act inside the inspector's existing authority rather than a campaign requiring permission from somewhere else. The discipline survived its own most aggressive test against itself because the right to inspect the test's outcome had not been surrendered before the test was run. The chapter lesson §5.6 owes the corpus is the inverse: a single permanent surrender of the second-order tier ends the discipline regardless of what the first-tier list says, because the list cannot defend itself.

The right to inspect cannot be negotiated away, because giving it away is the failure mode the inspection exists to prevent. Inspector standing is the second-order non-negotiable the first-order non-negotiables depend on; surrender of the second tier ends the discipline whether the first-tier list is amended or not.

What standing protects, for the people the discipline serves.

The base the discipline is most directly accountable to — the practitioners who have been building food, shelter, money, and community since 2009, on terms they themselves set, in places they already live — does not need a politics imposed from above and is not asking for one. What that base needs, and has been short of, is *the right to author and maintain the substance of the institutions they are building, in vocabulary they themselves set, across the generations the institutions are meant to last*. That right is what inspector standing names. It is not a political position; it is the structural condition under which any political position the practitioners might choose — *anarchism, libertarianism, conservatism, agorism*, or any other — has a chance of staying bound to its meaning across more than one generation of the people holding it. The discipline does not pick the politics. The discipline keeps the binder cured so the wall the politics is built into stays a wall. The lineage's standing

observation is *push a free man hard enough and watch what he does*; the discipline's structural answer is *keep the right to inspect his own substance unsundered, and watch what he builds*.

Open question, kept open.

The chapter records the structure now — two tiers, second tier load-bearing, additive-only as the property that protects the first-tier list from quiet erosion — and leaves open the question of how second-tier standing transfers to the trade's next inspector. §5.3 names the wisdom-keeper line as the source of authority and review for the first-tier list; §5.5 names the generalist apprenticeship as the source of the inspector's hands. Whether second-tier standing — the right itself, distinct from the trade skill — transfers through the same two channels, through a third the trade has not built yet, or through some combination, is the open question this chapter exists to be returned to as the answer becomes available.

5.7 · Pioneer training

Open question · who this work is for · the calm before the storm.

This is the calm before the storm.

Sons and daughters of thunder.

We are the sons and daughters of thunder — those who have stood for years at the headwaters, holding back the flood not to stop it, but to learn its rhythm, its force, its promise. We did not dam the future; we studied it. We prepared.

How the instruments are built.

The kits and tools in this handbook are not derived from theory. They move the other way. We begin with what people are already doing and already struggling with — at the kitchen table, in the household, in the small group — and we watch. We watch what helps, what keeps leaking, what quietly holds even when no one has named it yet. Only when a pattern has proven itself across independent encounters with the same terrain does it get shaped into an instrument and passed on.

The method has a name.

The formal term is Grounded Theory — a research discipline that refuses to begin with a hypothesis and earns its conclusions instead by asking whether the pattern keeps appearing when you look for it across real, independent attempts at the same problem. The sons and daughters of thunder do not need the academic name to practise the method. They are already practising it whenever they trust what they have lived over what they have read. The name is offered here not to impress but to make the claim verifiable: this is not intuition dressed as method. It is a recognised discipline with a body of literature, and it produces the same results when applied honestly by anyone willing to start with real life rather than a whiteboard.

We trust the kitchen table more than the whiteboard. The useful tool has to earn its place by working in ordinary life before it is written down and passed on.

Why the Rename Test exists.

Every kit in this handbook carries a Rename Test — a check that asks whether the person holding the tool can put it in their own words, for their own community, without losing the function. That test is not a formality. It is the method keeping itself honest. A tool that cannot survive renaming has not been grounded. It is still theory. The Rename Test is the mechanism by which the discipline stays rooted in what people can actually use — and why the power the sons and daughters of thunder carry is verifiable, not assumed.

The icon is a ship.

The Headwaters icon is a ship. Not a fortress. Not a temple. A vessel — trim, seaworthy, ready to leave the known shore. AI is the new territory: vast, unmapped, alive with both peril and possibility. Literate programming — the practice of writing code so the human logic drives the machine, not the other way around — is only the first small sail on that horizon, a tiny blip of clarity in an ocean of code. It still lacks shape. It still needs hands — many hands — practicing, refining, grounding it in reality.

Who the work belongs to.

This work belongs to well-grounded individuals who prize self-sovereignty and refuse aggression. It calls to big hearts, restless minds, and artists who understand that the most powerful tools are also the most beautiful when shaped by care.

We are not late to this frontier. We are the ones who kept the headwaters while the world slept. Now we launch.

5.8 · Sponsors and experts — base first, then networking outward

Open question · how the trade grows without losing its ground.

The pioneer journey will at some point be visited. Sponsors will offer to stand behind the work materially; experts will offer to stand beside the work in their own discipline. The question this chapter exists to keep open is when that traffic begins, in what order, and what the standing rule is for letting it in. The discipline records the pattern now, before the visitors arrive, so the order is structural rather than improvised.

The base is people, not infrastructure.

The base the chapter refers to is not a follower count, a subscriber list, or a marketing channel. It is the practitioner's own circle — the people already doing the work in the same physical territory, on terms they themselves set, in lineage with the four teachers §4.1 names. That base earns the right to extend invitation by walking the path themselves first, and only then inviting a second cohort whose completion of the same stations will, in turn, earn the standing to issue further invitations. Base now; cohort as the path is walked; only then the visitors who arrive on the standing the cohort has built. The phrasing is *base, then cohort, then visitors*, in that order, and the order is the discipline.

Sponsors stand behind. Experts stand beside.

A sponsor stands behind the work materially — funding, materials, a workshop floor, time off another job, the loan of a tool the trade does not yet own. An expert stands beside the work in their own discipline — a builder who has spent thirty years framing, a midwife who has caught a thousand babies, an accountant who has kept a small business honest across three recessions. The two roles are not the same and the chapter resists collapsing them. A sponsor whose money becomes the basis on which their expertise is then accepted is the failure mode §5.6 named about inspector standing being negotiated away under pressure; the discipline records the names separately so the failure mode can be named separately, and so the inspector can refuse the conflation when it is offered.

What 'visit' means on the path.

A visit is bounded. A visitor leaves a single short note at one station — not a tour of all of them, not a curriculum, not a relationship the path conscripts on the practitioner's behalf. The note is in the visitor's own voice, attributed to the visitor and to the role (sponsor or expert), and visible to anyone walking that station thereafter. The bounded surface is the structural protection: a visitor cannot accidentally become the path's primary voice because there is no place on the path for a primary visitor voice to live. The path is the practitioner's; the visit is the visitor's; the line between the two stays drawn.

Phasing is not optional.

The temptation, once the pattern is named, is to network early — to invite sponsors before the base has walked the path, on the reasoning that visible sponsorship will draw the base in. The chapter records this as the failure mode the chapter exists to name. Networking before the base is real produces the inverse of the intended effect: the base reads sponsor-first as a recruitment campaign and stays away, the path is then walked primarily by visitors with no base, and the discipline loses the people whose practice it was supposed to be in service of. The §5.7 framing of *holding the headwaters back while the world slept* is the same pattern in a different register — the calm came first, the launch comes second, and the order cannot be reversed without surrendering the calm.

What the path records now.

The Pioneer Path data structure now carries an optional *visitors* slot on every station, capable of holding a list of named sponsors and experts with their role and a single short note in their own voice. The slot is empty on every station at the time of writing. The empty state is the chapter's argument made visible: there are no visitors yet because the base has not yet walked the path, and the discipline records the absence rather than papering over it with placeholder names. As the base walks the stations and earns the standing to invite, real visitors will be added one at a time, and the populated state will be the discipline's milestone — recorded in the same field the empty state is recorded in now.

The visitor surface is empty by design. Sponsors and experts are added as the practitioner's own circle walks the path and earns the standing to invite the second cohort, and as that cohort in turn earns the standing to host visitors. The empty state is the discipline; the populated state is the milestone.

5.9 · Lodge, Path A, and Zone 4 — three open questions, two resolved, one still held

Open question · partially resolved May 2026 · Lodge still pending the rename test.

This chapter opened with three naming decisions the workspace was running ahead of handbook adjudication. Two have been resolved by the practitioner in session. One — Lodge — remains open pending the codetory rename test. The chapter records all three, with their resolution status, so the discipline knows what is confirmed and what is still being held.

Path A — resolved. The return flow.

Path A is confirmed as the *return flow* — the direction Zone 4 → Zone 5, distinct from Paths B, C, and D which all run Zone 5 → Zone 4. A Zone 4 project that graduates Zone 3, runs its full cycle, and floats surplus vocabulary or lived experience back out to Zone 5 as founding drift. The successful community project seeds the Shallows with its hard-won language so the next Nursery group has something real to wade into — not a consultant's framing, not a funder's vocabulary, but the words the people who actually did it used to describe what they built. Path A is the return current. It is how the watershed replenishes the Shallows instead of only drawing from it.

Zone 4 as two models — resolved. One zone, one role, two lenses.

The apparent tension between Zone 4 as *Arc* (individual producer transition, conventional → regenerative) and Zone 4 as *The Clearing* (voluntary collective formation) is resolved: *Arc* was an earlier lens that named Zone 4 from the vantage of a single producer's trajectory. That framing has been superseded. Zone 4 is now understood as *voluntary informal association* — small groups of people finding each other around an idea and beginning to organize, without contracts, without board authority, without an exchange. The abattoir pilot and the pilot farm operation are still valid Zone 4 examples, now understood as one expression of that voluntary formation process rather than the defining one. Zone 4 has been renamed The Clearing in the constellation data to reflect this.

The full flow the practitioner confirmed: Zone 5 (wild idea) → Zone 4 (informal group shapes and semi-organizes it) → Zone 3 board votes to approve → Zone 3 pushes a contract to Zone 2 (practitioner is paid to do the work) → work passes back to Zone 3 to operate and sustain → Zone 4 participants see collective benefit. Most people stay only in Zone 4 and see modest collective benefit. Some people also carry Zone 2 work — they have connective value across

zones and benefit out both ends. The Zone 2 contractor is hired by Zone 3 to do the work the Zone 4 group organized; they are not the same role, even when the same person holds both.

Lodge — resolved. The rename test holds.

Lodge is confirmed. The rename test was run against three candidates: *Membership*, *Profile*, and *Household ID*. All three crack on contact.

Membership imports a dues-and-benefits frame — a membership can be public, can be enrolled in, can be tracked in a ledger. A membership tool gets built with a sign-up flow and a benefits page. Lodge is not something you enroll in; it is something you are brought into. *Profile* imports the social-media posture of public self-presentation — a profile shows you outward, to someone outside the circle. Profile tools become bios, follower counts, public visibility settings. Lodge does not present you outward; it holds you inward, among the people who already know you're there. *Household ID* imports the government-register posture of official identity — an ID is recognized by systems and institutions, not by people. Household ID tools become verification flows, KYC steps, login credentials. Lodge is recognized by the keeper of the door and the people behind it, not by a system checking a database.

Lodge is confirmed as the Zone 1 identity layer name. What the name carries that none of the alternatives do: private (not public, not institutional), earned by invitation (not enrolled, not registered), held by a group with shared values (not by a platform, not by a regulator), revocable by the keeper of the door (not by a terms-of-service update). All three substitutes would quietly change what Zone 1 tools get built. Lodge is load-bearing.

Part DD · Deep Dives

Optional deeper reading — you do not need this section to begin practising. If you understand what codetry is and you are ready to use it, go directly to the Field Ledger or set the book down and begin. These seven chapters are here for practitioners who want to know

exactly how codetry differs from the disciplines it most closely resembles. Return when a question of intellectual lineage arises.

DD.1 · Different from code poetry

You have permission to skip this section entirely. If you understand what codetry is and you are ready to practise it, the Field Ledger is the next stop — or set the book down and begin. These chapters are for the practitioner who wants to know precisely how codetry stands in relation to the disciplines it most resembles. They are not required reading; they are a depth resource to return to when a question of lineage arises.

There is a real, decades-old tradition called *code poetry* — going back to Perl in the late 1980s, through the Stanford Code Poetry Slam, Mez Breeze, Nick Montfort, and Ishac Bertran's *code {poems}* anthology. That tradition is about the source code itself being a poem: programs that are also valid verse, lines arranged for sound or terseness, the aesthetics of what is on the page in the editor. Beautiful tradition. Adjacent and respected.

But the poem in code poetry lives *inside* the source. In codetry the poem lives as the architecture, and the source is what makes it run.

Code poetry's place in codetry's awareness is named in §4.2: it is the adjacent tradition the lineage chapter meets first — *adjacent and respected*, in the chapter's words, rather than a root — and the contrast named there (source as poem versus naming as architecture) is the one that clears the ground before §4.2 goes on to name the disciplines codetry actually sits on top of.

Code poetry: the source is the poem. Codetry: the naming is the architecture, and the source is what makes the naming hold.

DD.2 · Different from literate programming

The other discipline codetry gets confused with — and the one that has more pull on serious readers — is literate programming. Donald Knuth named it in 1984. He built WEB and CWEB, the tangle and weave tools that let prose and source live in one document and be

extracted into either a typeset article or a working program. Org-mode Babel, Jupyter, R Markdown, and Quarto are its modern descendants.

Both disciplines insist that words around the code do load-bearing work. What each one names as the load-bearing word, and where each one places the unit of care, is the contrast worth drawing here; §5.1 returns to the relationship between the two disciplines once that contrast is on the page, and finds it less symmetric than this chapter first allows.

Literate programming makes the document the source.

Prose explains; code is generated from the prose. The unit of care is the explanation. The reader is meant to read the program the way they would read an essay, and the typeset output is what the discipline is for.

Codetry makes the metaphor the source.

Naming carries the architecture; the code is the medium that makes the metaphor real, clickable, runnable. The unit of care is the name. The reader is meant to *use* the program and find that the metaphor is doing structural work — that the name a user types is the same name a column in the database carries, the same name the test fixture asserts on.

Knuth's discipline is named here with the same respect already extended to code poetry. It is older, it is deeper in the literature, and both it and codetry are *don't trust; verify* moves: show your work in the medium where the work actually lives. Literate programming verifies by exposing the reasoning. Codetry verifies by making the metaphor inspectable in the name itself. The temptation in this chapter is to leave it there, with the two disciplines doing parallel work in adjacent rooms — and the contrast above does hold at the level of *what each discipline is for*. The relationship between them is taken up again, less politely, in §5.1: the woven document only does what its prose says it does to the extent that the names inside the source carry the metaphor the prose claims they carry, which makes the discipline that holds those names a precondition for the weave rather than a sibling to it.

Literate programming's place in codetry's lineage is named in §4.2: it is not only the nearest discipline in the prior literature but the one codetry sits one floor underneath rather than across the room from, and Knuth's *don't trust; verify by showing the reasoning in the medium where the work lives* is the closest single move in the prior literature to the discipline of making the metaphor inspectable in the name itself.

DD.3 · Different from DDD and Conway's Law

The third discipline codetory gets confused with — and the one that has the deepest pull on readers from the mainstream software-engineering tradition — is the lineage that runs from Conway's Law to domain-driven design. Melvin Conway named the law in 1968: any system reflects the communication structure of the organisation that built it. Eric Evans named domain-driven design in his 2003 book; Vaughn Vernon, the ThoughtWorks crowd, and the bounded-context, ubiquitous-language vocabulary that came after are all in this room.

Codetory shares ancestry with both. All three accept the same uncomfortable premise: structure outside the code shapes structure inside the code, and pretending otherwise is how systems quietly go wrong.

Conway's Law observes the mirror.

Conway's move was descriptive. He noticed that the shape of a team prints itself onto the shape of its software, whether anyone meant it to or not. The discipline that grew from that — inverse Conway, team topologies — is the practice of arranging the org chart on purpose so the system you get is the system you wanted.

Domain-driven design works the mirror.

DDD takes the next step and says: name the model after the language the domain experts already use. The *ubiquitous language* is meant to live in the conversation, the whiteboard, and the code at once. Bounded contexts mark where one such language ends and another begins. Done well, this is real respect for the world the software is for.

The relationship between codetory and DDD is taken up again, less politely, in §4.2: DDD is not only a sibling discipline but one of the *roots* codetory sits on top of, and the *ubiquitous language* clause is the closest single phrase in the prior literature to the move codetory asks of every individual noun.

Codetory takes the stricter stance.

Codetory agrees that the language outside the code should be the language inside the code, and then asks a harder question: *whose language?* DDD typically lands on the domain expert — the analyst, the consultant, the senior engineer who has just spent a week in workshops tidying the vocabulary up. Codetory insists the noun must come from the community itself, in the form the community already uses it, before any tidying.

Which means translation away from that noun — even into a cleaner, more general, more reusable noun — is treated as *drift*, not as cleanup. The moment a *saltbox* becomes a *household container* in the schema, the architecture has slipped, even if every test still passes. The codetry-test exists because that slip is invisible to the type checker and obvious to the person who handed you the word.

Conway and DDD ask whose org shapes the system. Codetry asks whose word survives the schema — and treats every translation away from it as drift.

DD.4 · Different from type-driven design

The fourth discipline codetry gets confused with — and the one that has the strongest pull on readers from the typed-functional tradition — is type-driven design and its rallying cry, *make illegal states unrepresentable*. Yaron Minsky's essays out of Jane Street, Richard Feldman's Elm work, and Scott Wlaschin's *Domain Modeling Made Functional* are all in this room. The conviction is the same across the lineage: the model is the architecture, and the model is whatever the type system lets you say.

Codetry shares that conviction. Both disciplines accept that the model carries the weight, and both refuse the older arrangement where the model is a thin layer of records and the architecture lives in the procedures around them.

Type-driven design puts the load on the type.

The discipline pushes every invariant the domain demands into the type signature. A non-empty list is its own type. A validated email is its own type. An *Order* that has been *Paid* is structurally different from an *Order* that has not, so the function that ships it cannot be called on the unpaid one. The type checker becomes the first reader of the domain, and the bugs that slip past it are the only bugs left.

Codetry puts the load on the name.

Codetry agrees that the model carries the architecture, and then asks the harder question: *whose word is on the type?* A perfectly typed `HouseholdContainer` with a non-empty `Items` list and an immutable `CreatedAt` is, by every type-driven measure, a beautiful model. It is also, by codetry's measure, drifted — because the community said *saltbox*, and the type system

has quietly translated the word into something more general on the way to making the invariants legible. The illegal state was made unrepresentable; the load-bearing noun was made unrecognisable.

Type-driven design verifies the model against the compiler. Codetry verifies the model against the person who handed you the word. Both are *don't trust; verify* moves; they verify against different witnesses.

Type-driven design's place in codetry's awareness is named in §4.2 as a near neighbour inside the broader *the model carries the architecture* lineage: both disciplines refuse the older arrangement where the model is a thin layer of records, and the distinction §4.2 maps — the type system as witness versus the person who handed you the word — is where the two disciplines part ways inside the same conviction.

Type-driven design makes illegal states unrepresentable. Codetry makes drifted nouns unshippable — and treats a perfectly typed model with the wrong word as drift the type checker can't see.

DD.5 · Different from capital allocation at scale

The fifth discipline codetry gets confused with comes from finance, not software. It is the founder-as-allocator school that treats capital allocation as the highest economic act — Mises in 1920, Hayek after, and the modern entrepreneur lineage that runs through Silicon Valley sit in this room.

The conviction is sharp. Resources are finite; uses are infinite. The person closest to a real problem, taking real risk on their own balance sheet, allocates better than a committee that does not. Profit is the signal that the bet was right; a loss is the signal it was wrong.

Codetry agrees with the calculation point. A central planner cannot see what the people on the ground see. The information that decides where the next dollar should go lives in the room where the work happens, not in a head office. Both disciplines accept that the local reader sees what the distant planner cannot.

Capital allocation at scale wants the allocator to keep allocating.

The school's success story is the founder who allocates well and then keeps allocating, on a bigger and bigger pile, for as long as they live. The exit is to compound. The community around the founder is a counterparty, not a successor.

Codetry wants the allocator to make themselves replaceable.

The practitioner takes personal risk, reads the local information, runs a P&L. So far the disciplines agree. Then they part ways: the practitioner is paid to write the method down so the community can run the work without them.

The exit is handover, not compound. The book the practitioner ships is the work, not the brand. A successful practitioner is one the community no longer needs in the chair; a successful founder-allocator is one whose chair grows.

Both schools agree that profit is a signal. They disagree on who reads it. Capital allocation at scale reads the signal at the cap table. Codetry insists the signal must also be readable at the kitchen table — the cost stack, the markup, the truck cost on a page the household sees.

The capital-allocation tradition's place in codetry's awareness is named in §4.2 through the premise both schools share: the local reader sees what the distant planner cannot, and the distinction §4.2 holds is the exit — compound versus handover, the growing chair versus the written method the community can run without the author.

Capital allocation at scale wants the best allocator to keep allocating. Codetry wants the best allocator to write down how, and then leave the chair to the community that owns the work.

DD.6 · Different from XP and the system metaphor

The sixth discipline codetry shares ancestry with is the agile lineage that Kent Beck started with *Extreme Programming Explained* in 1999. XP built one of the most consequential pieces of codetry-shaped work in the prior literature without naming it as such: the practice called *system metaphor*.

XP's original twelve practices included *system metaphor* as a load-bearing element. The team agrees on a single shared overarching metaphor for the system — a naming spine that disciplines the whole codebase. Every object, every method, every boundary takes its name from the same metaphor, so a reader moving from the schema to the UI to the tests hears one coherent story throughout.

What happened to the system metaphor practice.

It was the first XP practice most teams dropped. The agile mainstream quietly set it aside — it was hard to explain, hard to evaluate in a retrospective, and it produced the most visible arguments on a team that could not agree on what the metaphor should be. Kent Beck later

acknowledged that the practice had been the hardest one to teach, and the Scrum and Kanban traditions that grew from XP's roots did not carry it forward. By the time the agile mainstream solidified in the mid-2000s, *system metaphor* was a footnote.

Codetry is what the system metaphor practice was trying to name.

The underlying claim — that a single chosen metaphor can and should constrain a system's naming throughout the entire codebase — is exactly the bet codetry generalises. Where XP applied it inside software teams, codetry extends it into community institutions where the domain experts are the people who live in the place. Where XP's system metaphor was evaluated by team agreement, codetry's rename test (§3.2) makes the same evaluation falsifiable at the level of the individual noun: hold the rest of the system constant, swap the word, read what shifts in the conversation.

The reason the practice fell out of use is instructive: *system metaphor* was described as a big, whole-team design choice, a single metaphor chosen up front for the entire system. That framing made it feel architectural and intimidating. Codetry's move is to apply the same discipline noun by noun, workbench session by workbench session, so the metaphor does not need to be chosen all at once — it is held incrementally, one rename at a time, and the rename test is the tool that holds it.

XP's place in codetry's lineage is named in §4.2: XP is not only an ancestor discipline but one of the *roots* codetry sits on top of, and the *system metaphor* practice is the closest single element in the agile prior literature to the discipline of holding a noun against the rename test.

XP's system metaphor said: name the whole codebase from a single metaphor. Codetry says: hold that discipline one noun at a time, and make the hold testable at the kitchen table rather than the whiteboard.

DD.7 · Different from Brooks and the essence/accident distinction

The seventh lineage codetry rests on is Fred Brooks' *No Silver Bullet — Essence and Accident in Software Engineering* (1986). Where most of the prior literature named in §4.2 is a sibling or a cousin, Brooks drew the philosophical line that codetry's entire verification standard rests on.

The essence/accident distinction.

Brooks distinguished between *essence* — the irreducible conceptual structure of the software, the problem the system is actually for — and *accident* — the parts that exist only because of the substrate, the choice of language, the deployment environment, the framework imposed by the organisation. The hard parts of software, Brooks argued, are in the essence: the conceptual complexity of the problem itself. No accidental improvement — faster compilers, better tools, more expressive languages — can dissolve essential complexity, only reduce the cost of carrying it.

Where codetry walks across the line Brooks drew.

Brooks did not write about names. He drew the line that says names *can* belong to essence rather than accident. A label in a UI, a string field in a schema, an affordance on a button — each of these could be treated as an accident of the substrate, a presentational choice that can be changed without touching the system's conceptual structure. Codetry's claim is that the name a community uses for its own institution is not an accident — it is part of the essential structure, and a discipline that does not protect it is leaving the load-bearing layer undefended.

Codetry's §3.6 standard — *the metaphor must be inspectable in the name itself* — is a claim about essence: the name is not a surface label sitting on top of the system's real structure, it is part of the real structure, and the rename test exists to keep it there. When a *saltbox* becomes a *household container* in the schema, the essential conceptual relationship between the word and the community has been dissolved and replaced with an accidental one — the kind of word a software engineer would choose rather than the kind of word the person who lives in the place already uses.

Brooks' place in codetry's lineage is named in §4.2: *No Silver Bullet* is not only a philosophical antecedent but one of the *roots* codetry sits on top of, and the essence/accident distinction is the philosophical line the rename test exists to hold.

Brooks drew the line between essence and accident in software. Codetry walks across that line and claims the community's word for its own institution as essence — and treats every translation away from it as an accident the system should not have been allowed to accumulate.

DD.A · Appendix — About this section

Deep Dives · appendix · optional reference material · finish the book first.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path. Finish the book first and return.

Six passages held from the main chapters. Each was strong enough to keep and too dense for the register of the chapter it came from. They are placed here for the reader who wants the full technical depth — the complete role definitions, the bar-level worked examples, the structural comparisons. If you read the seven chapters and want to go further, start here. If you are reading for the first time, finish the book first and return.

Passages are presented in the order they were held: two from Chapter 4 (the full role prose behind The Standby and The Gate), two from the structural comparison and worked-example material (both-states vs. both-sides; the Refused outcome at bar level), and two from the applied work (Bright Side data sovereignty; Northern Store Plan methodology). Core passages are reproduced verbatim from their source, with brief framing notes before and after each.

DD.I · The Standby — Full Role Definition

Deep Dives · I · The Standby · full role definition · held from Chapter 4.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

The chapter narration introduces The Standby in prose built for a general reader. What follows is the complete role definition from the deleted working document — the full vocabulary, the severity ladder, the two sub-shelves rejected as umbrella names, and the codetry principle the naming process produced.

The constellation's first non-zone primitive. The umbrella system + always-on state for *temporary centralized disruptions* — drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power, water, freight, payment systems, pandemic, evacuation, AGM-postponed, key-person-down. Six-word vocabulary: *the Standby* (umbrella + always-on state), *a call* (a specific active event), *the watch* (active-monitoring posture), *standby stock* (the always-on reserves), *the debrief*

(after-action synthesis), *centralized disruption* (the class of event). Four-rung severity ladder: advisory / standby / active / standdown. Two sub-shelves inside the umbrella: *The Common Pantry* (food/supply sub-noun) and *The Watch* (active-monitoring sub-noun) — each rejected as the umbrella name in turn because neither could hold both states.

The name has to hold both states — when a system has both a slow side (always-on practice) and a fast side (active event), the name has to do both jobs in one word, or the system will fork into two systems with two cultures.

The Standby as posture substrate.

Calling the Standby a *training layer* imports school-like expectations — curriculum, certification, skills checklists — that the Standby deliberately refuses. The right frame is *posture substrate*: the Standby is what grows the capacity to declare a hat without choosing from a menu. It is closer to liturgy than curriculum. The six-word vocabulary, drilled at the household level before any zone crossing is attempted, is what makes the ritual of becoming a recognition rather than a decision. You do not arrive at the Z1→Z2 gate and figure out what Practitioner means. You know, because the Standby has been teaching your body what posture under pressure feels like.

The four-rung severity ladder maps directly onto the gate system. Advisory is the Watch — something is forming, posture is unchanged, The Watch is informed. Standby is the gear-up moment — preparation is sleeved in, the crossing is imminent, stock is verified. Active is the crossing — a call is open, a hat is on, the record has flipped. Standdown is the Debrief — the call is closed, the hat is off, the receipt is written. The ladder and the gate ceremony are not two systems running in parallel. They are the same discipline at two scales: household and community.

The Debrief is the missing link between the human ritual and the blockchain enforcement layer. The chain can see that a gate was opened — a transaction was signed, a hat was declared. It cannot see whether the ritual was properly closed. A Standby stood down with no Debrief is a gate left ajar. A cryptographic receipt written from the Debrief back to the membrane would close the loop: the chain witnesses not just the opening but the standing down. This is an open architectural question. It is named here so it does not close quietly.

The Standby grows the posture. The gate demands you declare it. The chain witnesses that you did — and that you stood down when the call was over.

DD.II · The Gate — Full Role Definition

Deep Dives · II · The Gate · full role definition · held from Chapter 4.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

The chapter narration introduces The Gate in the same register as The Standby. What follows is the complete role definition — the full vocabulary, the four-rung severity ladder, the four single-direction names rejected on paper, and the second codetry principle the naming process produced.

A calm membrane between *the bright side* (the constellation's own dialect: neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock, the watch) and *the systems* (the outside world's dialect: resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves, compliance officer). Holds the umbrella system + always-on posture for passing language across institutional boundaries — codetry vocabulary going out to a regulator, banker, funder, lawyer, or other legacy-world counterparty; their vocabulary coming back in.

Eight-word vocabulary: *the Gate* (umbrella + always-on posture), *the bright side* (codetry-vocabulary side), *the systems* (the outside world's side), *a mapping* (a registered correspondence between a bright-side term and its systems-side equivalent), *a substitution* (one applied instance of a mapping), *a category* (the domain a mapping belongs to), *a translation* (the auditable record of what crossed and what changed), *a calm membrane* (the metaphor doing the load — selectively permeable, alive, not a wall and not an open door). Four-rung severity ladder: draft / under-review / cleared / refused — the *refused* rung is first-class, for source-side language with no honest target-side equivalent the founder is unwilling to lose.

Four single-side or single-direction names rejected on paper: *Translator* (collapses posture into pure transaction), *Filter* (subtractive mis-frame), *Censor* (carries punitive weight the metaphor refuses), *Glossary* (dictionary without the room).

The name has to hold both sides — when a system has language that has to live in two contexts that hold different vocabularies as legitimate, the umbrella name has to fit both contexts in one word, or the system will pick a dialect and lose the other room.

commit:ea059b3~1 · artifacts/practitioner-operating-plan/src/pages/Codetry.tsx
(constellation array, The Gate entry)

Tool: Gate Log — start your translation record — Enter your first pairing — your community's word on the left, the systems' word on the right. The Gate is only a gate if someone is keeping the log — both sides recorded, neither dissolved into the other.

DD.III · Both-States and Both-Sides — The Structural Comparison

Deep Dives · III · both-states vs. both-sides · structural comparison · held from Chapter 4.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

Chapter 4 treats both-states and both-sides in separate sections, in the order they were discovered. This passage puts the two principles side by side — the structural comparison that shows where they agree, where they diverge, and what the divergence means for naming a primitive.

Both tests are pick-one-then-the-other, but the axis is different. The both-states test picks a *state* ... The both-sides test picks a *context* ... In both tests, if the answer to either question is *not really*, the system has already started forking — into two cultures (both-states) or into two pipes (both-sides). If the answer to both is *yes* — *same word, different rung* (both-states) or *yes* — *same word, different room* (both-sides), the name is holding and the system is one system.

The axis distinction is the load-bearing difference. Both-states is a temporal test: the system runs at two speeds, and the umbrella name has to survive the tempo change. Both-sides is a contextual test: the system faces two rooms simultaneously, and the umbrella name has to survive the room change. A system can fail one test without failing the other. The Standby

fails only the both-states test if you force it — it holds in both states but would not survive being read as a both-sides primitive, because *standby* is not a term of art in the systems' dialect. The Gate fails only the both-sides test if you force it — it holds from bright side and from the systems' side, but it does not run at two tempos; it runs at one tempo in two simultaneous contexts.

Same word, different rung (for states). Same word, different room (for sides). If you can say that sentence about your umbrella name, the name is doing its job.

artifacts/codetry-handbook/data/handbook.ts, lines 428–429

DD.IV · The Refused — A Bar-Level Worked Example

Deep Dives · IV · The Refused · bar-level worked example · held from Chapter 4.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

Chapter 4 introduces the Refused outcome as a Gate rung and names it as first-class. The passage held here is the bar-level structural analysis — what Refused looks like when read from each side of the Gate, and why the finding is the same finding in both directions.

Refused — the sub-shelf for source-side language that has no honest equivalent on the other side — is the sharpest bar-level worked example. From the bright side: Refused records that a word in the constellation's dialect cannot be translated without distorting it, and so will not be. From the systems side: Refused records that a word in the outside world's dialect has been examined and found to have no honest landing point in the constellation's vocabulary. The finding is the same finding read from two directions. Both rooms are served by knowing the Gate will not invent false equivalents.

The Parr's Jars smoked salt crossing (passage 4-R in the harvest) is the field demonstration. The health unit's form had no slot for *freeze-dried microgreens from our own hydroponics, blended with onions from Walls Farm* — only for *kale powder (commercial source)*. The Gate Refused: no honest systems-side equivalent existed. The product crossed; the story did not.

The lesson the field example adds to the bar-level definition: the Gate does not always find an equivalent. Sometimes it refuses. When it refuses, the practitioner notes what was lost in the crossing and keeps the bright-side language alive at home, even when it cannot appear on the label.

Refused is not a failure state and it is not a footnote. It is the discipline proving that the Gate is a gate and not an open door. A system without a Refused rung is a translation machine — it will always find an equivalent, which means it will always invent one when none exists. The Refused rung is what makes the Gate honest.

artifacts/codetry-handbook/data/handbook.ts, lines 421-423

DD.V · Bright Side — Data Sovereignty at the Facility Level

Deep Dives · V · Bright Side · data sovereignty · held from Chapter 2.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

Chapter 2 introduces Bright Side as a mobile-first staff tool for residential care — what it replaces, what it does not ask staff to change, and how the builder describes the tool in his own words. The passage held here is the data-sovereignty framing: what single-facility control means, and what it means for a community that has watched institutional tools take their data with them on the way out.

It starts as a single-facility tool. No head office, no corporate subscription, no vendor lock-in. Your home controls the data. If you stop using it, you leave with a clean export.

This sentence is doing more structural work than it appears to. In residential care, the data that lives in a facility's care management system is not neutral — it is the institutional memory of what the shift looked like, who was present, what was noted, what was missed. When that data lives in a corporate platform, the facility's memory lives in a vendor relationship. If the relationship ends, the memory is at risk.

Single-facility design is the codetry move applied to data sovereignty: the home controls the data the same way the community controls the noun. Both are anti-drift positions. The vendor cannot take the word with them on the way out; the vendor cannot take the records with them on the way out. The clean-export guarantee is the data equivalent of the codetry-test — a check that the sovereignty claim is real and not just marketing.

For communities building care infrastructure, this framing matters beyond the residential care application. Any tool that collects operational data is making a quiet claim about who owns that data. Single-facility, no head office, clean export is the full claim.

artifacts/codetry-ship/src/pages/BrightSidePage.tsx, lines 117-119

DD.VI · Northern Store Plan — A Methodology, Not a One-Off

Deep Dives · VI · Northern Store Plan · methodology · held from Chapter 2.

Optional reference material — not in the main reading path.

Chapter 2 covers the six-phase engagement model, the cockpit, and the contract structure for the northern community store plan. The passage held here is the strategic note from the practitioner's own operating plan: the methodology exists and is proven, and the thing missing is not more fieldwork but a one-page scope document that makes it easy for a second client to say yes.

The methodology exists and is proven. The only thing missing is a one-page scope document and a rate sheet that makes it easy for a second client to say yes. This is the fastest path from 'one contract' to 'a business.'

This is the practitioner writing to herself, not to the client. The difference in register matters. Chapter 2 describes the methodology from the client's perspective — what the community gets, in what sequence, at what handoff. This passage describes the

methodology from the practitioner's perspective: what is missing from the supply side to make the work repeatable.

A proven methodology with no scope document is a bespoke engagement. A proven methodology with a scope document and a rate sheet is a service that can be priced, quoted, and delivered to a second community without reinventing the intake. The six phases in Chapter 2 are the methodology. The scope document and rate sheet are the packaging that turns the methodology into a business. The practitioner had done the field work; this passage names the one administrative step between one contract and a practice.

For readers building similar practices in other regions — the instruction is transferable. Document the phases. Set the rate. Make it easy for the second client to say yes before the first engagement closes.

artifacts/practitioners-guide-v2/src/data/portfolio.ts, lines 192-194

Part FL · Field Ledger

Eleven worked codetory tests, in chronological order. Each one is a small piece of the practice — a question about a name, what was on the screen before, the intervention tried, the rule discovered, the falsifier the rule lives or dies by, and the verdict. The ledger is here so the discipline can be inspected against its own examples rather than only against its rules.

FL.1 · Test 001 — Payday: words bearing weight

Date 2026-04-26 · Eave / xBuckets Payday tab · status: graduated.

The finding.

The first formal codetory test. The xBuckets Payday tab surfaced three CTAs all dressed in the same water language with no priority signal. The rain word was being asked to do three jobs and so did none of them.

What was on screen.

Three actions, one metaphor, no hierarchy: *Let's make it rain* (the hero), *Convert XRP → RLUSD* (the wallet/swap chip beside it at peer-of-CTA volume), and a *Full rain / 90% / 75% / 50% / Custom* percentage chip cluster that scaled how much of the plan to pour. A user, asked to read the screen cold, froze: which CTA do I tap, and what does *full rain* mean if *let's make it rain* is also a button?

The intervention.

Variant A on the canvas collapsed the rain word back to a single referent and gave every other step in the flow its own word: a *Today's rainfall* card replaces the percentage chips, a flow ribbon makes Rainfall → Siphon → Reservoir visible with dollar values at each node, *Channel the rainfall · \$1,200 ready · every drop into a bucket* becomes the only CTA, and the wallet/XRP-swap chip is demoted to plumbing typography below it. Each word, one job. None overlap.

The rule discovered.

One word → one referent. In codetry, every metaphor word in the surface UI must point to exactly one thing in the architecture. The moment a word names two actions, it names neither.

Falsifiable claim.

If holding one-word-one-referent across the constellation reduces ambiguity at decision points, then a user looking at Variant A without prior context should be able to tell from the words alone what the single next action is. Falsified if the user still cannot.

Status.

Graduated. Variant A shipped in `PaydayTab.tsx` / `PaydayPlanner.tsx`. Two later sightings on the same surface complicated the verdict. *Sighting 1 (the catch in the wild)*. A fresh screenshot of the live Payday tab caught a banking word — *Stays in bank (bills)* — quietly displacing the locked Eave verb *Siphon* on the catchment-plan card. A one-line rename in the two parallel surfaces restored *Siphoned out for bills*. The diagnostic move named in this chapter (*when a word feels off, look for one doing two jobs or one belonging to a different register*) found the defect immediately, and the locked map of \$FL.2 supplied the exact replacement word with no design discussion needed. *Sighting 2 (the rebase that silently undid the fix)*. Two days later, a search of the codebase showed `PaydayPlanner.tsx` had reverted

to *Stays in bank (bills)* — Task #806 (the calm rest view) had branched from a pre-rebase tree, and a tangled merge resolved by pulling the planner card forward from the pre-rebase branch silently restored the older banking word. Nothing in the merge process flagged it. The fix here was to restore the locked word and add the smallest possible mechanical witness — a single unit test asserting the catchment card reads *Siphoned out for bills* and not anything containing *Stays in bank*.

A discipline degrades on every rebase, every long branch, every fast merge. A contract doesn't. The locked map needs at least one machine-checked witness on every surface it owns.

FL.2 · Test 002 — Eave: the word map locked

Date 2026-04-26 · Eave / xBuckets, every surface · status: graduated.

The finding.

Test 001 proved the rule on a single screen. Test 002 paid the cost of holding the rule across the whole zone. *Reservoir* had been used three different ways (the wallet, the long-term savings vehicle, the emergency fund); *Channel* had been used four different ways (bucket distribution, the Bridge sheet, the Drainage lesson, the Earn routing); *Compound Rainfall* was the lesson title for tax-advantaged compounding, but the body actually described two referents (a weather pattern and a tax-sheltered vehicle); the hero label field was named `masterBucketLabel` in code, a holdover that no longer matched the surface word. Three words doing eleven jobs.

What was on screen.

Across every Eave surface (Payday tab, Earn tab, Buckets tab, lessons, hero card, settings), the same loose vocabulary leaked into different jobs on different surfaces. The Bridge sheet used *channel*; the debt lesson used *channel*; the Earn routing used *channel*; the bucket distribution used *channel*. Same word, four meanings. Same problem for *reservoir*. The locked map did not yet exist, and the absence was where the drift lived.

The intervention.

Lock the word map for the whole zone — one word, one referent, in EN and FR, in every surface, in every lesson, and in the code field-names. Where one word was doing two jobs, a second word was coined or recovered so each job has a name of its own. The Bridge sheet

was rewritten to use *Bridge* (not *Channel*); the debt-channeling lesson became *debt-drainage*; the *compound-rainfall* lesson became *cloud-cover* and introduced *Glacier* explicitly as the tax-sheltered vehicle; the *Reservoir* field was renamed in `TenantConfig` from `masterBucketLabel` to `reservoirLabel`. A separate decision recorded in the test (Task #851) rephrased three remaining surface uses of the bare verb *park* to *set aside* / *keep* so the retired metaphor word never appears on an Eave surface at all.

The locked map.

- Rainfall — the income arriving on payday from work or other sources
- Siphon — the verb that diverts a portion of rainfall toward bills before any bucket fills
- Reservoir — the wallet that holds RLUSD between rainfall and channelling into buckets
- Channel (verb) — the move from Reservoir into Buckets on payday, never used for anything else
- Bucket — a single named savings goal the household assigns rainfall to
- Cloud Cover — tax-sheltered compounding (formerly *Compound Rainfall*); the weather, not the vehicle
- Rain Barrel — a household's working emergency-fund bucket, distinct from Reservoir
- Aquifer — the long-horizon savings vehicle below working-life buckets
- Glacier — the tax-sheltered long-horizon vehicle (TFSA / RRSP / equivalent) sitting under Cloud Cover
- Watershed — the whole household-finance system viewed as one catchment area
- Bridge (verb) — the cross-currency move on the Bridge sheet, never *Channel*
- Public Lake — a public AMM pool
- Private Lake — a tenant-curated AMM pool routed to by a Drip Harvester
- Lake current — the swap fee a Lake collects (renamed from *Park toll* by Task #849)
- Fill (verb) — the move from Reservoir into a Lake (parking RLUSD to earn Lake currents)
- Drainage — the verb for paying down debt, never *Channel*

Naming note. *Reservoir* in this zone is the household stablecoin wallet — the place RLUSD sits between rainfall and channelling into buckets. It is a different object from the *Reserve* line in the Practitioner's Guide V2 ContractsPage (a 75% hold-back of post-tithe agency surplus that funds the next reserve / next pilot). Same metaphor family — both are *what is*

held back so the system can run again — but the household wallet is downstream of the household's own income, not of an agency's surplus. A reader moving between the two artifacts should not conflate them.

The rule discovered.

One word → one referent, held across the whole zone. Test 001 named the rule on one screen. Test 002 is what it costs to honour the rule across a constellation.

Falsifiable claim.

If the locked map holds, a new user reading any Eave surface should be able to describe the architecture using the same nouns the lessons teach — without translation. Falsified if a user encounters a word and asks *which one do you mean?* The map is small enough to teach in a single breath, and that is the measure: if the map cannot be taught in a breath, it is not locked.

Status.

Graduated. The 16 locked nouns above have been honoured across `copy.en.ts` / `copy.fr.ts`, the lesson modules, and the field-names in `TenantConfig`. All 16 also appear as worked-example entries on the Eave page of the constellation map (the companion artifact), each with the rule that holds it in place.

FL.3 · Test 003 — Bamboo field on the wallet chip

Date 2026-04-26 · Eave / xBuckets Payday tab · status: rejected.

The question.

The first formally *rejected* test. The handbook's hempcrete chapter (§1.5) names XRP as *the bamboo field* in its coda. Does the word *bamboo field* earn a place on the wallet/XRP-swap chip — the quiet plumbing chip Test 001 demoted below the *Channel the rainfall* CTA — or does it stay as a meta-doc reference only?

What was on screen.

Three chip wordings were tried on the canvas, sitting beneath the real graduated CTA from Test 001. Variant 0 (control): *412 XRP unconverted ⇌ Swap to ~\$420 RLUSD* — mechanical, register-neutral. Variant A (full metaphor): *Bamboo field standing ≈ Cut ~\$420 into rainfall* — wallet becomes field, swap becomes cut, no XRP word visible. Variant B (half-metaphor): *Bamboo field · 412 XRP ⇌ Swap to ~\$420 RLUSD* — XRP retained as anchor noun, bamboo field added as label.

The intervention.

The test was: read each chip cold, with the rainfall language sitting right above it, and ask whether the user can tell what the chip does from the chip alone. Variant 0 reads as plumbing, exactly as Test 001 left it. Variant A breaks: *Bamboo field standing* leaves the cold reader with no idea what the chip touches, and *Cut into rainfall* asks the reader to hold biological cutting and atmospheric rainfall in the same gesture — the metaphor cracks at the verb. The screen now has two unreconciled registers (water and plant) competing for the reader's attention. Variant B is the most interesting failure: *Bamboo field · 412 XRP* doesn't crack, it just adds noise. The XRP word still does all the load-bearing work; *Bamboo field* sits as a nickname that gives the reader nothing they didn't already have.

The rule discovered.

One register per screen. The Test 001 rule (one word → one referent) extends to the screen as a whole: a single product surface should carry a single metaphor register, not two competing ones. A metaphor that lives honestly in the lineage doc may still be the wrong word for a surface, if that surface already belongs to a different register.

Falsifiable claim.

Bamboo field earns the chip if a cold reader, with no prior context, can tell from the chip alone what the chip does. It fails if the bamboo word lands as a non-sequitur next to rainfall / channel / bucket — i.e. if the metaphor word does a second job and so does neither cleanly.

Status.

Rejected for the wallet chip. The bamboo-field metaphor stays as a meta-doc reference (\$1.5). The chip on the Payday tab continues to read as the quiet plumbing chip Test 001 demoted it to. The canvas variants are preserved as a counter-test artefact. The verdict

would change only if a bamboo-only surface is built (the upstream gets its own screen, no rainfall language nearby) or if the water register is replaced wholesale on the Payday tab — neither of which is on the table from this test.

See also.

§1.5 (What kind of thing codetry is — Hemcrete) coda — the bamboo-field metaphor that this test refused on the wallet chip. §FL.1 (Test 001) — the test that demoted the wallet chip to plumbing in the first place.

FL.4 · Test 004 — Calm states earn their loudness back

Date 2026-04-26 · Eave / xBuckets Payday tab · status: graduated on arrival.

The finding.

The first temperature-family rule, and the first rule named from a *convergence* rather than from a single test. Two independent design moves on the same screen — Test 001's *Wobble targets* escape hatch and Task #806's *Tinker with the plan* disclosure — arrived at the same shape: a calm primary surface with the loud controls retreating behind a quiet, summonable text-link. Two unrelated authors converging on one shape isn't a coincidence; it's a rule asking to be named.

What was on screen.

Both surfaces cut the same silhouette. *Precedent 1 — Wobble targets* (Test 001 graduation): the percentage-chip cluster was retired, and the custom-scale control retreated behind a single quiet text-link sitting under the flow ribbon (`PaydayPlanner.tsx` ~line 1631). When tapped, the wobble panel unfolds in place and the user can dial. *Precedent 2 — Tinker with the plan* (Task #806): the *all funded* rest view takes the screen, and a single quiet disclosure button sits at its foot (`PaydayRestCard.tsx` ~line 237); the wired controls are conditionally rendered exactly when the user asks for them. Same shape: calm primary surface, quiet text-link with a chevron, summon-on-demand panel — different originating task, different copy, identical geometry.

The intervention.

There is no code change here. The intervention is the act of recognition: seeing that the two surfaces are instances of one rule, and writing the rule down so the next surface that needs the same shape can reach for it deliberately rather than rediscover it accidentally.

The rule discovered.

Surface state mirrors cycle state, and calm states earn their loudness back. A calm state is the default surface for any architectural state that doesn't require user action. The loud controls don't disappear — they retreat behind a quiet, named disclosure that the user can summon on demand. The default is calm; loudness has to earn itself back by being asked for.

This is a different rule family from one-word-one-referent (§FL.1) and one-register-per-screen (§FL.3). Those rules govern the *vocabulary* of the surface — which words appear, in which dialect. This rule governs the *temperature* of the surface — which controls appear, at what loudness, given the architectural state behind the screen. The two families compose: a locked vocabulary doesn't help if every control is shouting at peer volume; a calm layout doesn't help if the words are doing two jobs each. Both have to hold for the surface to feel right.

Falsifiable claim.

Falsified if an Eave surface in a calm architectural state still presents loud active controls by default (failure mode A: pre-loud), or if a surface hides a loud control so successfully that a power user who knows the control exists cannot find it within one tap from the calm default (failure mode B: hidden, not retreated). The rule sits between those two failure modes — *retreat, not removal*.

Status.

Graduated on arrival. Unlike Tests 001-003, this rule was not discovered on the canvas and then graduated to production — it was *shipped twice* in production before being named, by two unrelated tasks, and only then recognised as a single rule. The codetry test here is the naming, not the shipping. No production code or copy ships from this test.

See also.

§FL.1 (Test 001) — the vocabulary rule the Wobble-targets escape hatch shipped from. §FL.3 (Test 003) — the one-register-per-screen rule, complementary to the temperature rule named here.

FL.5 · Test 005 — Drip Harvester reads as DeFi noise

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets Earn surface · status: graduated.

The finding.

The Earn surface speaks two languages at once. The locked Eave water vocabulary (§FL.2) covers four of the words on screen. The other seventeen are imported from DevOps, naval, finance, and crypto-Twitter registers — and the cold reader has to translate every one of them to understand what the screen does.

What was on screen.

A cold read of the Earn tab as it shipped surfaced seventeen distinct vocabulary defects on a single screen, clustered into four foreign registers. *DevOps / robot register* — *agent, fleet, deploy, Drip Harvester Fleet, 2 harvesters deployed, Deploy another agent*. *DeFi / protocol register* — *AMM pools, LP Position, LP tokens, pool shares, Est. APR, trading fees, swap*. *Broom register* — *sweep, auto-sweeps, sweep threshold, Routing drip to cistern*. *Crypto-Twitter register* — *no rug pulls, no moonshots, 24/7*. And one direct violation of the Eave lock: the surface used *cistern* where Test 002 locked the word to *Bucket*.

The intervention.

Four canvas variants were built. Variant A (vocabulary sweep) replaces every word the locked map does not sanction — *Drip Harvester* becomes the only word for the actor (DevOps register dropped); *Private Park* becomes the destination noun (later renamed to *Private Lake* by Task #849, recorded here); *Park toll* (later *Lake current*) is coined as the new noun for the swap fee a Park collects; pool labels sweep to Park labels; APR is reframed to plain monthly dollars (*\$X / month per \$100 parked*); the channel verb is restored to its locked use (*drips to savings*, not *channelled to savings*); *drip* becomes the only verb for the Drip Harvester → Bucket move; *bucket* replaces *cistern* wherever *cistern* crept in; the crypto-Twitter defensiveness is dropped. Variant B (register honesty — gloss the foreign words inline) was predicted-rejected and rejected. Variant C (a flow ribbon at the top of the Earn tab) was scoped out as a heavier production change and recorded as a follow-up test.

The rule discovered.

*Vocabulary defects compound where the metaphor is most asked to do work.
Silence about the metaphor is permission for DeFi.*

Foreign registers fill unmapped territory the same way weeds fill unplanted soil. The Earn surface inherited the agent/fleet/deploy/LP/AMM/sweep register not because anyone designed it that way but because nobody held the locked map there.

Falsifiable claim.

If the Variant A graduation holds, a cold-read of the Earn tab should describe what the screen does using only the locked Eave words plus *Drip Harvester* and *Park toll* (the two new sanctioned nouns). Falsified if a cold reader still reaches for *deploy* or *LP* or *sweep* to describe what they see.

Status.

Graduated. Variant A shipped to `copy.en.ts` (Earn block) and the affected JSX strings in `EarnTab.tsx`; critical strings mirrored to `copy.fr.ts`. *Park toll* added to the locked Eave map. *Side note on the practice.* This was the first codetry test to graduate twice in one session — once as a draft, then again after code-review caught defect leakage (APR/pool/trading-fee phrasing and the *Channelled to savings* locked-word violation still leaked the first time). A third leak — *Not funded yet* on the Drip Harvester card, where *funded* read as *broken/halted* to a household reader — was caught from the live phone surface, not from review, and replaced with *No RLUSD parked yet*. The pattern: *the locked map is the test*, and *graduated* is only true when a strict surface scan finds no leaks — including the user's pocket, not just the diff.

See also.

\$FL.2 (Test 002) — the locked map this test was held to. \$FL.6 (Test 006) — the flow-ribbon follow-up scoped out of this test. \$FL.7 (Test 007) — the structural test that found the LP-position card had survived this vocabulary sweep.

FL.6 · Test 006 — Earn flow ribbon graduates (three stations)

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets Earn surface · status: graduated, later superseded by \$FL.8.

The claim.

If a flow ribbon at the top of the Payday tab kept three CTAs from fighting for one word, then a flow ribbon at the top of the Earn tab will keep four foreign DeFi registers from filling the silence around the topology of how a Drip Harvester actually moves money.

What was on screen.

After the \$FL.5 vocabulary sweep, the Earn surface speaks one language consistently — the locked Eave water map plus *Drip Harvester* and *Park toll*. But the *topology* is still implicit. A cold reader who lands on the Earn tab sees, in order: an XRP Spring card, a Drip Harvester intro card, an LP-position card (when one exists), a list of Private Parks, and a Learn accordion. Nothing on the surface tells them, in one read, where their money currently sits and how it moves between stations.

The intervention.

An `<EarnFlowRibbon />` component was added to `EarnTab.tsx` and rendered near the top of the surface. It shipped with three nodes connected by chevrons: *Reservoir* → *Private Park* → *Buckets*, with the Drip Harvester drawn as a small badge sitting on the Park → Buckets edge — *not* as its own node. The Test 006 reasoning was that the Drip Harvester is *the verb that moves Park earnings into a Bucket* and so does not deserve a station on a topology picture. Active state on the Park node when at least one Drip Harvester is running; pulse on the Drip Harvester badge when a sweep is ready.

The rule discovered.

Topology earns its place at the top of the surface when the stations the money passes through cannot be inferred from the cards below. Anywhere the metaphor is asked to do work across more than one card, the surface earns a flow ribbon at its top.

Falsifiable claim.

If Variant C's graduation holds, a cold reader landing on the Earn tab should be able to point at the ribbon and say, in one sentence, where their money currently sits and where it will move to next — even before reading any of the cards beneath it. A second falsifier: if a cold reader treats the ribbon as decoration (skips it on first read) or asks *why is this picture here?*, the visual weight is wrong and the ribbon needs to be louder, not softer.

Status.

Graduated, then superseded by §FL.8 (Test 008). Two cold reads after Test 006 shipped found the three-station design hid the Drip Harvester's noun-sense behind its verb-sense and lost the reader's ability to point at the earner wallet on the topology picture. §FL.8 restored the four-station ribbon and added a position read-out underneath. Test 006 is preserved here for the practice record — including the moment the rule held and the moment it didn't.

See also.

§FL.5 (Test 005) — Variant C of which this test graduated. §FL.8 (Test 008) — supersedes this three-station design with a four-station ribbon and a position read-out.

FL.7 · Test 007 — The LP-position card survived the vocabulary sweep

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets Earn surface, LP-position card · status: graduated.

The finding.

The vocabulary sweep from §FL.5 cleaned every word on the LP-position card and left the card itself untouched — and the layout it had been hiding behind those words turned out to be three structural defects stacked on top of each other.

What was on screen.

Defect 1 — no impermanent-loss disclosure on the card. The card promised a steady drip and never told the household what happens if RLUSD and XRP drift apart in price. The honest *you might end up with less RLUSD than you parked* lived in a Learn accordion three taps away. *Defect 2 — multi-card density.* Six visual blocks fought for the same square inch of attention with no hierarchy and no answer to *what should the eye look at first when this card loads?* *Defect 3 — no toll-drop cadence.* Drip rate \$0.27 / month read as a constant — a number stamped on the card the way an interest rate is stamped on a bond — but the Park toll moves with trading volume, and a household coming back to a \$0.13 drip rate in two weeks had no reference point for telling normal weather from something wrong.

The intervention.

Variant A (hierarchy + IL + toll history) graduates. A single hero block opens the card (*Drip earned so far · +\$2.40 RLUSD / next drip at \$25.00*, with the progress bar directly under it and a one-line footer *10% of the way · then \$22.50 lands in Vacation*); two stats survive in a sub-row below (*Parked* and *Drip rate*), with *Your share* and *Today's drip* cut as DeFi-derived metrics the household never asked for; a `TollBand` helper sits under the sub-row showing the Park toll as a band labelled honestly as a *typical range* (production does not yet snapshot tolls over time, so the band is derived from the current toll $\pm 35\%$, with a follow-up to record real history); an amber IL heads-up earns the bottom of the card next to the parked money, with a link out to the Learn module `$FL.5` already rewrote to be honest. Variant B (stability band) and Variant C (single story) recorded as rejected.

The rule discovered.

A vocabulary sweep cleans words; it does not clean layout. Clean words on a noisy card still read as a noisy card. Vocabulary tests do not graduate layout; layout tests do.

Falsifiable claim.

If the graduation holds, a cold reader on the LP-position card should (1) read the hero block and know within one sentence what they parked, what they have earned, and how far they are from the next drip; (2) see the IL warning without scrolling past it or tapping into Learn; and (3) describe the drip rate as *about \$0.27 a month right now, but it moves with the toll* rather than as a constant. Falsified if a cold reader still says *I see four numbers, I don't know which one matters* or quotes the rate with no qualifier.

Status.

Graduated. Variant A shipped to the LP-position branch of `JoinPoolSection` in `EarnTab.tsx` and the new `lp` copy keys in `copy.en.ts` (mirrored in `copy.fr.ts`). The new `TollBand` helper lives in `EarnTab.tsx` next to `RISK_STYLE`. Real Park-toll history is recorded as a follow-up task; Variant A ships an honest typical range band today. Side note on the practice. The Earn surface now has two distinct kinds of test — what does the surface say (`$FL.5`'s vocabulary sweep) and what does the surface put first* (this test's hierarchy + disclosure). They catch different defects on the same card.

See also.

\$FL.5 (Test 005) — the vocabulary sweep that this test found the layout had survived. \$FL.8 (Test 008) — the parallel structural test on the Earn flow ribbon.

FL.8 · Test 008 — The Earn flow ribbon becomes four stations

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets Earn surface · status: graduated, supersedes \$FL.6.

The claim.

If the ribbon is supposed to answer *where in the system am I?* then every station the money passes through has to be a thing the reader can point at — the Drip Harvester is one of those things, so it graduates from a verb on an arrow (\$FL.6) to its own circle in the chain, and the ribbon grows a one-line position read-out underneath that names where the household actually is.

What was on screen.

Two cold reads after \$FL.6 shipped showed its three-station ribbon had a hole. *The Drip Harvester is also a wallet — an earner wallet that holds RLUSD before it is parked* was already named, repeatedly, in the locked map and the intro card — and drawing the Drip Harvester only as an edge verb left the cold reader unable to point at *the wallet itself* on the topology picture. *The ribbon answered topology but not position.* Test 001's Payday-tab ribbon shows changing dollar values at each station; \$FL.6's Earn ribbon could not (the Earn-tab values move on a weekly-to-monthly cadence) and shipped labels-only — meaning the ribbon answered *the chain in the abstract* without ever answering *where the household currently is on it*. A reader with no Drip Harvester yet, a reader with one set up but no parked RLUSD, a reader with a parked Lake collecting currents, and a reader with a sweep-ready harvester all saw the same picture.

The intervention.

Two changes from \$FL.6, both restoring something the canvas Variant C of \$FL.5 already had. *Four nodes, not three.* The Drip Harvester gets its own circle on the ribbon, between Reservoir and Private Lake, with the sub-label *earner wallet*. The \$FL.6 reasoning (Drip Harvester is a verb, not a noun) was true and irrelevant: the Drip Harvester *is* a verb (the move from Lake to Bucket) **and also** a wallet (the place RLUSD sits while the move is happening). The ribbon is a topology, and topology asks *what are the places?*, not *what are*

the verbs? The verb sense survives in the prose under the ribbon. A *one-line position read-out under the ribbon* names the most forward station the household has actually reached: four states, each later state implying all earlier ones.

The position read-out.

- No Drip Harvester yet — *Your reservoir is the only stop with anything in it — set up a Drip Harvester to push the drip forward.*
- Drip Harvester set up, nothing parked — *Your Drip Harvester is set up but nothing's parked yet — fill a Private Lake with idle RLUSD to start collecting Lake currents.*
- Parked RLUSD, harvester earning — *You've parked RLUSD in a Private Lake — your Drip Harvester is earning Lake currents.*
- Sweep ready — *Your Drip Harvester has earned enough — the next drip is ready to land in a Bucket.*

The rule discovered.

Topology is a noun-game. Every station the money passes through must be drawn as a station, even when the same thing is also a verb in the prose. Put the noun on the ribbon; let the verb live in the sentence underneath.
Corollary: topology earns position when it names where the reader currently is, not just what the chain looks like — the ribbon stops being a static diagram and becomes a status line.

Falsifiable claim.

If the graduation holds, a cold reader landing on the Earn tab should be able to (1) point at four labelled circles and say *this is where my money goes through*, (2) point at the highlighted circles and say *this is where it currently is*, and (3) read the sentence under the ribbon and say what happens next — without scrolling past the ribbon. Falsified if a cold reader still asks *where is the Drip Harvester?* after looking at the ribbon, or if the *empty* state of the read-out is read as *broken* rather than as *you are at the start of the chain*.

Status.

Graduated. Variant C (canvas) restored as the live ribbon: four nodes, Drip Harvester between Reservoir and Lake. Position read-out shipped under the ribbon, EN in `copy.en.ts`, FR mirror in `copy.fr.ts`. Active-station emphasis upgraded from a 2px ring to a saturated

tone-fill + ring. Drip Harvester pulse on sweep-ready preserved from §FL.6, now on the Drip Harvester station itself rather than on the Lake → Buckets edge. §FL.6 superseded; its `flowEdgeHarvester` string removed.

See also.

§FL.6 (Test 006) — the previous (three-station) shipping of this same intervention, kept in the ledger because the moment a rule held wrong is part of the practice record. §FL.7 (Test 007) — the parallel structural test on the LP-position card.

FL.9 · Test 009 — Water-register wordings on the wallet chip

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets Payday tab · status: graduated.

The question.

§FL.3 ruled out the bamboo-field metaphor on the wallet/XRP-swap chip on the grounds of *one register per screen* — bamboo (biological) was fighting rainfall (water) on the same surface. The rejection was clean, but it only proved bamboo doesn't belong here. It did not prove that the production wording — *Convert XRP → RLUSD* — is the best the chip can be. This test asks: can the chip speak the same water register the rest of the screen already uses, without inflating itself back to peer-of-CTA volume?

What was on screen.

Three water-register variants were tried alongside Variant 0 (*412 XRP unconverted ⇌ Swap to ~\$420 RLUSD*). Variant A: *Top up reservoir from XRP · ~\$420* — verbal-only, *Reservoir* doing the wallet work the locked map of §FL.2 says it should. Variant B: *Add to reservoir · 412 XRP ⇌ \$420* — same locked word, slightly cooler verb, with the explicit ⇌ arrow and concrete numbers retained. Variant C: *412 XRP standing by · refill reservoir* — the calmest verb, source-leads, action-follows.

The intervention.

Each variant rendered at the actual production typography (10px white/25 underlined text-link, sitting under the *Channel the rainfall* CTA) and read cold. The question was double: does the chip still tell the user mechanically what it does, *and* does it remain demoted relative to the hero CTA above it.

The rule discovered.

Demotion by typography is not the same as demotion by vocabulary. The locked map (§FL.2) covers vocabulary; the temperature rule (§FL.4) covers loudness. A chip can be typographically quiet and still break the screen's register — and that break can hide for cycles precisely because the typography says don't look here.

Falsifiable claim.

A water-register wording earns the chip if both hold: (1) *mechanical clarity preserved* — a cold reader can still tell from the chip alone what the chip does, specifically that XRP gets exchanged for stablecoins added to the wallet (the same falsifier as §FL.3); and (2) *demotion preserved* — at the actual production typography (10px white/25 underlined text-link), the new wording does not feel louder than the control, i.e. it does not pull the eye away from the *Channel the rainfall* CTA above it.

Status.

Graduated. Variant A — *Top up reservoir from XRP* — ships as the new wording, same typography, same demoted text-link, same surface position. The chip remains plumbing; it now also speaks the locked Eave dialect. Variant B is rejected for unnecessary visual weight (the arrow + numbers buy nothing the locked dialect doesn't already give). Variant C is rejected for losing mechanical precision (poetic but uninformative — a cold reader can't tell the chip swaps).

See also.

§FL.3 (Test 003) — rejected the bamboo-field metaphor on the same chip on the grounds of one register per screen. §FL.10 / §FL.11 (Test 010) — the loud-twin and the deeper-room moves of the same closing-out arc on this surface stack.

FL.10 · Test 010 — Water-register wordings on the shortfall CTA

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets wallet-confirm sheet · status: graduated.

The question.

§FL.9 graduated the *demoted* XRP-swap chip from *Convert XRP → RLUSD* to *Top up reservoir from XRP*, finally bringing it into the locked Eave water dialect. That chip has a *loud* twin — the prominent amber CTA in the wallet-confirm sheet that appears when the wallet is short of plan total. It still said *Convert XRP → RLUSD to cover shortfall*. Same action, same destination, same protocol-noun register-break. This test asks: can the loud chip speak the same dialect as its quiet sibling without losing the urgency the amber card is built to express?

What was on screen.

Three variants alongside Variant 0 (*Convert XRP → RLUSD to cover shortfall*). Variant A — *Top up reservoir from XRP* (a direct port of §FL.9's graduate). Variant B — *Top up reservoir from XRP · cover the shortfall* (§FL.9's graduate as the action, then a separator, then the urgency tail naming what the amber card is shouting about). Variant C — *Refill reservoir from XRP · cover the shortfall* (same shape as B but with *refill* instead of *top up*).

The intervention.

Each variant rendered in the actual amber-CTA treatment of the wallet-confirm sheet, with the surrounding amber alert text intact, and read cold. The question was: does the new dialect rhyme with the quiet sibling on the Payday tab *and* still read as the answer to the alert above it, not as an aside that happens to live in the same card?

The rule discovered.

When a chip has a quiet sibling and a loud sibling that do the same thing, the loud one should rhyme with the quiet one in dialect, then add whatever the loud surface needs. Test 003's one register per screen held even on a typographically demoted surface (§FL.9); this test extends it to a loud surface — the amber CTA was hiding behind its urgency the way the demoted chip was hiding behind its typography.

Falsifiable claim.

A water-register wording earns the loud amber CTA if both hold: (1) *mechanical clarity preserved* (same falsifier as §FL.3 and §FL.9); and (2) *urgency preserved* — the cold reader still understands this is a *fix-the-shortfall* action, not a casual top-up. The chip should read

as the answer to the amber alert above it, not as an aside that happens to live in the same card.

Status.

Graduated. Variant B — *Top up reservoir from XRP · cover the shortfall* — ships, same amber CTA treatment, same surface position, same icon. Variant A is rejected for dropping *shortfall* and leaving the urgency in the amber card alone with no echo on the chip. Variant C is rejected for *refill* implying a state of fullness the reservoir never had this cycle (the same word §FL.9 had already flagged as wrong-temperature on the demoted twin). Variant B's structure — (*§FL.9's exact graduate*) · (*purpose-of-this-surface*) — gives the two chips a shared spine, mirroring the existing graduated hero CTA from §FL.1 (*Channel the rainfall · \$1,200 ready · every drop into a bucket*).

See also.

§FL.9 (Test 009) — the quiet sibling on the Payday tab whose dialect this loud twin now rhymes with. §FL.11 (the second-filed Test 010) — the deeper-room move on the swap-sheet header that closes out the arc this test opened.

FL.11 · Test 010 (second entry) — Water-register wording on the swap-sheet header

Date 2026-04-27 · Eave / xBuckets ConvertXrpSheet · status: graduated.

Numbering note. This is the second entry filed as Test 010 in the ledger, and it has been left at its original number rather than renumbered to 011 — both because the duplicate is itself part of the practice record (two tests on the same wallet/XRP-swap stack landed on the same date and were filed as 010 in error, and the ledger preserves that), and because the first 010 (§FL.10) and this entry (§FL.11) are the loud-twin and the deeper-room moves of one closing-out arc on the same surface stack and read better as a pair than as 010 / 011 across a renumbering boundary. Future ledger entries are expected to start at 011, leaving §FL.10 / §FL.11 as the one anomaly the numbering preserves.

The question.

§FL.9 graduated the wallet/XRP-swap chip into the locked Eave dialect (*Top up reservoir from XRP*), and explicitly *deferred* the same question one surface deeper — the sheet that opens when the user taps the chip. This test asks whether `convertXrp.title` should follow the chip into the locked dialect, or earn its protocol nouns because the user has crossed into a transactional room. The defence in §FL.9 was specific (*the swap interface is allowed its own register because by then the user has crossed into a different room*), defensible, and possibly right — but it was an agent decision made in passing, with no falsifier and no cold read. It deserves its own test.

What was on screen.

Four variants. Variant 0 (control): eyebrow *Tap the Headwaters* (already in dialect, locked by §FL.2), title *Convert XRP → RLUSD* (protocol). Variant A: title *Top up your reservoir* — pure dialect, mirrors §FL.9's graduated verb. Variant B: title *Refill the reservoir from your headwaters* — both locked nouns, most poetic. Variant C: title *Top up your reservoir* with a small grey subheading *XRP → RLUSD* underneath — hybrid.

The intervention.

Each variant rendered as the live `ConvertXrpSheet` would render it, with the body line-items (XRP balance, RLUSD to receive, slippage in XRP, *Convert in Xaman* on the CTA) intact. The question: at the title level, does dialect or protocol read as honest *given the rest of the sheet already names the assets*?

The rule discovered.

Register zoning works vertically as well as horizontally. Test 002 zones registers across screens (§FL.2); this test shows the same kind of zoning inside a single component: the title-level register can speak dialect while the line-item register speaks protocol, as long as each register lives at the level it is best at. Dialect names the kind of action; protocol names the assets the action moves; the CTA verb names what the wallet will sign. Three registers, three jobs, one sheet, no register-break.

This is not a new general rule — it is §FL.2's locked map applied with one extra grain of resolution: not just *which words* per screen, but *which words at which level inside a screen*. Worth naming because it unblocks a class of cases (transactional sheets with poetic frames)

where the *moment of honesty needs protocol* fear was load-bearing for the conservative call in §FL.9.

Falsifiable claim.

A water-register sheet title earns the surface if both hold: (1) *transactional clarity preserved* — a cold reader, having tapped the chip on the Payday tab, can still tell from the sheet header alone that this is the XRP-to-RLUSD swap they just opened, without having to scroll to the line-items to confirm; and (2) *honest at sign-time* — the title sits inside the locked dialect without making the moment of signing feel evasive about which assets are moving. Protocol nouns are still present on the surface — in the line-items below the title and on the CTA — so dialect at the title level is *demotion of mechanics*, not *withholding* of them.

Status.

Graduated. Variant A — *Top up your reservoir* — ships as the new title, same eyebrow, same body line-items, same CTA. The chip-tap → sheet-open transition is now a *handoff* in one language, not a gear-change between two. Variant B is rejected for stuttering with its own eyebrow (*Headwaters* appears twice inside ten words). Variant C is rejected for replicating, badly, the title/body register separation the sheet already does well.

See also.

§FL.9 (Test 009) — *the chip whose graduation this test extends one surface deeper. §FL.10 (the first-filed Test 010) — the loud-twin chip on the wallet-confirm sheet that opened the arc this test closes.*

Part APP · Appendix G — Community Money Machine Governance Rules

The operating rules for a community-owned money machine. Decision authority, quorum, voting, dispute escalation, Reserve raid protocol, quarterly reporting, and annual audit — drawn from the canonical governance document and carried here so stewards can reference them offline.

APP.0 · About this appendix

Appendix G · Community Money Machine — Governance Rules · Version 1 · Anchored May 2026

These are not bylaws. They are the operating rules for a machine the community owns. The difference matters: bylaws live in a filing cabinet. Operating rules live at the kitchen table.

The Community Money Machine Blueprint (v4) names five governance rules but leaves the mechanics undefined. This appendix fills that gap. It answers the questions a real community will ask when they sit down to run the machine: Who decides what? When does the whole table need to weigh in? What happens when people disagree? What does the quarterly report look like? What is the exact sequence when the Reserve has to be raided?

Every rule here is grounded in the Watershed Compact decision filter and the three-tests rule from the blueprint. Nothing here contradicts a poured-concrete decision.

- APP.1 — Decision Authority Matrix: who decides what, and when the table must weigh in.
- APP.2 — Quorum: who is at the table and what counts as a valid decision.
- APP.3 — Voting Method: how decisions are recorded and what majority they require.
- APP.4 — Dispute Escalation: the two-step path before a formal vote.
- APP.5 — Reserve Raid Protocol: the named five-step sequence for any Reserve draw.
- APP.6 — Quarterly Money Machine Report: the machine's health check, four times a year.
- APP.7 — Annual Audit: the full-year reconciliation.

APP.1 · Decision Authority Matrix

Appendix G · Part 1 — who decides what

The machine has two levels of authority: steward authority and Kitchen Table authority. A bucket steward is the named person responsible for that bucket's day-to-day operation. Stewards are named during the Week 7-8 Governance Setup in the 90-Day Checklist. Stewards act alone within their lane. When a decision crosses lane boundaries, increases long-term obligations, or touches the Reserve, the Kitchen Table decides.

What each steward decides alone.

- Bucket 1 — Cost Basis steward: approve routine operating expenses already in the agreed Cost Basis; pay practitioners at the agreed rate; flag variances under 5% of monthly Cost Basis without a table meeting.
- Bucket 2 — Reserve steward: monitor balance and report monthly. Cannot authorize any draw without a table vote.
- Bucket 3 — Reinvestment steward: approve Reinvestment spends up to a single-spend ceiling set by the table at the start of each year (default: \$2,500 CAD or 10% of monthly Cost Basis, whichever is lower). Must confirm ownership-increase test before any spend.
- Bucket 4 — Eave Flow steward: confirm that overflow conditions are met before any Eave Flow is released. Cannot redirect Eave Flow to a new recipient without table approval.

What requires Kitchen Table approval.

Any of the following triggers a required table decision — not a steward call, not a 'we'll sort it later':

- Any change to the monthly Cost Basis — whether up or down. Adding a practitioner, changing compensation, or cutting an operating line all require table approval.
- Any draw on the Reserve — regardless of size. No exceptions. (See APP.5 for the full sequence.)
- Any Reinvestment spend above the single-spend ceiling.
- Any change to bucket percentages or the machine's split structure.
- Any new Eave Flow recipient — who the overflow goes to is a table decision, not a steward's gift.
- Any income stream that constitutes more than 25% of total monthly income — adding or losing it changes the machine's risk profile and the table needs to see it.
- Any partnership, contract, or agreement that creates a new recurring obligation against the Cost Basis.
- The annual audit findings — reviewed and acknowledged by the full table before they are considered closed.
- Declaration of income failure — the formal trigger for Reserve access (see APP.5).

APP.2 · Quorum

Appendix G · Part 2 — who is at the table and what counts

Who is 'at the table'.

The Kitchen Table for money machine purposes is the governing circle named during Week 7–8 of the 90-Day Checklist. It must include all four bucket stewards (or their named alternates) and at least one community member who is not a steward — a witness seat that keeps the machine honest. The minimum structure is five people: four stewards plus one witness. Seat definitions are documented and filed with the machine's governance record.

Minimum quorum for a valid decision.

Three-quarters of the named table seats must be present — in person, on a call, or by documented written consent submitted before the meeting. For a five-person table, that is four people. For an eight-person table, it is six.

The witness seat counts toward quorum. The witness seat cannot be the deciding vote on a Reserve draw or a Cost Basis change — those require at least one steward majority.

When quorum cannot be reached.

If a decision is time-sensitive and quorum cannot be assembled within seven calendar days of a trigger event:

- The bucket steward most directly affected documents the situation in writing and sends it to all table members.
- A 48-hour written consent window opens. Members who respond with written approval or objection count toward quorum for that specific decision only.
- If written responses still do not reach quorum threshold, the default action is no change — the machine holds its current course until a full meeting can happen.
- A Reserve draw cannot be authorized under the written-consent emergency path. Reserve draws require a live meeting. If a live meeting cannot happen in seven days, the machine stops spending above Cost Basis until it can.

APP.3 · Voting Method

Appendix G · Part 3 — how decisions are recorded

How decisions are recorded.

Every Kitchen Table decision on a money machine matter is recorded in the machine's governance log — a running document kept by the table's designated record-keeper. Each entry records: date and format of the meeting; who was present and whether quorum was met; what was decided, in plain language; the vote count (for / against / abstaining); any dissenting positions, summarized in one or two sentences per dissenting member. The log does not need to be long. It needs to be honest.

What constitutes agreement.

- Simple majority — more than half of those present and counted toward quorum — carries most decisions.
- Two-thirds majority is required for: any change to the Cost Basis that increases total monthly obligations by more than 15%; any Reserve draw; any change to bucket structure or split percentages; any Eave Flow recipient change.
- Unanimous consent is required for: winding down the machine entirely; transferring machine ownership or governance to a new body; any decision that permanently removes a community member's stake in the machine.

How dissent is logged.

A member who disagrees with a decision states their position plainly. The record-keeper captures it in one or two sentences. The decision proceeds. The dissent stands in the record permanently — it does not reopen the decision, but it exists as a flag for the annual audit and for future tables reviewing the history. There is no penalty for dissent. Dissent is a contribution to the machine's institutional memory. A table that never has a recorded dissent is a table that is not thinking hard enough.

APP.4 · Dispute Escalation

Appendix G · Part 4 — the two-step path before a vote

Not every disagreement needs a vote. Most disputes are navigated in two steps before a formal vote is called.

Step 1 — Direct steward conversation.

When two stewards disagree on a money machine decision, the first step is a direct conversation — just the two of them, no audience, within three business days of the disagreement surfacing. The goal is to name the actual concern underneath the disagreement: Is it a values question? A math question? A trust question? Many disputes dissolve when the actual concern is named plainly. If Step 1 resolves the dispute, the resolution is noted briefly in the governance log. No formal vote needed.

Step 2 — Kitchen Table review.

If the direct conversation does not resolve the dispute within three business days, either steward brings it to the full table at the next scheduled meeting (or calls a special session if the matter is time-sensitive). The table hears from both stewards — uninterrupted, in sequence. Then the table discusses. Then it votes if a vote is needed. The governance log captures both positions and the outcome.

There is no Step 3. The table's decision is final within the machine's operating life. If a community member believes the table has violated the machine's governance rules or the Watershed Compact, that is a separate matter handled through the community's broader governance structure — not through money machine dispute escalation.

Escalation is not a punishment process. It is not about who is right. It is about naming the disagreement clearly, giving both sides a fair hearing, and making a documented decision. A dispute that goes to Step 2 and gets resolved cleanly is the machine working correctly.

APP.5 · Reserve Raid Protocol

Appendix G · Part 5 — the named sequence for any Reserve draw

The Reserve is the community's insurance. Raiding it is a serious act with a formal sequence. The sequence exists so that the decision is never made in a panic, never made by one person, and is always traceable.

Step 1 — Income Failure Declaration.

The Cost Basis steward observes that incoming revenue has fallen below Cost Basis for two consecutive months (or projects a shortfall within the current month that cannot be covered by any other means). The steward documents this in writing and sends it to all table members. This written notice is the formal 'income failure declaration.' A single bad month is not an income failure. Two months in a row — or a single month where the shortfall is more than 50% of Cost Basis — triggers the declaration.

Step 2 — All-Hands Table Meeting.

Within five calendar days of the income failure declaration, the full table meets (live — in person or synchronous call). This meeting cannot be replaced by written consent. Quorum rules apply. The meeting has one agenda: determine whether a Reserve draw is necessary and, if so, how much. Before authorizing a draw, the table must confirm: every Cost Basis expense has been reviewed for cuts or deferrals; no Reinvestment spending is occurring; no Eave Flow is occurring; the income failure is not a result of a governance violation or mismanagement that should be corrected differently.

Step 3 — Authorization.

The table votes. A two-thirds majority is required. The vote is recorded in the governance log with every member's position noted. If authorized, the draw amount is the minimum necessary to cover the confirmed shortfall — not a round number, not a buffer against future uncertainty. The Reserve covers what is real and documented today.

Step 4 — Draw and Notification.

The Reserve steward executes the draw within two business days of authorization. All table members receive a written confirmation of the draw amount and the date it was made. The machine's current state immediately returns to Building State — regardless of what state it was in before the draw. The Reserve must be rebuilt before Reinvestment or Eave Flow resumes.

Step 5 — Replenishment Obligation.

Within 30 days of the draw, the table meets again to establish a replenishment plan. The plan names: a monthly replenishment amount; a target date to return the Reserve to its pre-draw level; the income recovery actions being taken to prevent another income failure. The replenishment plan is documented and filed with the governance record. It is reviewed at every quarterly Money Machine Report until the Reserve is restored.

A Reserve draw that is not followed by a replenishment plan within 30 days is a governance violation.

APP.6 · Quarterly Money Machine Report

Appendix G · Part 6 — the machine's health check, four times a year

What it contains.

The quarterly Money Machine Report is the machine's health check, produced four times a year. It covers:

- Opening balances — each bucket's balance at the start of the quarter, in dollars.
- Income received — total, broken down by stream, with reliability category (recurring vs. one-time).
- Bucket movements — how much moved into each bucket and why.
- Cost Basis reconciliation — actual spend vs. agreed Cost Basis, with any variance explained.
- Reserve position — current balance, current months of coverage, trajectory.
- Reinvestment activity — what was spent, what ownership it produced (or why it was held).
- Eave Flow activity — if active, what went where and why.
- Closing balances — each bucket's balance at the end of the quarter.
- Flags — anything that doesn't look right, anything that needs a table decision, any governance log items from the quarter that the full community should know about.

The report does not editorialize. It states what happened. If something went sideways, it says so plainly.

Who produces it.

The Cost Basis steward produces the report with input from all four bucket stewards. Each steward is responsible for the accuracy of their section. The record-keeper reviews the governance log entries and summarizes any decisions made during the quarter.

Where it lands.

The quarterly report is presented to the full Kitchen Table at a meeting scheduled in advance — ideally within 15 days of the quarter's end. After the table reviews it, the report is shared with the broader community in whatever format the community has agreed to (posted at the co-op, shared by email, read aloud at a community meeting). The report does not go to outside funders, governments, or platforms unless the community has explicitly decided otherwise and that decision is in the governance log.

What triggers an unscheduled report.

- A Reserve draw is authorized (the draw and replenishment plan together constitute an interim report).
- A new income stream representing more than 25% of monthly income begins or ends.
- Any bucket falls below its minimum threshold for the first time.
- The table votes to trigger one for any other reason.

APP.7 · Annual Audit

Appendix G · Part 7 — the full-year reconciliation

Once a year, every bucket is reconciled publicly. The annual audit is a full review of the machine's year: every dollar in, every dollar out, every bucket movement, every governance decision.

The annual audit is not the quarterly report. It is a complete accounting, reviewed by the full table and shared with the community. An outside community member — someone not serving as a bucket steward — should review the audit before it is finalized. This is not a formal accounting engagement. It is a community check. A second pair of eyes that has no stake in the numbers looking clean.

The annual audit date is set in the 90-Day Governance Setup and does not move without a table vote.

Grounding notes.

These rules are designed to be run at the kitchen table, not in a boardroom. They do not require lawyers, accountants, or outside facilitators. They require: people who agreed to be named stewards; a governance log someone actually keeps; a table that meets when the

rules say to meet.

The Watershed Compact's decision filter runs underneath all of this. When a governance question arises that these rules do not answer directly, the table runs the question through the five decision filter questions. That answer is the answer.

The three tests from the blueprint — ownership vs. dependency, watershed vs. leak, seven-generation scrutiny — apply to every governance decision, not just spending decisions. A governance structure that creates dependency, leaks authority to outside institutions, or would embarrass the next generation is a governance structure that needs to change.

Part CODA · Conclusion

The practitioner's own arc — from scared to prepared, from 2011 to present — and the source from which this handbook was drawn.

Coda · From scared to prepared

Coda · a practitioner's arc · 2011 to present.

It was spring 2020. The practitioner was walking a baby's stroller around the yard, watching a three-year-old move through the grass. The world was in disarray, and underneath the noise of it was one clear question: what would happen to this region if the truckers went on strike? At that moment the local co-op was gone, the farmers market was uncertain, and the grocery stores' shelves ran on three days of just-in-time supply. The answer to the question was not acceptable. So the practitioner started planning a business.

That moment in March 2020 was not the beginning. It was the activation. The beginning was 2011, when learning how money works led to a decade of quieter preparation: building the homestead's three heating systems, installing the manual well pump for the spring-fed

well, expanding the gardens, learning hydroponics and microgreens, tripling down on food preservation, acquiring chickens. Working during the time of abundance for the time of hardship the patterns suggested was coming.

The practitioner called it a *depression business* from the start — working with what you have and sticking things in jars, that's got 1930 written all over it. The business had a name: *Parrs Jars*. The umbrella organization had a name: *Above Parr Solutions*. Both names were honest about their moment. Neither was built to carry the full weight of what came next.

The naming arc.

By July 2020 the business was running. By the time the constellation had taken shape, the names had all been tested. *Parrs Jars* named the product; *Jarista* named the practitioner and the practice. *Above Parr Solutions* named the organization after its founder; *Headwaters* named it after the system — the source that feeds the whole watershed. The rename test had been run on the practitioner's own prior work, and the constellation had come out the other side.

The five courses Bobbie had been building — Preservation, Preparedness, Permaculture, Seasonal Living, Decentralization — turned out to be the zone practices, waiting for the architecture that would let them stand together as a system rather than as a product list. Same content. New structure. The naming gave the content its shape.

What grassroots community is for.

The Commons zone was built from the same logic as the Jar Kitchen: start the cart rolling. Knowing that a local food hub would not be the final answer — but also knowing that forward motion is easier to redirect than stillness — the practitioner built the infrastructure and began pursuing distribution. Collaborators arrived. The co-op took shape. The Zone 0 household practice had generated Zone 3 infrastructure.

The regulatory walls were real. The health unit required lab testing for each farm ingredient in the freeze-dried salt blends, and recommended switching to commercial ingredients instead — which was done, to meet orders, and which cost the product its story. The co-op lost its farmers market exempt status after three years of building the model to meet those regulations. Grant applications for food safety equipment were denied. The in-person market attendance fell. The juice, for many local producers, stopped being worth the squeeze.

None of that changed the thesis. *Grassroots community and productive local economies are the only fighting chance.* The Jarista does not wait for the regulatory environment to become favourable before building the Seasonal Shelf. The community does not wait for grant approval before learning to preserve. The work is done during the time of abundance, before anyone knows whether the activated state is coming. That is the Standby principle, applied to a practitioner's own life.

What the practitioner commits to.

- Building food skills — the compounding asset of the homestead.
- Inspiring community — showing up, because community makes everything easier and developing community is not easy.
- Helping others — mentorship, the co-op's incubation program, sharing the decade of learning.
- Productive hobbies — hunting, fishing, foraging, trapping. Not hobbies in the leisure sense. Named as primary sourcing channels.
- Raising good men who think for themselves and practice empathy — the multi-generational frame. The constellation is not built for this generation alone.

A depression may be around the corner but being depressed never has to be a reality we face. The world is your oyster in good times and bad when you build your life around the simple things that matter.

Freedom is not granted. Freedom is claimed — one Preservation Season at a time, one jar at a time, one community institution at a time. The discipline codetory adds is small: name the thing correctly, test the name by trying to rename it, and refuse to let the generic vocabulary quietly erase what makes the practice specific. The Jarista, the Jar Kitchen, the Seasonal Shelf, the Harvest Hold, the Bulk Round, Preservation Season — these names are the practice made legible. Keep them.

Tool: Your Constellation — name your six zones — The Jarista named her zones so the practice could be taught and held. Name yours. Zone 0 through Zone 5, in your vocabulary — not the founding examples, yours.

Tool: Daily Driver — Build backwards from your dream. One driver per project, one action per day. Track what is pivotal and keep moving when the road changes.

C · The Source

This handbook was authored in 2026 alongside the constellation it draws its founding examples from. The constellation lives at the practitioner's working URL; the canonical Codetry working-doc lives at /practitioner-operating-plan/codetry; the machine-readable constellation manifest, frozen as a snapshot in this app, lives at /practitioner-operating-plan/constellation.json.

Voice and editorial decisions follow the constellation's own quiet, declarative register. No marketing.

The discipline named here is offered in the spirit of the four teachers above and Thunder alongside them.

For the community development practitioners who pick this up: the names will be your own. Use the discipline; throw away the examples. That is the only correct way to read this book.

Version 0.5.7 · 2026-05-05. Readable offline. Field-tested in Northwestern Ontario.

FORMAL VOCABULARY (GLOSSARY)

Formal Vocabulary

Activated state

Chapter reference: Ch4

One of the two operational states of The Standby. The infrastructure is the same as the resting state; only the valve position changes. In activated state: open call, deployed stock, live rosters in motion. The name holds across both states.

Both-sides

Chapter reference: Ch4

A test for naming a primitive that faces two contexts simultaneously. Does the umbrella name hold from the bright side and from the systems side? If the name privileges one context, the membrane becomes a wall. Same word, different room. Also the refusal criterion for BLM word candidates: does the word hold when explained to a band council elder and to an auditor in the same sentence? If one reading erases the other, the word fails. If both readings are simultaneously correct, the word passes — and any collision it carries is load-bearing, not accidental.

BLM refused word

Chapter reference: Ch4 / BLM Glossary

Bright Side Language Model refused word. A term tested for use in Headwaters vocabulary that was flagged for collision with an existing concept, examined to determine whether the collision blurs or unifies meaning, and either rejected or accepted with an explicit note. The four-step protocol: (1) word flagged for collision; (2) collision examined — does it blur meaning (reject) or reveal that two concepts share a single boundary (unify)?; (3) if unified, accepted with an explicit note; (4) the note becomes the glossary entry. The collision is documented, not hidden. Refusal criterion: the Both-Sides test — does the word hold when read by a band council elder and by an auditor simultaneously? First entry: cap.

Both-states

Chapter reference: Ch4

A test for naming a primitive that moves between tempos. Does the umbrella name hold in the resting state and in the activated state? If the name bends to fit only one tempo, the system will eventually fork into two systems with two cultures. Same word, different rung.

Bright side

Chapter reference: Ch4

The community's own dialect — the words a community uses with itself in its own kitchens, meetings, and ledgers. Neighbour. Channel. The books. Standby stock. The watch. Neither informal nor incorrect. Simply a different room. The name originates in dementia care practice: an effective support person cannot hold the systems' frame of reality and do the work simultaneously. Not because that side is better, but because certain things are only visible from inside it.

Centralized disruption

Chapter reference: Ch4

The class of event that activates The Standby: conditions that temporarily remove or degrade a shared infrastructure the whole constellation depends on. Examples: drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power failure, water outage, freight disruption, payment system failure, pandemic, evacuation, postponed AGM, key-person-down. Named as a class so the constellation can distinguish a Standby call from a household-level crisis handled inside Zone 0.

Codetry

Chapter reference: Ch3 origin, Ch4 vocabulary

The practice of building software whose primary load-bearing material is metaphor. The naming is the architecture; the code is the medium that makes the metaphor real, clickable, and runnable. The unit of care is the name: the chosen noun carries the constraint, and the schema, the UI, and the verbs of the app follow from it. Rename a primitive — Buckets to Categories, Practitioner to Founder — and the structure quietly changes shape underneath the name. (Ch3 states the definition in full; this entry formalises it in the vocabulary. “Codetry disciplines” is the collective descriptor for the named practices — constellation, primitives, principles — that codetry runs on; it is not a separate entry.)

Constellation

Chapter reference: Ch4

The full set of economic systems a community runs together. Not a network (which implies optional connection) and not an organization (which implies a single structure). A constellation: distinct systems, gravitationally related, each doing its own job.

Drift

Chapter reference: Ch3 / Ch4

The failure that occurs when a community's load-bearing noun is translated — even into a cleaner, more general, or more reusable noun — without the community's recognition or consent. Drift is not announced as a loss; each move feels like cleanup, like progress, like professionalism. The codetry-test exists because drift is invisible to the type checker and obvious to the person who handed you the word. (Codetry-test is the informal name for the

discipline's ongoing verification posture — when in doubt, check against the human who gave you the word, not against the literature or the model; it is not a separate named procedure.)

The Gate

Chapter reference: Ch4

The primitive that holds the community's own language (bright side) and institutional language (the systems) as two simultaneous sides of one membrane. It decides what crosses, logs every substitution, and refuses to translate what has no honest equivalent. The constellation's second non-zone primitive. Full eight-word vocabulary: see Appendix I.

Knowledge creep / Language drift

Chapter reference: Ch3 / Ch4

Two named failure modes that together constitute drift in practice. Knowledge creep: a word a person used in a kitchen ends up, three meetings later, as a different word in a deck — the concept stays but the noun wanders. Language drift: the books becomes the ledger becomes the financial management module — the noun is swapped for a cleaner, more general one and the original word is no longer in the room. Neither announces itself as a loss.

The systems

Chapter reference: Ch4

The outside world's dialect — the language a regulator, banker, funder, or lawyer will accept. Resident. Bank account. Financial statements. Inventory reserves. Compliance officer. Neither dialect is wrong inside its own context. Each is unfit currency in the other's.

Practitioner

Chapter reference: Ch1-Ch5, Ch4 vocabulary

A person practicing codetory within a community: listening for the noun the community already uses, refusing to translate it into something cleaner, and verifying against the person who handed them the word rather than against the literature, the model, or their own better idea. A posture, not a role specification. The practitioner's exit is handover, not compound. (Practitioner's workbench: the practitioner's own named tool — the place where

the week is planned, the costs are walked, and the work is kept honest against what was said it would be. The rename from “founder's dashboard” to “practitioner's workbench” is itself a codetory move; practitioner's workbench is a sub-entry, not a standalone primitive.)

Primitive

Chapter reference: Ch4

A named system inside the constellation that does a specific, irreducible job. Each primitive has a name chosen to hold across every context in which it appears — zones, seasons, personnel, tempo.

Refused

Chapter reference: Ch4

A Gate outcome for source-side language that has no honest equivalent in the target dialect. The word does not cross. The document notes the gap. Protecting the word is more important than completing the translation. Refused is a first-class outcome — not a failure, not a footnote.

Resting state

Chapter reference: Ch4

One of the two operational states of The Standby. In resting state: always-on preparation — stocked shelves, current contact trees, regular test-starts, the watch reading morning advisories. The infrastructure is the same as the activated state; only the valve position changes.

The Standby

Chapter reference: Ch4

The primitive that holds emergency preparedness and emergency response as one system. In its resting state: always-on practice, stocked shelves, current contact trees, regular test-starts. In its activated state: open call, deployed stock, live rosters. One infrastructure, two states, one name. The constellation's first non-zone primitive. Full six-word vocabulary: see Appendix I.

Zone

Chapter reference: Ch4

A domain of practice inside the constellation. Six zones, numbered by proximity to the household: Zone 0 — Saltbox (household); Zone 1 — Kitchen Table — your circle (invite), identity layer: Lodge; Zone 2 — Workbench (practitioner's workbench, operating plan, contracted work); Zone 3 — Greenhouse (community exchange, 807 co-op, board-governed); Zone 4 — The Clearing (voluntary informal association, Nursery / Fodder / Fallow, graduation gate to Zone 3); Zone 5 — Edge / Shallows (open public, anonymous DID). Primitives are hosted in zones but read by all zones. Full zone flow: Zone 5 wild idea → Zone 4 informal shaping → Zone 3 approval + contract → Zone 2 paid execution → Zone 3 operation → Zone 4 collective benefit → Path A return drift to Zone 5.

Lodge

Chapter reference: Ch4 / §5.9

The confirmed name for the Zone 1 household identity layer. A Lodge identity is what a household holds below the Eave: a name the circle recognises, without disclosure to Zone 3+. Entry is by invitation and passphrase. Private — not public, not institutional. Earned by invitation — not enrolled, not registered. Held by a group with shared values, revocable by the keeper of the door. The rename test was run against Membership, Profile, and Household ID; all three cracked. Lodge is load-bearing.

Appendix Sub-Terms

A call

*Chapter reference: Ch4 body / App I · The Standby***

A specific active event within The Standby's activated state. An open call triggers roster deployment and stock release; the system runs in active until the call stands down.

The debrief

*Chapter reference: Ch4 body / App I · The Standby***

After-action synthesis conducted once a call stands down. The mechanism by which the Standby learns from each activated event.

Standby stock

*Chapter reference: Ch4 body / App I · The Standby***

The always-on reserves maintained during resting state. The physical/material sub-shelf of the Standby primitive; also survives as a sub-shelf noun inside the umbrella alongside The Common Pantry and The Watch.

The watch

*Chapter reference: Ch4 body / App I · The Standby***

The active-monitoring posture during resting state: reading the morning advisory, keeping contact trees current, running generator test-starts. Also named as a rejected umbrella name for The Standby (too fast-side-only to hold the slow shelf).

Nursery

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 4 formation model · Zone 4 Formation***

The Zone 4 sub-shelf for new cooperative ideas in earliest formation — no history, no scar tissue, open slate. A Nursery idea has not yet been through the world.

Fodder

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 4 formation model · Zone 4 Formation***

The Zone 4 sub-shelf for Zone 3 ideas returned for reworking. Carries history and scar tissue; distinct from Nursery. Named honestly so the difference between a new idea and a returned one is never flattened. A Fodder idea has already survived one round of the world.

Fallow

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 4 formation model · Zone 4 Formation***

The Zone 4 sub-shelf for ideas resting between attempts, not formally demoted. Fallow ground still has life in it; fallow is not failure.

Graduation gate

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 4 formation model · Zone 4 Formation***

The moment a Zone 4 cooperative idea becomes a fully formed, actionable pilot handed to the Zone 3 producer board for a vote per 807's bylaws. Graduating means surviving one full cycle without 807 eating the risk. The board votes only at graduation — not during formation.

Economic floor mechanism

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 4 formation model · Zone 4 Formation***

807 frames Zone 4 ideas in outside-world dialect → writes grants → grants fund Zone 2 workbenches of the people doing Zone 4 formation work → strengthened Zone 2 capacity → better Zone 4 output → Zone 3 graduation → Zone 3 surplus eventually funds Zone 2 directly. Without a funded Zone 2 layer, Zone 4 stagnates.

Dead backwater

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Zone 5 · Zone 5***

Named failure mode for Zone 5 (The Shallows): the feed goes quiet, tip flow drops to zero, no new DIDs wading in. Prevention is Zone 3 and Zone 4's job, not Zone 5's.

A calm membrane

*Chapter reference: App II · The Gate***

The governing metaphor for The Gate: selectively permeable, alive, not a wall and not an open door. Describes how the Gate holds bright side and the systems simultaneously without collapsing into either.

A category

*Chapter reference: App II · The Gate***

The domain a mapping belongs to, used to organize the Gate's ledger of registered correspondences.

A mapping

*Chapter reference: App II · The Gate***

A registered correspondence between a bright-side term and its systems-side equivalent. The foundational record in the Gate's ledger.

A substitution

*Chapter reference: App II · The Gate***

One applied instance of a mapping: the act of replacing a term from one side with its mapped equivalent for a specific document or context.

A translation

*Chapter reference: App II · The Gate***

The auditable record of what crossed the Gate and what changed in the crossing.

The household seal

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

The Z0 key custody object: a standard letter envelope sealed with a wax disc or tamper-evident strip, signed across the seal face by the primary holder. The signed seal is the broken-glass equivalent — opening it leaves a break legible to every household member without instruction. The household seal lives in the household's main gathering space, visible to all adult members in the course of a normal day, and never behind a secondary access barrier. The Saltbox Zone Zero equivalent of the household jar: tangible, communal, visible, non-trivial to access without noticing. The Systems term: primary physical key custody record.

Primary holder

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

The adult who signs the household seal, initiates all custody events, and holds the first-call obligation in a custody breach. In a multi-adult household, exactly one adult holds primary custody at any moment; the role may rotate, but rotation is itself a custody event. In a single-adult household, the primary holder names an external witness to hold the pattern knowledge. The Systems term: authorized key custodian.

Witness position

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

The custody role held by every adult household member who is not the primary holder. The witness does not co-sign, co-hold, or act in place of the primary holder. The witness function is to confirm that a custody event occurred, that it was expected, and that the seal was in

good order before and after. In a single-adult household, the witness position is held by a named external third party. The Systems term: secondary custody acknowledgment role.

Custody event

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

Expected, recorded, and uncontested access to the household seal. Initiated by the primary holder; the reason is known or knowable to the household; the log is updated before the seal is re-set; the new seal is set the same day. A custody event that is not logged is a breach condition, not a custody event — even if the access was legitimate. The Systems term: authorized custodial access; custody record updated.

Custody breach

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

Unexpected, contested, or undocumented access to the household seal. Triggered when: the seal is broken with no log entry; the envelope is found at the wrong location; the primary holder denies the access; a non-primary member opened the seal without logged transfer of primary custody; or the envelope is missing without explanation. A breach is named before it is investigated — naming stops the household from consuming the notification window in private ambiguity. Naming a breach opens the override chain record. The Systems term: unauthorized or undocumented key custody access; override chain record initiated.

The custody log

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

A handwritten folded card kept inside the household seal envelope alongside the keys. Records each custody event: date, primary holder's hand, reason for access, new seal number. Also names the external witness for single-adult households. The log is the paper chain-record at Z0 — not digital, not mediated, legible to any household member. The Systems term: physical custody record.

Seal number

*Chapter reference: Ch4 — Z0 Key Custody · Z0 Key Custody***

A sequential integer written in pen on the envelope face before each re-sealing. Each custody event produces a new seal number. The seal number links a log entry to the physical state of the envelope at the time of that event, providing an auditable sequence without

digital infrastructure. The Systems term: custody record sequence number.

BLM Refused Words

Cap

*Chapter reference: BLM Glossary — Entry #1 · BLM Refused Words***

A practitioner's credential and authorization ceiling, held simultaneously. Who you are and what you can authorize are the same boundary in Headwaters. The credential and the ceiling are the same object. Both-Sides test result: passes. A band council elder reads 'cap' as the authority you carry to the table; an auditor reads 'cap' as the maximum a role can authorize. Both readings are correct. The word holds. Collision note: almost refused because Headwaters is full of financial ceilings (spending cap, budget cap, income cap). The collision is intentional — in Headwaters, authorization is not separate from identity. A financial ceiling is not a cap; it is a limit or threshold. Community-facing term: cap. Chain record term: warrant (the ledger entry that records what a cap authorizes). Refusal note: cap was the first BLM refused word to survive its collision and enter the vocabulary.

Limit / Threshold

*Chapter reference: BLM Glossary — financial ceiling replacement · BLM Refused Words***

The term for budget, spending, and income ceilings in Headwaters financial records. Used specifically to keep 'cap' available for its credential-and-identity meaning. A limit is a number in a ledger; it applies to a line item. A threshold is a trigger point — when crossed, it changes a decision. Neither carries the identity weight of a cap. Going forward: budget limits, spending limits, income thresholds. Not: budget caps, spending caps, income caps.

TALES

The Button She Almost Didn't Press

A tale about labour, patience, and the weight of meaning

Kaya had been inside for eleven days. Not sick. Not grounded. Just — inside. The summer had gotten long in a way summers sometimes do when you're sixteen and there's nothing that needs you.

Kaya had been inside for eleven days.

Not sick. Not grounded. Just — inside. The summer had gotten long in a way summers sometimes do when you're sixteen and there's nothing that needs you.

Her cousin was at her dad's in Thunder Bay. The community centre was doing little kids' programs. Everyone seemed to be somewhere that wasn't for her.

She opened the Helping Hands app the way you open the fridge when you're not hungry — just to see.

There was a section she'd never clicked: Skills. A list of things people in the community knew how to do. Beading. Bannock. Net repair. Chainsaw maintenance. Cree syllabics. And near the bottom, under Food and Harvest:

Wild Rice Harvesting.

She didn't know why she stopped there. She'd eaten wild rice her whole life. She'd never thought about where it came from, exactly. The lake. Obviously the lake. But she'd never been out there when it happened.

There was a small button beneath the description. It just said: I'm watching this.

She pressed it. Nothing happened. The screen didn't change. No confetti. No notification. She put her phone down and went back to watching the ceiling.

Four days later, Margaret Swain called her.

Kaya almost didn't answer. She didn't know Margaret well — she was an old woman who lived near the dock, the kind of person adults talked about with a certain respectful hush. She had a boat she'd been taking out alone for forty years.

I saw your name on the list, Margaret said. You want to learn the rice?

Kaya said yes before she understood what she was agreeing to.

They went out the first morning before the sun was fully up.

The lake smelled like cold and green things. Margaret handed her a pole and showed her how to hold it — low, steady, moving from the hips, not the arms. They pushed through the rice beds in silence. The stalks were taller than Kaya expected, brushing against her arms, the grains hanging heavy at the top.

Not yet, Margaret said.

How do you know?

Pinch one. Rub it. Is it soft or does it hold?

Kaya tried. She didn't know what she was feeling for.

Soft, Margaret said. We wait.

They went out four mornings that week and came back each time without rice. Kaya learned to read the colour of the stalk. She learned how the grains sounded against each other when the wind came through — not ready, not ready, not ready. She learned that Margaret never seemed impatient, and that this was itself a kind of teaching.

On the fifth morning, Margaret reached up, rubbed a grain between her fingers, and looked at her.

Today, she said.

The ricing sticks were smooth from decades of use. Margaret showed her the motion — one stick to bend the stalk over the canoe, one to knock the grains loose. Gentle but decisive. You weren't hitting the rice, you were inviting it to fall.

At first Kaya was too hard. Rice scattered into the water.

Not like that, Margaret said. She didn't explain further. She just showed her again.

Kaya tried softer. More rice stayed. She found the rhythm slowly — bend, knock, bend, knock — the grains raining down into the hull in a sound she had never heard before and would not forget. Dry and full and alive.

Her arms ached by midmorning. Her back hurt in a new way. The mosquitoes found the gap between her collar and her hat. The sun came up and the lake got bright and she kept going because Margaret kept going, and stopping felt like the wrong answer to something, though

she couldn't have said what the question was.

They worked through the morning until the canoe was heavy with it. The rice lay in the hull like small dark keys, thousands of them — all that waiting, now something real you could hold.

Margaret cut the engine on the way back and let them drift for a moment.

My grandmother showed me, she said. Hers showed her. It goes back further than either of us can name.

Kaya looked at the rice. She looked at her sore hands. She didn't say anything because there wasn't anything to say that would fit.

That night, opening the app to show her mom, Kaya noticed her name had moved. Under wild rice harvesting, where it used to say Watching, it now said Learning.

She wasn't sure how to explain what that meant. It was just a word on a screen.

But she'd been out on that lake. She'd waited when the rice said wait. She'd learned the knock that doesn't scatter. She'd come home with something real in the hull and something different in her chest — a kind of weight she'd been missing without knowing it.

She put her phone down.

Tomorrow, Margaret said, they would parch it.

There was more to learn.

In the Helping Hands skill directory, wild rice harvesting lives under Food and Harvest. Anyone can press I'm watching this. The Knowledge Holder who carries the skill sees your name. What happens after that has been happening on this lake for longer than the app — longer than the phones — longer than most of the words we have for it. The technology just made sure the door was easy to find.

Author note: The Watching stage is the door before the door. No commitment, no test, no credentials. Just: I see this and I'm curious. Someone who holds something real sees your name. That thread — between a restless kid and a person with forty years in a boat — is what the system is actually for.

The Girl Who Waited for the Eagle

A tale for children of all ages, on every kind of ground

There was once a girl who had too many ideas. She wrote them all down — thousands of them — and waited to learn what they were for.

There was once a girl who had too many ideas.

They came to her in the morning before she opened her eyes. They came to her in the river, in the shape of the current. They came to her in the market, watching the old women trade things that had no price tags — a jar of something, a word of something, a promise of something.

She wrote them all down. Thousands of them. Pages and pages of ideas that had no shape yet, only a direction.

What are they for? people would ask.

I don't know yet, she would say. But I will.

She had been watching eagles her whole life.

Not looking for them. Watching them. There is a difference. Looking is hoping something will come. Watching is being ready when it does.

Eagles do not come when you call. They come when you are ready for what they carry.

She had learned this the slow way.

For years she walked into communities and told them what she thought she had.

Most listened politely. Some said interesting. None said yes.

She drove home on long roads and asked the sky: Is this the right direction?

The sky did not answer. Or maybe it did, and she was not yet ready to hear it.

Then one morning she was standing outside, writing in the early cold, and she asked herself the question again — the same question, worn smooth from so many years of asking.

Is this the right direction?

And an eagle appeared.

Not circling far away. Not a shape on the horizon. He came from nowhere and dropped low, and held himself above her in the wind — like he was reading her, the way she had spent years reading the land.

She said, Well, hello.

He stayed.

She asked again: Is this the right direction?

He rose in a slow circle — once, twice — and flew out of sight.

She stood still for a long time.

She understood that some questions take much longer to answer than you expect. And that the answer had already been yes — she just hadn't heard it yet.

Not long after, she found herself sitting in a small room with a very old woman.

The old woman's hands were the most knowledgeable thing about her. They moved when she talked, like they were drawing the story in the air before the words arrived.

The girl had been told: do not bring your ideas into this room. She had left them outside, in her bag, in the car.

She brought nothing but her ears.

The old woman talked for a long time about things that had no English words. She talked about how her people said enough in a way that also meant full and grateful. How they said trade in a way that also meant we are part of each other's story now. How they said home in

a way that held the river, the season, the name of a grandmother, and a specific kind of light all at once.

The girl listened.

Then, very quietly, she asked: Would it be alright if I wrote some of these down?

The old woman looked at her for a long time.

Not yet, she said. Come back.

The girl came back. Again and again. Each time, she brought less. Each time, she was invited further in.

One afternoon the old woman said: The problem with your people's words is they sit still. Ours move. You can't put a moving word in a box.

What if the box moved with it? the girl said.

The old woman was quiet. Then she smiled.

Show me, she said.

And that was how the ledger began.

Not with an idea or a plan. Just an old woman saying show me — and a girl who had stopped talking and started listening.

The ledger was not a dictionary. It was not a translation. It was a living record — words in the shape they lived in that community, connected to the people who carried them, updated when the community said so, closed to the outside world unless the community opened it.

It belonged to them. She was only the one who had learned to hold it carefully.

She told her children about it at bedtime, years later.

What did the eagle mean? her youngest asked.

She thought about it.

I think he meant: you are slow enough now. You are ready.

Ready for what?

To be useful without being in charge of it.

Her child thought about this for a while.

That sounds hard, he said.

It is, she said. It takes about thirty years.

Author note: A true story, told sideways. The eagle was real. The waiting was real. The old woman is still waiting to be found. This work is for her.

The Girl Who Never Knew

A coming-of-age tale, told in decades

She had always worn her heart on the outside, where everyone could see it. She thought that was simply how hearts worked. She didn't know, then, what she was being prepared for.

She was born with her heart already outside her chest.

Not broken — just worn on the outside, where everyone could see it. She didn't know this made her different. She thought that was simply how hearts worked.

She lived at the edge of the trees, where the yard gave way to roots and shadows and a deep kind of quiet. She brought wildflowers to the neighbours without being asked. She sat with the old dog next door when it was sick. She noticed, without being told, when someone was about to cry — and she would simply stay nearby, because being close was its own kind of help.

Her world was small. And in that smallness, it was full.

Her mother called her beautiful inside and out. She accepted this the way she accepted most things — warmly, without question. She didn't know, then, that not every girl heard those words.

She didn't know, then, what the world outside the trees was made of.

When she became a teenager, she pulled her circle tighter — not from fear, exactly, but from a kind of knowing.

She had found her nook. A corner of the forest that was hers to tend. She knew which mosses grew along the north-facing rocks, which paths stayed dry after rain, which branches held the best quiet. She kept it beautiful the only way she knew how: slowly, tenderly, a little at a time.

Her friends were few and chosen. Her joy was specific. She did not need much from the world because she had learned how to make enough from what was near.

Some people called this small.

She called it enough.

She didn't know, then, that enough can be a wall as much as a gift.

University took her to bigger rooms and louder voices. She moved through them quietly — always finding the calmer edges and the places where the noise didn't reach.

She was supposed to graduate on time. There was one course — a small one, taken online — that stood between her and the finish line. But it never quite arrived. The screen felt thin and far away, and outside the window there were always more beautiful things to look at. Always some reason to disappear back through the trees.

So when the calendar gave her one more semester and the chance to choose something of her own, she chose a course she couldn't explain. A program. A place. The heart of downtown Winnipeg, which might as well have been another country.

She was pulled there for reasons she couldn't name. A lot of reasons, none of them in words.

So she went.

The room was small — a relief. But the faces were unfamiliar, and that was a new kind of discomfort.

She sat the way she had always sat: with big ears and a tender heart. And she listened.

What she heard undid her.

These were people of all ages — some her parents' age, some younger than she expected. And one by one, in that room in the heart of the city, they opened their lives and let her look inside. Stories of things she had no word for. Experiences that her small and careful world had never once prepared her to hold.

She went home each night and cried herself quiet.

Not from sadness, exactly. From the rearranging.

Thirty days. Thirty days of a world she had not known was there — grey in the places she had always imagined as bright, and pitch black in corners that had never once occurred to her. People who had seemingly never, not once, felt warmth from the inside.

It tore her to pieces.

And then, slowly, it put her back together differently.

She didn't know, then, that this was the gift. That being broken open is how you make room for more.

Years later she would be sitting on a deck, watching the light go long across the yard, and she would think: that was the moment. That room. That city. Those thirty days. That was where the path turned.

She hadn't seen it clearly then. You never do.

But she would sit at a table, later still, and watch an old woman's hands — the way they moved without hurry, the way they held things gently, the way they had learned, over a long life, to carry what was heavy without letting it show.

And she would understand, finally, what she had been learning all along.

That a heart worn on the outside is not a weakness.

It is a kind of readiness.

She just never knew, until then, what she was ready for.

Author note: Some rooms change you before you understand what happened inside them. The gift usually arrives looking like loss.

The Fish Who Stopped Trying to Climb

On knowing what you were built for

She had been told her whole life that the ones who get somewhere are the ones who climb. She believed it. She spent two summers trying to get up the tree.

She had been told her whole life that the ones who get somewhere are the ones who climb.

The heron said it from the top of the dead cedar. The osprey said it by going where she could not follow. The people on the bank showed it without words — they always looked up when they talked about the future, never down.

She was a small fish in a small creek. The creek ran cold and clear through the tamarack bog, past the old beaver dam, under the road, into the lake. It was a good creek. Everyone agreed it was too small.

Climb, they said. That is how you get somewhere.

She tried.

In June she flopped herself out onto the bank, gripped the roots of the cedar, and pulled. She got nowhere. The mud was soft and she fell back into the water breathing sideways.

She tried again in July. The mud was harder. She got higher — almost a body length up the root before she fell. She lay in the shallows a long time after that.

I am doing this wrong, she thought. I must be doing this wrong.

By August she had stopped trying at night. She lay in the deep cold beneath the beaver dam and looked up at the light rippling on the surface and told herself she would try again in the morning.

She didn't tell anyone she had stopped. It felt like something to be ashamed of.

In September the rains came hard.

In three days the creek rose over its banks. The water moved down through the tamaracks in a wide silver sheet, and she went with it — not choosing, just carried. She passed through the culvert. She passed through the shallows at the lake's edge. She passed through the cold seam where the creek water and the lake water met, and then she was somewhere she had never been.

She stopped trying to hold on.

The current knew where to go.

In two days she had seen more of the world than she had seen in her whole life.

She swam through the shadow of the osprey without being taken. She found the deep pool behind the boulder where the big trout rested in the heat of the day, and they moved aside without a word. She felt the place where a cold spring entered from below — icy cold in just a body length — and she understood, for the first time, that water came from somewhere. It came from deep in the ground. It had been there a long time before it found its way out.

She had swum down, not up.

And in the going down, she had found the whole river.

By October she could read the water the way some people read a map.

She knew which bends went dry in drought and which held the deep pools that never emptied. She knew the gravel bars where the sunlight reached and the shaded banks where it didn't. She knew the cold patches and the warm shallows and the places where the river looked fast but wasn't — and the places where it moved exactly as fast as it seemed.

She had not learned any of this from a teacher. She had learned it from being inside it.

The river gave her what the tree never could. Not a view from above. A knowledge from within.

One evening in late October a child sat on the bank above the deep pool. She was young — maybe eight — with a stick and a line and a look on her face like she had been sent here by someone and wasn't sure why.

The fish rose near the surface. Not to be caught. Just to see.

The child saw the fish. The fish saw the child. They stayed like that — still in the last of the light — for longer than either of them planned.

I don't know why I'm here, the child said. Not to the fish. Just to the water.

The fish turned and swam slowly upstream.

The child stood and followed along the bank, stepping through the tall grass, over the roots, around the beaver dam. The fish led in the water. The child followed on land. Neither of them spoke. They went together for a long time in the last light.

When they reached the cold spring, the fish circled twice.

The child knelt at the bank and put her hand in the water. It was cold and clean and came from deep in the ground, from somewhere old and dark and patient. It had been there longer than either of them. It would be there long after.

The child looked at the fish for a long moment.

Then she picked up a smooth stone from the bottom, put it in her pocket, and walked back the way she came. She didn't know what she was taking it home for.

That was all right.

Some things don't need to be understood before they become yours.

The fish went back to the deep pool and rested.

She had not climbed anything.

She had gone where the water went, and found that the whole river was her home.

Author note: The freedom was never up the tree. It was already in the current — the fish just had to stop trying to climb long enough to feel it. The things we have been told to want and the things we were built for are sometimes the same, and sometimes they are not. Learning to tell the difference is not a single moment of clarity. It is a whole river, moved through over time. The child takes a stone home without knowing why. That is how it works — the knowing comes later, if it comes at all. The going is enough.

The Boy Who Counted the Rings

On learning that is not done to you

His grandfather handed him the knife before he had asked for it. That was the first lesson — that the lesson does not wait for you to be ready.

The tree came down in early December, after the ground had frozen hard enough to drag on.

His grandfather cut it — a white spruce, old and straight, taller than the barn — and when it fell it made a sound the boy felt in his chest. Then his grandfather walked to the stump, crouched down, and looked at it for a long time without saying anything.

The boy came and crouched beside him. The stump was wide — wider than his arms could reach — and the rings inside it ran close together in some places and far apart in others. He had learned in school that you could read the age of a tree in the rings. He waited for his grandfather to start reading.

His grandfather reached into his jacket and handed him a knife.

You count them, he said.

The boy looked at him. He had expected to watch. He had expected to be told.

Start at the outside and work in, his grandfather said. That's all.

Then he stood, went to the sled, and started cutting branches.

The boy knelt at the stump and pressed the blade lightly against the wood. The rings were thin near the outside — the last few years — and he traced each one with the tip of the knife, counting under his breath.

He lost count at thirty-one. Started again.

He lost count again at forty-something. The rings got blurry where they ran close together.

He pressed his thumb against the wood instead. He could feel the difference between the dense rings and the wide ones — the hard years and the easy years, though he did not know that yet in those words. He went slowly. He started to understand where one ring ended and the next began not by looking but by feeling, the way you learn a path in the dark.

He counted eighty-seven rings before he reached the center, where the wood was dark and tight.

His grandfather came back and looked over his shoulder.

Eighty-seven, the boy said.

His grandfather was quiet for a moment. He ran his own thumb along a stretch of close rings near the middle of the stump.

That was a dry spell, he said. Tree barely grew.

The boy looked at the tight rings and looked at the wide ones and suddenly he could read them — not every detail, but the shape of the story. The hard years narrow. The good years wide. The tree remembering every season it had ever been through, in the wood itself.

How did you know I could do it? the boy asked.

His grandfather picked up the knife and folded it closed and handed it back to him.

I didn't know, he said. But you did it anyway.

The boy kept the knife. He did not know yet what else it would open.

Eighty-seven years of weather, in the wood of a tree that fell on a December morning. You don't need to be told what that means. You just need to count it yourself.

Author note: The lesson is not in the telling. It is in the doing before you feel ready — the knife in your hand before you asked for it, the counting that gets harder before it gets easier. A grandfather who explains robs the grandchild of the discovery. One who hands over the knife and walks away gives something that cannot be taught any other way.

The Girl Who Stopped Waiting for Spring

On the aliveness that does not wait for permission

Every year she waited for the ice to break. Every year, when it did, she felt like herself again. One February she started wondering where that feeling had been going in between.

Every year she waited for the ice to break on the lake.

It happened in April, sometimes May. There was a sound to it — not a crack so much as a low, settling groan, like the lake was exhaling something it had held all winter. She had been hearing that sound her whole life and it still made her stop whatever she was doing and listen.

When the ice broke she felt like herself again. Full and awake and in the right place. She could not have explained it to anyone who asked.

The months between freeze and breakup — October through May — she spent in a kind of holding. Not unhappy. Not exactly. Just waiting. Keeping herself in reserve until the world said it was time.

One February, the hardest month, the one that showed no signs of ending, she was looking out the back window at the yard when she saw it.

A small push of green, coming up through the snow at the base of the fence.

She went outside in her coat and crouched down to look at it. The ground was still frozen six inches down. The temperature had not been above minus ten in three weeks. Whatever this was had no business being here. Nothing had said it could.

And yet.

She watched it for the next two weeks. Some mornings it was buried under new snow and she would find it again when the snow shifted — still green, still pushing, as if it had not gotten the message that this was not its season.

It did not ask if it was time. It did not look at the ice on the lake. It grew toward something it could not see yet, through ground that had not softened, in a month that gave it nothing to work with.

She started going outside in the mornings to check on it. She did not tell anyone. It was hers in a way she could not explain.

April came. The ice broke — she heard it, the same exhale — and she went to the lake the way she always did, and stood at the edge, and felt it: the fullness, the waking.

But this year it was different. This year she recognized it.

She had felt this in February, kneeling in the snow at the base of the fence. She had felt it every morning she went outside to check on the green thing that grew without permission. The feeling had not been stored away waiting for the ice. The feeling had been available the whole time. She just had not known to look for it before April.

The ice broke anyway.

But this year she was already there when it did.

Author note: The aliveness that arrives with spring is real. But the capacity for it was never seasonal. It was only ever waiting for her to stop waiting. The February green that grows without permission is not a lesson — it's a reminder. The internal drive that needs an external cue to feel legitimate is still the drive. It just hasn't trusted itself yet.

The Elder Who Sat at the Creek

On the kind of teaching that happens without a lesson

Everyone thought she was resting. She was not resting. But she never corrected anyone about it.

Every afternoon at the same time, the old woman walked down the slope behind the house and sat at the same place on the bank where the creek bent around the root of an old birch.

She brought nothing with her. She did not fish. She did not read. She sat and she looked at the water.

The children called it her resting time. They said it the way children say things they have learned from adults without understanding — with a careful respect that was mostly just caution. She heard them. She did not correct them.

The first child who came to sit beside her was the restless one — the one who couldn't be still anywhere else, who moved through every room like something was chasing her. She came and sat on the bank and lasted four minutes before she got up and left.

She came back the next day. She lasted six minutes.

The old woman said nothing. She watched the water.

By the end of the week the restless one was lasting twenty minutes, and she had stopped fidgeting by the third day. She was watching the place where the current split around the root that reached into the water — the way it went smooth on one side and rippled on the other. She watched it the way you watch something you are trying to understand.

Then the curious one came. Then two more. By midsummer there were often three or four children on the bank at any given afternoon, and the old woman among them, and no one speaking.

They began to see things.

The dragonfly that held still in moving air. The heron downstream who could stand in the current without shifting for twenty minutes at a time. The way the light hit the water differently in the hour before the sun went behind the tree line — everything going gold and then going quiet. The place on the far bank where the mink came every third day or so, so reliable you could set your afternoon by it.

They did not talk about what they saw. They just saw it.

One afternoon the curious one asked:

What are you looking for?

The old woman was quiet for a moment.

Nothing now, she said.

The child thought about this for a while.

What were you looking for before?

The same thing, the old woman said. Until I found it.

The child did not understand. She went home thinking about it.

A year later she was sitting at the same spot alone, a Saturday in March, the creek running high and cold with the melt. She had come without thinking about it, the way you go to a place your body knows.

She sat and looked at the water.

She was not looking for anything.

And then she understood.

You look until you stop looking. And then you see.

The old woman had not taught any of them anything. She had just shown them how to stay.

Author note: The deepest teaching is not a curriculum. It is a posture — someone at the water's edge who has learned to be still and does not hide it. The children came because something in them recognized something in her. She didn't call them. She didn't explain. She just kept showing up at the same place at the same time. That is sometimes all that is needed.

The Man Who Came Back with Empty Hands

On the freedom that was never somewhere else

He left at nineteen, certain the life worth living was somewhere he hadn't been yet. He came back at twenty-six with none of what he went to find.

He left at nineteen.

He didn't leave angry. He left the way you walk away from something you love and still cannot stay — with one hand still almost reaching back. He told himself he was going to find something. He did not know the name of it yet, but he was sure it was not here.

He worked construction in the city for two years. He was good at it. He made more money than he had ever seen and spent it on things that filled his hands for a week and then didn't.

He moved further. He tried other cities and other kinds of work. He drove long stretches of highway alone, which he had expected to feel like freedom, and which felt like something else — not bad, just not what the word had promised.

He made friends and lost track of them. He had nights that were exactly what he'd imagined, and mornings after those nights that were not. He tried to want what the people around him wanted. Sometimes he almost did.

He came back in January, twenty-six years old, in a truck that needed work, with less money than he'd left with and nothing to show for the years except the fact of having spent them.

He expected things to feel different when he pulled off the main road. They did not feel different. The bush came up on both sides the same way it always had. The sky was the same particular grey it got in January when the cloud sat low and the light went flat. The tracks in the driveway were his mother's, from the morning, already half filled in by the snow.

He sat in the truck for a few minutes before he went in.

His grandmother was at the kitchen table. She did not ask where he had been. She slid a bowl of soup across the table and went back to what she was doing.

He sat down and ate. The kitchen smelled the same as it always had — something about the wood and the stove and the particular cold that came in under the door in January. He hadn't known he remembered that smell until it was in his nose.

Later he walked down the slope to the creek behind the house. It was frozen solid, but he could hear it — moving water under the ice, the same low sound it made every winter. He had been hearing that sound his whole life and had not thought about it once in seven years.

He stood on the bank for a long time.

He had traveled looking for the feeling of being his own — of life belonging to him, of moving through the world on his terms. He had found it in pieces, in moments, and lost it again. He had chased it across a lot of geography without it getting any closer.

Standing at the frozen creek in January, empty-handed, he could feel it. Not arriving. Already here. It had been here the whole time. He had just been somewhere else.

The freedom he had been looking for was not a location.

It was a permission. And he had always had it.

He just hadn't known it was his to take until he had tried to find it somewhere else and failed.

He went back inside. His grandmother was still at the table.

Welcome home, she said.

He sat down.

He didn't know yet what came next. That was all right. He was here now. The creek was still running under the ice. The kitchen still smelled like itself.

That was a beginning.

Author note: Some people have to leave to find out that what they were looking for was not a place. The leaving is not a mistake — it is part of the knowing. You cannot understand that the freedom was always yours until you have spent real time looking for it somewhere else

and come home with empty hands. The empty hands are not a failure. They are what you bring back when you are finally ready to receive what was here the whole time.

The Boy Who Swallowed the Stars

A Quantum Adventure for Big Thinkers and Their Families

At almost twelve, Zander's brain was a blazing supernova of ideas — rockets made of laughter, time machines powered by dreams, questions so big they made the ceiling feel too small.

Once upon a time, in a cozy house on Orbit Lane, lived a boy named Zander Starburst.

At almost twelve, Zander's brain was a blazing supernova of ideas. Rockets made of laughter. Time machines powered by dreams. Questions so big they made the ceiling feel too small.

"What happens to my energy when I die?" he asked one Tuesday.

"Can thoughts travel faster than light?" he wondered on Wednesday.

Zander's ideas burst out with enormous, wonderful energy.

His mom, Captain Gravity, loved him more than the whole Milky Way. She made sure he was developing well, eating healthy food, and that wild ideas didn't accidentally launch anyone into outer space. She kept the world steady and safe.

But sometimes Zander's ideas got so big and fast that Captain Gravity's eyes would widen. She would listen for a little while, and then the gravity between them would get heavy for them both — the kind of heavy that ends in everyone feeling squished.

Then one afternoon a small, sparkly creature appeared on the windowsill.

He had the tail of a squirrel, the eyes of someone who had read everything twice, and a tiny chalkboard under his arm that read: PROFESSOR QUARK — Quantum Squirrel, at your service.

"I have been watching your household," said Professor Quark, flipping his tail importantly. "You have a superposition problem. Both of you are right at the same time. Neither of you can tell."

"What do we do?" said Zander.

"Three things," said Professor Quark. "Very small. Very powerful. Shall I?"

Captain Gravity pulled up a chair. Zander sat on the floor. Professor Quark cleared his throat.

The first thing was the Wonder Bins.

A special set of stackable bins where every idea goes — the wild ones, the scary ones, the too-big-for-now ones. Mom can add her thoughts too. The bins collapse when they aren't being used and stack neatly on top of each other. Each bin has a transparent envelope label so they can slip in a short project description or title. Nothing gets crushed. Everything stays possible and clearly named.

The second thing was Quantum Table Time.

Fifteen minutes every day where Zander gets to shine like a full star, and Mom gets to share her gravity wisdom — with no interruptions. They simply listen and say: What I heard is...

At any point in the day when they aren't seeing eye to eye, either one can stop the discussion and say: Put it on the Quantum Table. Zander is responsible for building his case privately and bringing it to their daily Quantum Table Time. If a decision isn't made in that time, it gets gently bumped to the next day's.

The third thing was the Strategic Collapse Menu.

When it's time to decide, they don't collapse into a boring YES or NO. They pick from:

Tiny Safe Test Version

Mix-Master Version (best of both ideas)

Keep Wondering Longer

Transform-It Twist!

"Nothing collapses until you choose how," said Professor Quark. "That is the quantum way."

The next afternoon, Zander put his Indoor Sky City with Trampoline Clouds idea into the Wonder Bins. Mom added her worries about safety and mess. Then they did their first Quantum Table Time.

For the first time in weeks, no one got squished.

Together they chose a Tiny Safe Test Version: a pillow fort with glow-stick stars and one small trampoline.

It was ridiculous. It was glorious. Zander laughed so hard he almost floated.

Even the biggest questions — the ones about energy and death and light — went into the Wonder Bins now. Sometimes Mom added a thought. Sometimes they sat with them at Quantum Table Time and just named what they didn't know yet.

That turned out to be enough. More than enough.

Their new words spread through the house like starlight:

"Superposition time!" or "Put it on the Quantum Table!"

And instead of becoming a black hole, Zander and Captain Gravity became a double star system — two bright, strong lights orbiting each other, sharing energy instead of stealing it.

Zander still had enormous ideas.

Mom still kept him safe.

But now their love had room to grow without collapsing.

And somewhere in the quantum playground, Professor Quark the Quantum Squirrel gave a satisfied little flip of his sparkly tail.

The End... (or one of many wonderful possible beginnings!)

Author note: Every big idea needs a safe place to land. The Wonder Bins, the Quantum Table, the Strategic Collapse Menu — these aren't just for children. Any two people trying to share a life without crushing each other's light could use a system for holding ideas gently. The pillow fort was the point all along.

PRACTICE CARDS

Foundation Skills

What does the rename test check for?

The rename test is codetry's primary diagnostic. Before accepting a name, you try to rename the thing. If a better name comes easily, the first name was generic. If renaming is difficult — if something would be lost — the name is doing real work.

Reflection prompts:

- In your own words, what question does the rename test ask?
- What does it mean for a name to 'resist' renaming? What quality does that reveal?
- Give an example of a name from your own work or life that would pass the rename test. Why would it resist?

What is the difference between a load-bearing name and a decorative one?

A load-bearing name carries meaning that would be lost if you replaced it with a synonym. A decorative name could be swapped for a generic term without changing what people understand. The distinction matters because only load-bearing names earn their place in a vocabulary.

Reflection prompts:

- How would you explain 'load-bearing' in naming to someone who has never heard the term?

- What test could you apply to decide whether a name in your own practice is load-bearing or decorative?
- Name one term from this handbook that you think is clearly load-bearing, and explain why.

In what sense is a name infrastructure?

Infrastructure is what other things are built on top of. A name becomes infrastructure when other people, decisions, and practices depend on it. When a name is infrastructure, changing it has costs — dependencies break. This is why load-bearing names must be chosen carefully: they are harder to revise than they appear at the moment of naming.

Reflection prompts:

- What makes something 'infrastructure' rather than just a component? What is the defining quality?
- Give an example from your own work or life of a name that has become infrastructure. What would breaking it cost?
- If a name is infrastructure, what does that imply about the moment of naming? What does it ask of the practitioner then?

How does generic vocabulary quietly erase a practice?

When a practitioner stops using their specific vocabulary and defaults to generic equivalents, the precision of the practice leaks away. 'Preserving food' in place of 'Preservation Season' loses the temporal frame. 'Workspace' in place of 'Jar Kitchen' loses the identity. The practice becomes harder to teach, replicate, or defend — not because it changed, but because the language did.

Reflection prompts:

- Choose one term from the Jar Kitchen vocabulary. Replace it with the most natural generic equivalent. What is lost?
- Why would a practitioner drift toward generic vocabulary over time? What pressures push in that direction?
- What is the cost of that drift — for the practitioner, and for anyone trying to learn from them?

Why is vocabulary described as evidence that a practice is real?

A practice that cannot be named — whose methods, phases, roles, and outputs lack specific language — may be real to the practitioner but is invisible to everyone else. Vocabulary is the form in which a practice becomes legible: teachable, auditable, reproducible. Without it, the practice dies with the practitioner.

Reflection prompts:

- What does it mean for a practice to be 'legible'? Legible to whom, and for what purpose?
- Can a practice be real without vocabulary? What is the cost of that invisibility?
- What aspect of your own practice is currently real but not yet legible — not yet named specifically enough to be passed on?

Positioning

How does codetry differ from Domain-Driven Design?

Both codetry and DDD take language seriously as a design tool. DDD works inside software systems, building ubiquitous language for technical teams. Codetry works at the practitioner level — it is about how a person names the things that make their specific practice distinct, not about software architecture. The distinction matters because codetry asks the same question DDD does — whose language runs the system? — but asks it on behalf of the community, not the development team. A self-reliant practitioner who names their water system, their food reserve, and their mutual-aid network precisely is doing codetry whether or not they have ever written a line of code.

Reflection prompts:

- What does DDD mean by 'ubiquitous language'? What is it trying to solve?
- Where does codetry's concern with naming begin — and where does DDD's begin? What is each discipline's starting point?
- Could a practitioner use codetry without building any software? What does your answer reveal about the two disciplines?

How does codetry relate to literate programming?

Literate programming, as Knuth described it, interweaves code and prose so the program reads as a coherent essay — the human logic drives the machine, documented in the same breath. Codetry is interested in a narrower question: whether the names a practitioner

assigns to their concepts are precise enough that the practice survives translation — into writing, into conversation, into someone else's hands. For a self-reliant practitioner, the stakes are direct: if your food storage system, your mutual-aid network, or your water management only makes sense to you, it will not survive you. Codetry is how you make it transferable.

Reflection prompts:

- What was Knuth's core insight with literate programming? What problem was he solving?
- Codetry is described as narrower. What is it narrowing to, exactly?
- What does 'the practice survives translation' mean? Give a concrete example of a practice that might not survive without precise naming.

The Practitioner

What makes someone a 'practitioner' in the codetry sense?

A practitioner is not simply someone who does a thing — it is someone who has developed a vocabulary for how they do it. The practitioner can describe the trade, explain the distinctions, and pass the practice on. The vocabulary is the evidence that the practice is real, not accidental.

Reflection prompts:

- What separates a practitioner from someone who simply does the same work repeatedly?
- Why is vocabulary described as evidence that the practice is real? What would its absence suggest?
- By this definition, are you a practitioner in something right now? What vocabulary do you have — or need to build?

What is the distinction between the trade and the tool?

The trade is the durable practice — the knowledge, the relationships, the judgment a practitioner develops. The tool is the current instrument: the software, the device, the platform. Tools change; the trade persists. Naming the trade correctly means it doesn't disappear when the tool does.

Reflection prompts:

- In your own words: what is the trade? What is the tool? Give an example of each from any field.
- What happens to a practice when the practitioner can only name the tool, not the trade?
- Name one thing you do where you have named the tool but not yet named the trade. What would a trade-level name look like?

What distinguishes a practice from a project?

A project has a finish line. A practice does not — it is an ongoing relationship with a domain, a discipline, or a craft. The codetory distinction matters because naming something a practice changes what you build around it: infrastructure, vocabulary, and rhythm rather than milestones and completion.

Reflection prompts:

- What does a project have that a practice does not? What does a practice have that a project does not?
- How does naming something a 'practice' change what you build around it?
- Is there something in your life that you have been treating as a project but is actually a practice? What would the reframe change?

What does it mean for a practitioner to function as an incubator?

The practitioner who has developed a vocabulary, a method, and a track record can offer something beyond their own output: they can help others develop their practices. The incubation role is named explicitly in the codetory framework because it is a distinct responsibility — not a side effect of doing good work, but a commitment the practitioner makes.

Reflection prompts:

- What does a practitioner need to have developed before they can function as an incubator?
- Why is incubation named as a distinct commitment rather than a natural consequence of expertise?
- Is there a role for you as an incubator — now or in the near future? What would that look like specifically?

What makes a skill a 'compounding asset' rather than just a skill?

A compounding asset is one that grows in value through use — each application makes the next application more effective, faster, or richer. Codetry treats food skills, naming discipline, and community relationships as compounding assets: the longer and more consistently they are practiced, the greater their yield relative to the effort applied.

Reflection prompts:

- What is the difference between a skill and a compounding asset? What does 'compounding' add?
- Why is naming discipline described as a compounding asset? How does each name built make the next one easier or better?
- What is your most valuable compounding asset right now — the practice that has grown most in yield per unit of effort over time?

Jar Kitchen

What names make up the Jar Kitchen vocabulary set, and what work does each do?

The Jar Kitchen vocabulary includes: Jarista (the person), Jar Kitchen (the workspace), Seasonal Shelf (the preserved inventory), Harvest Hold (the bulk reserve), Bulk Round (the sourcing cycle), and Preservation Season (the active production period). Each name holds a specific role — they are not interchangeable with generic equivalents.

Reflection prompts:

- Without looking, list as many terms from the Jar Kitchen vocabulary as you can recall.
- Pick two terms from the set. For each, explain what generic phrase it replaces and what is lost by using the generic instead.
- What principle ties the whole vocabulary together? What shared logic connects each name?

What does the name 'Jarista' do that 'home preserver' or 'canner' does not?

Jarista names a practitioner with a specific relationship to preservation as a practice — not a hobbyist, not a nostalgist. The name implies discipline, a vocabulary, and a method. It also implies that the practice is transferable: a Jarista is something another person could become.

Reflection prompts:

- What connotations does 'canner' carry? What does it suggest about who does the work and why?
- What does 'Jarista' claim that 'home preserver' does not? What is being asserted about the practice?
- Can you think of a role in another field where the common name undersells the practice? What would a more load-bearing name look like?

What is the Seasonal Shelf, and what function does it serve in the Jar Kitchen system?

The Seasonal Shelf is the preserved inventory maintained by the Jarista — the result of the Preservation Season and the Bulk Round. It is not a pantry in the casual sense. It is a managed reserve that connects the season of abundance (when food is available and cheap) to the season of scarcity (when it is not).

Reflection prompts:

- What problem does the Seasonal Shelf solve? What would break in the Jar Kitchen system without it?
- What makes it a 'shelf' rather than just 'stored food'? What does the name claim about how it is managed?
- Where in your own practice is there a 'shelf' — a managed reserve that connects abundance to scarcity — even if it hasn't been named that way?

What is the Bulk Round and what discipline does it require?

The Bulk Round is the sourcing cycle during which the Jarista acquires ingredients in volume — at the right moment in the growing season, from the right suppliers, at scale. It is a defined event, not a continuous activity. Treating it as an event rather than a habit is what makes it manageable.

Reflection prompts:

- Why is calling the sourcing cycle a 'Round' important? What does the name imply about timing?
- What is the difference between treating sourcing as a continuous habit versus a defined event? What does the event frame change?

- Is there a cyclical activity in your practice that would benefit from being named as a Round rather than a habit? What would defining it as an event allow?

What is the Harvest Hold and how does it differ from the Seasonal Shelf?

The Harvest Hold is the bulk reserve acquired through the Bulk Round — raw materials in volume, before processing. The Seasonal Shelf is the processed, preserved output ready for use. The two names mark different stages in the Jar Kitchen system: acquisition versus completion.

Reflection prompts:

- At what stage in the Jar Kitchen system does the Harvest Hold exist? What comes before it and what comes after?
- Why does the distinction between Harvest Hold and Seasonal Shelf matter? What would be lost by using one name for both?
- In your own practice, are there 'holds' — raw material you've acquired but not yet processed or made ready? What are they?

What is Preservation Season, and why does naming it as a season matter?

Preservation Season is the defined period during which the Jarista does the active work of processing, canning, fermenting, and stocking the Seasonal Shelf. Calling it a season is deliberate: seasons are bounded, recurring, and require preparation in advance. The name encodes the discipline — it is not a whenever activity.

Reflection prompts:

- What does the word 'season' imply about an activity — in contrast to words like 'process', 'project', or 'task'?
- What preparation does Preservation Season require that a more casual name would not encode?
- Is there a recurring bounded period in your practice that deserves to be named as a Season? What would naming it change about how you approach it?

The Constellation

What is the constellation, and what does it hold?

The constellation is the manifest of a practitioner's specific vocabulary: the terms that name the zones, the roles, the primitives, and the tools in their practice. It is not a mission statement or a philosophy. It is the working vocabulary that makes the practice legible — to the practitioner, to collaborators, and to the future.

Reflection prompts:

- How would you describe the constellation to someone who has not read the handbook?
- What is the difference between a mission statement and a constellation? Why does the distinction matter?
- If you were to draft three entries in your own constellation right now — three names specific to your practice — what would they be?

What are the constellation zones, and what does each represent?

The zones organize scale and relationship: Zone 0 is the household (the smallest unit of practice); Eave is the immediate network; Zone 2 is the community; Zone 3 is the broader ecosystem. Work done in Zone 0 generates the capacity that makes Zone 3 possible. The zones are not a hierarchy — they are a map of how the practice propagates.

Reflection prompts:

- Describe Zone 0 in your own words. What is it not?
- The zones are described as a map, not a hierarchy. What is the difference? What would change if they were treated as a hierarchy?
- Where does most of your current practice live — Zone 0, 1, 2, or 3? What would a move outward require?

What is the fork mechanic, and when does it apply?

A fork is a deliberate split in the practice — a moment where two versions are allowed to coexist while it is not yet clear which one is right. The fork is not indecision. It is a commitment to running both branches until the question resolves itself through use, not through argument.

Reflection prompts:

- What is the difference between forking and being undecided?
- What conditions make a fork appropriate? When would it be a mistake to fork?
- Is there something in your practice right now that deserves a fork rather than a forced decision? Describe it.

Key Concepts

What is the Standby primitive, and what posture does it require?

Standby is the practice of building capacity before it is needed — infrastructure, vocabulary, relationships, skills — so that when the activated state arrives, the practitioner is already positioned to act. Standby is not waiting. It is a specific form of preparation that is only possible during periods of relative ease.

Reflection prompts:

- How is Standby different from waiting? What does Standby require that waiting does not?
- What is the 'activated state' that Standby is preparing for? Give an example from the handbook or from your own context.
- What are you currently in Standby for? What capacity are you building that isn't needed yet?

What does the seven-generation horizon framing ask of a practitioner?

The seven-generation framing — drawn from Haudenosaunee governance — asks that decisions account for consequences seven generations forward. Applied to codetry, it means the names a practitioner chooses, the infrastructure they build, and the vocabulary they develop should be legible and useful beyond their own working life.

Reflection prompts:

- Where does the seven-generation framing originate, and what was its original purpose?
- How does codetry apply this framing to naming? What does it demand of a vocabulary?
- Is there a name or a structure in your practice that you believe would still be useful seven generations from now? What makes it durable?

What does it mean to treat trust as a protocol rather than a feeling?

Trust-as-protocol means designing collaboration around explicit, legible agreements — roles, vocabulary, decision rules — rather than relying on personal rapport alone. Protocol-based trust can be transferred to new collaborators, audited, and repaired when broken. Rapport-based trust cannot.

Reflection prompts:

- What is the difference between trust as a feeling and trust as a protocol? Give an example of each.
- Why is protocol-based trust more transferable? What can it survive that rapport-based trust cannot?
- Where in your current collaborations does trust rest on rapport that hasn't been made explicit? What would a protocol version look like?

What is the 'forward motion is easier to redirect than stillness' principle?

This principle holds that beginning — even imperfectly, even with incomplete information — creates the conditions for correction. A practice in motion can be steered. A practice that hasn't started cannot. The Jar Kitchen didn't wait for perfect infrastructure; the co-op didn't wait for regulatory clarity. The logic is that starting generates the feedback that planning cannot.

Reflection prompts:

- What does 'forward motion is easier to redirect than stillness' mean in practice? What specific situation does it apply to?
- What is the risk of applying this principle carelessly? When would you not want to start moving?
- Is there something in your practice where stillness is masquerading as planning? What would starting — even imperfectly — reveal?

The Three Layers

You can rearrange the furniture. You cannot move the load-bearing walls. Which layer of a Codetry platform is which?

Every platform Headwaters builds has three layers. The Ledger of Words is the foundation — vocabulary, zone structure, logic. Load-bearing. The Administrator Panel is everything built on top of it: listings, members, prices, schedules. Furniture. The Codetry Filter is the door frame that makes sure nothing added through the admin panel damages the structure underneath. Communities have full run of the house. Only the walls require the developer back.

Reflection prompts:

- What makes something load-bearing in a building — and what is the equivalent in a platform? What happens when someone tries to move the wrong thing?
- From the administrator's seat on day one, how would you explain which things are furniture and which are walls? What language would you use?
- The filter is the door frame. What does that mean — what does a door frame do that neither the wall nor the furniture does?

The Ledger of Words is to a Codetry platform what bylaws are to a co-op. Who can read them, who wrote them, and who gets called when they need to change?

Bylaws define how the co-op thinks and behaves. You don't amend them through the meeting-booking form. The Ledger of Words is the same thing: the vocabulary, zone names, and structural rules that define how the platform operates. A board member can run a meeting inside those rules all day. When the rules themselves need to change — when the co-op wants to rename a zone or restructure an envelope — that is when the developer comes back. The ledger is the constitution. The admin panel is the day-to-day business of governance.

Reflection prompts:

- A board member asks: 'Can I just change that term in the system myself?' Walk through the bylaw analogy out loud. What does it help them understand?
- Name three things a community might want to change that would require amending the constitution — and three that are just the day-to-day business of governance.

- What is lost if the bylaws can be edited by anyone at any time? What does that analogy reveal about the Ledger of Words?

Content flows freely. Grammar stays fixed. What does that boundary feel like from inside the administrator's seat?

Grammar is the Ledger of Words — the vocabulary and zone structure the platform is built on. Content is everything that moves through that grammar: listings, members, meetings, prices, schedules, announcements. The administrator has full, unsupervised control over all of it. They do not control the grammar. This is what makes the handoff real: the community isn't waiting on the developer for operations, only for architecture. Most administrators will never need to touch the grammar. That is the point.

Reflection prompts:

- What is 'grammar' in a platform — not linguistically, but operationally? Give two examples of grammar and two examples of content in a food co-op platform.
- What does it feel like to have full control over content? What would it feel like if you also had to call someone every time you updated a price?
- 'Grammar stays fixed' sounds like a constraint. How would you reframe it as a protection — something the administrator benefits from?

A Codetory Filter is a gate, not a manual. What does it catch that even the best onboarding session cannot?

A manual relies on memory. A gate acts at the moment of passage. When drift enters a platform — a listing in the wrong zone, a budget line with no bucket, a term that doesn't match the vocabulary — it usually enters through a well-meaning administrator who didn't remember the rule. The Codetory Filter doesn't rely on memory. It speaks the community's own vocabulary and catches the inconsistency at the moment it's being created, not six months later when the reports stop making sense.

Reflection prompts:

- What is 'drift' — not as a concept, but as something you can watch happen in real time in an organisation you know? Describe a specific example.
- What is the difference between a gate and a manual? One relies on the person. What does the other rely on — and why does that matter at handoff?
- The filter speaks the community's own vocabulary. What makes that different from a generic error message? What does it preserve?

Build Inside Out

Local Line was built for someone else. What is the difference between wearing clothes made for you and wearing what was on sale?

Building outside in means taking a platform built for a different body — a different language, a different set of rhythms, a different idea of what an 'organisation' looks like — and training the community to fit into it. The tool was on sale. The community reshapes itself around it. Building inside out starts with the community's actual body: their vocabulary, their roles, their cycles. The platform is cut to fit. It wears their name from the first screen. The community doesn't have to translate itself to use it.

Reflection prompts:

- Think of a platform recommended by a consultant: Local Line, QuickBooks, Square, Slack. Whose body was it cut for? What does the community have to do to fit into it?
- What does 'built for someone else' mean at the level of language — not just interface? What assumptions are baked into the vocabulary of an outside-in tool?
- 'Build it inside out and wear it proudly.' What does wearing it proudly mean — not as a slogan, but as something you would actually say to a band council?

When is a handoff a gift — something the community owns outright — and when is it a loan with no clear end date?

A gift changes hands completely. A loan keeps the original owner in the relationship. Most platform 'handoffs' are loans: the vendor stays in the relationship through licensing, through the admin password, through the fact that the community can't update the thing without calling someone. The Headwaters handoff is designed to be a gift from day one — not a milestone at the end of the engagement, but the design constraint that shapes what gets built. Build it so it can leave your hands entirely.

Reflection prompts:

- What are the signs that a handoff is a loan dressed as a gift? What keeps the original owner in the relationship?
- What three things must be true of a platform before the gift can honestly be given? What makes each one non-negotiable?
- If the handoff is the design constraint from day one, what does it change about how you scope and price the initial engagement?

A retainer is rent. A flat fee is a deed. What does the community own when the invoice is paid and the developer is gone?

Rent keeps the landlord in the relationship. As long as the community is paying a retainer, the developer is still needed — and the community knows it. A deed transfers the thing entirely: the vocabulary, the platform, the logic. The community owns it and owes nothing further. The flat fee is how the deed is structured — scope and price agreed before the first line is written, total cost known before commitment. No scope creep dressed as service. No dependency dressed as support.

Reflection prompts:

- What does rent say about a relationship that a deed does not? What power does the landlord hold that a deed removes?
- A band council or co-op board used to consultant dependency hears 'flat fee, no retainer required.' What does that signal to them — and why might it be hard to believe at first?
- The flat fee requires honesty about scope before the work starts. What must you know — about the community, the platform, and the work — before you can name a number that is also a deed?

What can the landlord do to the tenant's tools that the tenant cannot prevent — and what changes when the community owns the building?

Every SaaS platform is a landlord-tenant arrangement. The vendor can raise prices, change terms, shut down, be acquired, deprecate features, or simply decide the northern food co-op market isn't worth serving. The tenant has no recourse. When the community owns the platform outright — the data, the vocabulary, the codebase — the landlord is gone. In northern and Indigenous contexts, tool sovereignty is also cultural: the tools reflect the community's logic, not a product manager's assumptions about what 'normal' organisations look like.

Reflection prompts:

- Name three things a SaaS vendor could do — without asking — that would break a community food system built on their platform.
- What does 'owning the building' mean in practice? Not metaphorically — what does the board actually hold when the platform is theirs?
- Tool sovereignty is one expression of economic sovereignty. What is the connection? What does owning your tools protect that renting them does not?

Explain It

What gets salted in the Saltbox before it leaves — and what happens to something that leaves before it's ready?

The Saltbox is Zone 0 — the practitioner's own household, the most private space in the constellation. Salt preserves. Work done in the Saltbox is work on yourself: vocabulary-building, personal finances, deep practice, the Jar Kitchen. It has to cure before it can be offered outward. The Workbench, the Commons, and the Arc are built on what was prepared in Zone 0. Something that leaves the Saltbox before it's ready — vocabulary that isn't precise yet, a practice that hasn't been tested — won't survive the journey.

Reflection prompts:

- What does 'salting' preserve? What quality does it protect that would otherwise be lost in transit or over time?
- What does something that left before it was ready look like — in your practice, specifically? Name an example. What got lost?
- What are you currently salting in your own Saltbox? What is it not ready to do yet — and what will tell you when it is?

The tool name doesn't survive. The trade name does. How do you explain that gap — in under two minutes, without the book?

The entry point for most people in your circle is the contrast: we normally name the tool ('we use QuickBooks for accounting'), Codetry names the trade ('we track every dollar through its natural destination'). When the tool changes, the tool name disappears. The trade name stays — it describes the practice, not the instrument. Most people have felt this gap without naming it: the moment a software migration wiped out everything that had been organised around the old tool's vocabulary. That is the opening.

Reflection prompts:

- Write it. Two minutes, no book terms — explain Codetry to your husband, a board member, or a band council contact as if the handbook doesn't exist.
 - What is the one sentence — not paragraph — that everything else hangs from? The sentence that, if they get it, the rest follows?
 - What is the confused question you expect them to ask? ('Is this like...?') Write your answer — not the corrected version, the one that meets them where they are.
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PIONEER PATH

The handbook walked, not read. 20 stations across 5 phases.

Phase 1 · Read Your Community

Before building anything, see what's already there.

Station 1 · The Saltbox

Where every beam carries weight

Do: Walk through your home and pick the one room that does the most jobs. Write down — by hand, on paper — the three jobs it carries. Tape the paper to the doorframe.

Station 2 · Both-States

One word, two tempos

Do: Pick one thing in your community that runs in two tempos — mostly quiet but sometimes everything. Write its name. Then write the second name you almost gave it.

Station 3 · The Ledger Walk

Follow the money before you move it

Do: Go through one week of purchases in your community — groceries, fuel, building supplies, anything bought from outside. Write down where each dollar went. At the bottom, write one number: how much left your community that week. Keep the paper.

Station 4 · The Names

The connective tissue you already have

Do: Write down three names — real people in your community — who you would trust to hold a hard conversation honestly. Not a role, not a title. Three actual names. Fold the paper and keep it somewhere you'll find it. These are your connective tissue.

Station 5 · The Gap

What leaves your community every week

Do: Name one thing your community buys every week from somewhere outside — food, fuel, a service — that someone in your community could provide. Write the name of the thing. Next to it, write the name of one person in your community who already knows how to make or do it.

Phase 2 · Name Your Model

Identify the right shape before you commit to a structure.

Station 6 · The Archetype

Which shape fits before you build it

Do: Read the four shapes: The Store, The Agency, The Platform, The Cooperative. Write down which one your community is already closest to — even if it's informal and unnamed. Then write one sentence about why that shape fits. Don't pick the most ambitious one. Pick the truest one.

Station 7 · The First Trade

What moves informally already

Do: Name one exchange that already happens in your community without money changing hands — a favour, a barter, a standing agreement. Write: who gives, who receives, what moves, and what makes it work. Then write: what would change if that exchange had a name and a simple agreement behind it?

Station 8 · The Floor

The minimum before you think about growing

Do: Write down the minimum monthly number that keeps your community's most critical function running — not thriving, just running. One number. Then write the three things that number has to cover. This is your floor. Post it somewhere visible.

Station 9 · The Waterfall

The order that makes a dollar last

Do: On a piece of paper, draw a simple flow: if your community's first trade brought in \$1,000, where would it go — in what order? Draw the sequence top to bottom. Each box gets one label in your community's own words. The order is the decision.

Phase 3 · Make Your First Agreement

Practice the translation, then make one real commitment.

Station 10 · Both-Sides

One word, two rooms

Do: Find one form, letter, or invoice on your kitchen table that uses words your family doesn't. On a sticky note, write the family's word for the same thing next to the form's word. Leave both visible.

Station 11 · The Standby

Always-on, until it isn't

Do: Walk your property and write down the three things that fail first when the power goes out. Don't fix them yet — just name them, in your own words, in pencil, where you can see them tomorrow.

Station 12 · The Gate

A calm passage between two dialects

Do: Take one piece of mail from a regulator, banker, or government office. Underline every word in it your family wouldn't say at the table. Write your family's word in the margin next to each one. Keep both.

Station 13 · The Agreement

The same thing, said two ways

Do: Write one paragraph describing the first trade you named in Station 7. Write it twice: once in your community's own words, the way you'd explain it at a kitchen table. Once in the way you'd write it on a form or say it to a banker. Keep both. The gap between them is the work.

Phase 4 · Build the Floor

Establish the stability mechanisms before you grow.

Station 14 · The Buffer

The firewall before the debt plan

Do: How many months could your community's most critical function keep running if your main income stopped tomorrow? Write the honest number — not the optimistic one. If you don't know, write 'unknown.' That is also the answer. Now write one thing that would make that number one month longer.

Station 15 · The Tithe

First claim, not last

Do: Name what your community already gives back — to the land, to elders, to those who have less, to the next generation. Write the practice down, even if it's informal and has no dollar amount attached. This is your tithe. It goes first, before the rest of the waterfall.

Station 16 · The Reserve

Where extra goes when there's extra

Do: Write one rule for where extra goes when there's extra. Not a wish — a rule: 'When we have more than X, Y goes to Z.' If you don't have a rule yet, write the one that feels right. Write it in your community's language. Post it next to the waterfall you drew in Station 9.

Phase 5 · Hold the Line

Build the habits that make the model last past the first person.

Station 17 · The Renegotiation

Name the trigger before you need it

Do: Write down the three things that would have to change before you'd go back to the table and ask for different terms. Not feelings — conditions. 'When the store turns a profit for three months in a row.' 'When the grant runs out.' 'When the hours double.' Name the triggers before you need them.

Station 18 · The Replication

Who walks this after you

Do: Name one person in your community who could walk this path after you — who could run this model if you stepped back. Write their name. Write the one thing they would need to learn that they don't already know. That gap is your next teaching.

Station 19 · The Handoff

Three load-bearing sentences for the next person

Do: Write the three things the next person needs to know to pick this up if you're not there. Not the full plan — three load-bearing sentences: the floor number, the waterfall order, and the name of the gate person. One page, in plain language, somewhere they can find it.

Station 20 · The Return

What Tuesday morning looks like when it works

Do: Write one paragraph: what does your community look like in five years if this works? Not a grant objective, not an economic development target. What does it actually feel like on a Tuesday morning? Write it in your own words, in the language your community uses at the table.

CONSTELLATION SNAPSHOT

Version 0.5.7 · 2026-05-05

Grammar

- **Practice:** codetry — naming IS architecture (distinct from code-poetry)
- **Zone system:** permaculture 0–5
- **Thunder:** there is no shortage of problems, but when we look for solutions it all becomes a little easier

Principles

one bounded thing you can point at

A primitive names one bounded system with one specific job. The name holds across every zone, every season, every personnel rotation. It works from day one — empty and full, built and forming. The name is not a category label; it is the system itself.

Worked example: Saltbox — named for the cold-climate vernacular house whose asymmetric roof and thick north wall were the only way a house survived a boreal winter. The form is the function. Every beam carries weight. A codetory app is named the same way: the name is the design spec, and changing it changes the structure underneath.

the name has to hold both states

When a system has both a slow side (always-on practice) and a fast side (active event), the name has to do both jobs in one word, or the system will fork into two systems with two cultures.

Worked example: The Standby — the umbrella name had to hold both the always-on shelf (preparation, standby stock, the watch as a posture) and the active event (a call, an active rung, a debrief). Splitting into two names — say, *the Pantry* for the slow side and *the Call* for the fast side — would have produced two systems with two cultures. One word, two states.

the name has to hold both sides

When a system has language that has to live in two contexts that hold different vocabularies as legitimate, the umbrella name has to fit both contexts in one word, or the system will pick a dialect and lose the other room.

Worked example: The Gate — the umbrella name had to hold both the *bright side* (the constellation's own dialect: neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock) and *the systems* (the outside world's dialect: resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves). Splitting into two names — say, *Translator* for the bright-to-systems direction and *Importer* for the systems-to-bright direction — would have produced two pipes and no posture, with no record that both names exist for the same thing. One word, two contexts.

Constellation-Wide Primitives

The Standby

The umbrella system + always-on state for *temporary centralized disruptions* — drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power, water, freight, payment systems, pandemic, evacuation, AGM-postponed, key-person-down. One name that holds both the slow side (always-on preparation) and the fast side (active event).

Vocabulary:

- **the Standby** — the umbrella system + always-on state
- **a call** — a specific active event (a fire call, a flood call, a freight call)
- **the watch** — the active-monitoring posture between advisory and active — the sub-noun for the act of watching a developing situation
- **standby stock** — the physical/operational reserves the always-on side maintains
- **the debrief** — the after-action synthesis once a call has stood down
- **centralized disruption** — the class of event the Standby is for — a temporary loss or strain of a centralized system the community depends on

Severity ladder:

- **advisory** — something is forming on the horizon; no posture change required, but the watch is informed
- **standby** — preparation is sleeved in; standby stock is verified; envelopes ready to flex
- **active** — a call is open; the system is responding; envelopes and rosters have flipped
- **standdown** — the call is closed; debrief opens; standby stock is replenished

Rejected alternatives:

- **The Common Pantry (as the umbrella name)** — Holds the slow side beautifully (a pantry is by definition always-on) but cannot hold an active fire call, an evacuation, or a payment-systems outage without straining the metaphor. A pantry is what you keep; the Standby is also what you do. The Pantry sits *inside* the Standby as the food/supply sub-shelf.
- **The Watch (as the umbrella name)** — Holds the active-monitoring posture (the watch is active by definition) but cannot hold the slow shelf of standby stock without bending

into something that sounds like a permanent vigil. The Watch sits *inside* the Standby as the active-monitoring sub-noun.

The Gate

A calm passage between the bright side and the systems. The umbrella system + posture for *passing language across institutional boundaries* — codetry vocabulary going out to a regulator, banker, funder, lawyer, or other legacy-world counterparty; their vocabulary coming back in. Holds both sides without flattening either: the founder/practitioner keeps the original noun, the counterparty receives the dialect they can act on, and the gate logs the substitution so the translation stays auditable.

Vocabulary:

- **the Gate** — the umbrella system + always-on posture
- **the bright side** — the codetry-vocabulary side; the constellation's own dialect
- **the systems** — the outside world's side; the systems dialect (regulators, bankers, funders, lawyers, generic SaaS English)
- **a mapping** — a registered correspondence between a bright-side term and its systems-side equivalent (e.g. neighbour → resident, send → remit, fee → service charge, money → funds)
- **a substitution** — a single instance of a mapping being applied to a piece of crossing language
- **a category** — the domain a mapping belongs to (Pragmatism, Politics, Regulations, Privacy, Banking, ...); each category is a sub-shelf inside the Gate
- **a translation** — a piece of language that has passed through the Gate in either direction; the auditable record of what crossed and what changed
- **a calm membrane** — the metaphor doing the load — selectively permeable, alive, not a wall and not a wide-open door; the gate does work without picking a side

Severity ladder:

- **draft** — language has been written but not run past the Gate yet; no posture change required
- **under-review** — the Gate is reading the language; mappings are being proposed; the founder is in the loop

- **cleared** — the language has crossed; substitutions are logged; the translation is part of the record
- **refused** — the Gate declined to translate — usually because the bright-side noun has no honest systems-side equivalent and forcing one would lose the meaning the founder is trying to keep

Rejected alternatives:

- **Translator** — Holds the directional work but flattens the gate's posture into pure transaction — a translator processes; a gate decides whether to. Strips the calm-passage feel out of the metaphor.
- **Filter** — Implies the Gate's job is to remove or block, which mis-frames the work — the Gate doesn't subtract, it relabels in flight while keeping both names on file. A filter chooses what gets through; the Gate chooses what the through-language is called on each side.
- **Censor** — Carries punitive weight the metaphor refuses; the Gate is collaborative with the founder, not adversarial. A censor decides for you; the Gate proposes and lets the founder confirm.
- **Glossary** — Holds the dictionary side (Mappings) beautifully but cannot hold the active posture of substituting in real documents, the ledger of past substitutions, or the refused-translation rung. A glossary is what you keep on a shelf; the Gate is the shelf plus the room plus the work happening in it.

Zones

Zone -1 · Brainstorm Library

Domain: Seed bank — ideas before they're sorted into a zone

Status: pending

Opening: Think of it as a volunteer seed. One that fell from last year's harvest and found a little water and sunshine on its own. Not a parking lot — ideas parked don't grow. Not a curated library — you don't browse volunteer seeds; you notice them. If cultivated, who knows what they could become?

Reflections:

- What is sitting in your seed bed right now that you have not yet named?

- When did an idea that had no zone find its place — and what gave it the opening?
- Which seed in this bed is not for you — it is for someone two generations forward who will know exactly what to do with it?

Zone 0 · Saltbox

Domain: Decentralized homes — homeschool day companion, local-first per family

Status: live

Opening: Sitting on the deck with the morning sun and a cup of black coffee. Getting cold, but that's nothing new. Watching the children play outside — and then all of a sudden there's a moment. There's always a beautiful moment to capture. A moment where we wonder: will this ever cross my mind again? Will they remember? Saltbox is the reminder of the things that are true and unshakeable. The sunny moments that make the boreal winters worth bearing. The spring days when the outdoors is the parent and we can just enjoy documenting the ride.

The no-scoring rule comes from this: a measure of a fish's worth cannot be how well it can climb a tree. We each have our individual strengths, and when channeled, those strengths allow a waterfall of value that was never dammed. With a proper saltbox, the children grow brave in their own time — and the dams that don't need breaking down the line are the fruit of that patience.

Zone 0 holds both the family on the land and the elder in the care home. They are just homes in different stages, and they deserve the same value placed on their life stage.

Standby: Reads The Standby (constellation-wide primitive) as the household standby checklist — a per-family list mirroring the co-op's standby stock list, item for item, so the household side of a centralized disruption is named with the same vocabulary the co-op uses. Same rungs (advisory / standby / active / standdown), same nouns (a call, the watch, the debrief).

Reflections:

- What are the things that are true and unshakeable in your household right now?
- Where are you measuring a fish by how well it climbs a tree?
- What would it look like to let someone grow brave in their own time instead of pushing the pace?
- What were you handed by the generations before you in this household — and what are you handing forward to the ones who will sit in this kitchen after you?

- What does this household look like three generations from now — and is anything you are building today pointed at that?

Worked examples:

- **Lock-In Wins** — 15 quiet minutes is enough to count. No MM:SS, no sound, no streak, no score. Lock-in is a state of attention, not a measured performance.
- **Gentle Words** — 6-line bank, $\leq 1 \times / \text{day}$ per surface; Deakon's voice $\leq 1 \times / \text{week}$. Scarcity is the design — a line loses its weight when it's shouted daily.
- **Brave Moments** — Amber Shield, one-tap capture from Home; surfaced per-child in seasonal Family Recap. Courage is named, kept, and surfaced — never scored.
- **Quote of the Day** — Deterministic per calendar date; rotates next morning. The quote rests with the day.
- **Live Follow-Along** — Opt-in only, passphrase as header (X-Share-Pass), lock-in count excluded from share payload. Privacy is the default posture, not a setting.
- **Per-child Goals + tips** — Goal lives with the child, the tip meets them where they are. No streaks, no leaderboards. (Goals row in flight: #175 milestone badges, #176 starter-goal suggestions, #177 stalled-goal nudge — Z0 agent will send a delta before this row locks.)

Zone 1 · Kitchen Table

Domain: Non-custodial XRPL stablecoin envelope-budgeting installable web app (PWA) — household balance is the source of the watershed

Status: live

Tagline: Channel every drop. Nothing from nowhere.

Opening: The word "budget" evokes restriction, tightening. "Watershed" invokes flow, abundance. That difference is not cosmetic — it changes what the person holding the tool believes is possible before they touch a single number.

The Siphon is the bill that leaves before you see the money. But the siphon isn't permanent. You choose the size of it. You can reduce those bills, downgrade the lifestyle, make pivots. You ultimately control it — which is the opposite of what the word "expense" implies.

Standby: Reads The Standby as a standby budget envelope that sleeves up automatically during an active call — drought routes a water-cost envelope, fire routes a supply-cost envelope, freight routes a stockpile-cost envelope. Channel/Bridge verbs already model the

flex; Standby gives the trigger language.

Reflections:

- What in your financial life feels like restriction — and what would it feel like as flow instead?
- Where is your siphon larger than you chose it to be?
- What would it mean to channel every drop on purpose this week?
- Is the way your household earns and spends today something you would want your great-grandchildren to inherit as normal — or is it a pattern worth interrupting now?
- What financial pattern has been passed down through your family for two or three generations — and does it deserve to continue?

Worked examples:

- **Eave** — the eave is the first shelter outward from the household — the immediate circle of trust that catches what the household cannot hold alone. Rename to 'Network' and you lose the constraint that this zone is built on invitation, not open access; every downstream zone flows from that boundary being held.
- **Buckets** — envelope categories. You can only pour from one bucket into another; never summon water from nothing. Every transfer is a literal redistribution. Rename to 'Categories' and the UI starts quietly suggesting balances can grow by clicking. Per Test 005, 'cistern' was retired in favour of Bucket — the Earn surface had been calling savings envelopes 'cisterns' in violation of the locked Eave word map.
- **XRP Spring** — savings, defined as free XRP above the 10-XRP network reserve. A spring upwells from below the reserve floor; the user sees what's pooled above the rock. The new six-stage bamboo growth scene (just shipped, #793) extends the metaphor from data model into artwork — same constraint, now visible.
- **Drip Harvester** — two senses, both held by Test 008's resolution. As a noun: an earner wallet that holds RLUSD before it is parked in a Lake — the station between Reservoir and Private Lake on the Earn flow ribbon. As a verb: the move that drips Lake earnings into a Bucket once a sweep threshold is reached. The verb 'harvest' carries patience and seasonality; 'Auto-Compound' would have erased both.
- **Community Well** — monthly pooled tips that round-distribute to community proposals. A well everyone draws from and contributes to; the monthly snapshot/round cycle is the well refilling.

- **Giving Well** — user-to-user tip pool for charitable giving. Same well metaphor at the household scale.
- **Surplus Pool** — where Payday overflow goes once envelopes are full. Pool, not 'extra savings account' — water seeking level. (In flight: #794)
- **Payday Planner** — the moment the spring refills. Allocation flow follows water's priority order: must-pay buckets first, then comfort buckets, then Surplus Pool, then giving.
- **Rainfall** — income arriving this payday — paycheck plus side gig combined, before anything is taken out. The act of arriving, not the leftover; the leftover is the Reservoir.
- **Siphon** — auto-bills drawn out of the rainfall before it reaches the Reservoir. The locked verb for money leaving rainfall before it reaches the wallet — replaces 'bank' wherever it had crept in (Test 001 Sighting 1).
- **Reservoir** — the stablecoin wallet — what's left after the Siphon. The locked noun for the wallet itself; the field name in code is `reservoirLabel`, no longer `masterBucketLabel`. The wallet/XRP-swap chip honours this lock end-to-end after Tests 009 and 010.
- **Channel (verb)** — distributing the Reservoir into named Buckets — the act of 'every drop into a bucket'. Reserved for Reservoir → Bucket only; the Bridge sheet uses 'Bridge' for above-cap transfers, the Drainage lesson uses 'Drainage' for debt payoff, and the Drip Harvester uses 'drip' for Lake → Bucket.
- **Cloud Cover** — compound interest — the weather that keeps producing rain. Separated from the vehicle (Glacier) where it happens; the lesson formerly called 'Compound Rainfall' was re-named to introduce both nouns explicitly.
- **Rain Barrel** — emergency fund — the short-term reserve for surprises. The first layer of the Aquifer ladder; the daily drops about not draining the emergency fund were re-pointed from 'Reservoir' to 'Rain Barrel' to honour Test 002's lock.
- **Aquifer** — long-term savings — the deep reserve that fills slowly. The 3-6 month layer of the savings ladder; replaces 'Reservoir' wherever the lessons were using it for long-term savings.
- **Glacier** — tax-advantaged accounts (RRSP, TFSA) — savings the tax authority leaves alone. The vehicle Cloud Cover compounds inside; named explicitly so compounding (the weather) is no longer conflated with where it happens (the vehicle).
- **Watershed** — diversified income streams — one fragile stream becomes many resilient ones. Distinct from the former xBuckets product name 'Watershed' (still active at the URL/storage layer); here the noun refers to multiple income streams the household draws from. 'Three is a Watershed' replaces 'Three is a reservoir' across the side-income card and daily drops.

- **Bridge (verb)** — above-tap-cap transfers — the Abundance Bridge sheet. The locked verb for transfers that exceed the daily cap; the Bridge sheet was rewritten to use 'Bridge this rainfall' / 'Bridge this →' / 'Bridged across' instead of 'Channel', preserving Channel for Reservoir → Bucket only.
- **Public Lake** — regulated / credit-union yield product — the advisor-mode Earn destination. Half of the Park-rename pair (Public Park / Private Park were renamed to Public Lake / Private Lake by Task #849 so the destination sits cleanly inside the watershed metaphor).
- **Private Lake** — DeFi liquidity pool — the enthusiast-mode Earn destination, self-custody. The Earn flow ribbon's third station after Reservoir and Drip Harvester; replaces 'AMM pool' / 'liquidity pool' on every user-facing surface (Test 005).
- **Lake current** — the small fee paid into a Public/Private Lake each time a swap flows through it; the Drip Harvester's earnings are its share of those currents. Renamed from 'Park toll' by Task #849; the metaphor is that water flows through channels, collects in your Lake, and Currents from the Lake drip back into your Buckets.
- **Fill (verb)** — the act of putting idle RLUSD into a Lake. Renamed from 'park' by Task #849 — the Earn surface used 'park' as the verb for moving RLUSD into an LP; 'fill' brings the verb inside the water register and removes the last instance of 'park' from any Eave surface (decision logged in Test 002, Task #851).
- **Drainage** — debt payoff — the opposite move from Channel. The locked noun for paying down debt; the lesson formerly called 'Debt Channeling' was renamed 'Debt Drainage' so 'Channel' could be reserved for Reservoir → Bucket only (Test 002).
- **Park toll** — the swap fee a Park collects when someone exchanges through it; the Drip Harvester's earnings are its share of those tolls. Coined in Test 005 as the new noun replacing 'fee per swap' / 'trading fees' on the Earn surface — later renamed to 'Lake current' by Task #849 when the Park metaphor itself was renamed to Lake. Recorded here as the original sanctioned noun from Test 005's vocabulary sweep.
- **Scaffolding pretending to be engine** — Roughly 600 lines of procedural-music machinery — kick/snare scheduler, synth functions, chord timeline, LFO, music bus, per-scene chord-morph effect — sat behind `ENABLE_PROCEDURAL_MUSIC = false` for months in the Headwaters promo video's audio file, shaping how the file read and what future contributors thought the system did. Named as 'feature behind a flag' it was untouchable; named honestly as scaffolding pretending to be engine, it could be deleted, and ambient-audio.ts collapsed from 933 lines to ~330 with no change in runtime behavior. A flag that has been off long enough to forget why it was added is not a feature toggle — it is a name lying about the system's intent, and the honest move is to delete it.

Zone 2 · Workbench

Domain: Business / operating workbench — deal-flow, weekly steps, cost review, codetry working-doc, synthesis across all the zones

Status: live (you are here)

Opening: "Founder" feels odd. You don't found a community — you practice within it. You join to help. You have the phone calls, take the actions, practice listening. We practice these things because we know we need to. Crafting all day is what makes life that extra bit sweeter.

This is not a founder's dashboard. It is a practitioner's workbench — the place where the week is planned, the costs are walked, and the work is kept honest against what was said it would be.

Standby: Reads The Standby as the cross-zone synthesis the workbench is for — standby debriefs surface here as a recurring weekly-steps item once a call has stood down. The workbench keeps no live call state; it keeps the after-action read across zones.

Reflections:

- Where are you still using the language of a founder when you mean the work of a practitioner?
- What step have you been carrying over longest — and what would it mean to set it down instead of forward?
- Who in the community did you listen to this week?
- Is the practice you are building something you would want a grandchild to inherit — not the business, the way of working?
- What will be different in this community in fifty years if this practice continues — and is that the difference you intend?

Worked examples:

- **Today / Week / Year** — time-shape not feature-shape. The same data — phases × weeks × steps — surfaces three ways depending on the time-window the practitioner is standing in. 'Dashboard' would have flattened them.
- **Idea → Pitch → Contract → Fulfillment → Impact** — deal-flow as the spine the slide deck is re-spined around (src/lib/phases.ts). The phase IS where the practitioner currently is, and the deck reorders around that phase. Renaming to 'stages' would let the deck go static again.

- **Cost review walkthrough** — ~70 dollar figures registered in costRegistry.ts with rank order. Walked one-at-a-time, Approve/Edit/Skip + private notes. Not 'settings' — a discipline that gets done, like a pre-flight check.
- **Carry-over** — unfinished steps from past weeks roll forward as 'Carried over' on Today (not 'Overdue,' not 'Tasks'). Honest about time having passed without making it punitive.
- **Codetry (this doc)** — the version-controlled paper trail of the practice. Renaming to 'Design system' would erase that codetry is the practice naming itself.

Zone 3 · Greenhouse

Domain: Community production for NWO food systems — multi-tenant member-portal pattern

Status: live

Opening: Treasurer is the job nobody wants. Some try and fail; a few do well. It is a big commitment for a volunteer organization, and this generation does not have the same bookkeeping skills that the last one had. Nobody wants to step up because they do not want to mess up.

The answer is not to lower the standard — it is to make the job fail-safe, stress-free, and easy as pie for the people willing to take it on. Calm is the contract. The name is not a vibe; it is a promise the system makes to the person who was brave enough to say yes.

Standby: Host zone for The Standby. Centralized disruptions (drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power, water, freight, payment systems, pandemic, evacuation, AGM-postponed, key-person-down) are felt collectively here first — at the co-op shelf, the producer pipeline, the orders ledger. Call history is the record kept here; standby stock is the inventory primitive; The Common Pantry is the food/supply sub-shelf; The Watch is the active-monitoring sub-noun.

Reflections:

- Where in your organization is bravery being asked for without a safety net underneath it?
- What would change if the hardest volunteer job was also the most supported one?
- Who said yes to something difficult recently — and did they hear that it was noticed?
- Who in this community is making decisions as if they will be held accountable by people not yet born — and what does that look like in practice?

- What does a thriving version of this commons look like in 175 years — and what has to be true today for that to be possible?

Worked examples:

- **'Today I...' verbs as routing primitive** — the library front door isn't a menu of features; it's a shelf of verbs the member picks based on what today asks for (Today I cook & preserve / gather / order / learn / trade / help). The verb is the route, the photo-tile is the chapter cover, the cream recipe-card label sits on the photo. Audience (household vs producer) swaps which shelf you're looking at.
- **Library of recipe books** — audience-aware shelves of 8-12 themed stacks. Stacks = chapters, audience choice = which book. Visual recently caught up to metaphor — tiles read as printed recipe cards on a photo. Two-column on phones (a paired spread), three-column on desktop.
- **Treasurer Calm Monthly Journey** — 'Calm' is the contract, not a vibe. Confidence meter + per-treasurer lookahead preference (off / 1 / 2 / 3 days) + 14-day snooze-expiry outline + email digest + in-app banner. Treasurers plan ahead instead of reacting.
- **Dues snooze as primary verb** — treasurers don't 'defer' or 'pause' a dues line — they snooze it, and the system auto-wakes them with a digest tied to (recipient, lineItem, snoozedUntil). The verb dictates the behavior (something will wake you), not the other way around.
- **Stuck Board** — cross-domain aggregator at /admin/stuck and /board-hub/stuck. Pulls aging items from member onboarding, producer pipeline, outstanding dues, partner/grant sync errors, open grants, and marketplace seller replies into one owner-tagged view with last-touch timestamps. The name is the spec: things get stuck → the board surfaces them.
- **Producer Playbook** — sequenced markdown chapters producers work through, surfaced as list/detail with mailto CTAs back to the co-op. Playbook = ordered plays, not a wiki.
- **NOHFC Grow Application Workspace** — single-grant focused workspace at /applications/nohfc-grow-stream (lives in the Grants Finder artifact). Five tabs (eligibility, sections, budget, attachments, submission packet), deadline countdown, one-click switch to July 31 intake on a not-eligible verdict. Deliberately not a generalized grant form-builder — the grant is the unit of work.
- **Audience chooser as structural pivot** — signed-out visitors choose household vs producer; the choice persists in localStorage (807.audience.v1) and changes which library, which CTAs, and which dashboard cards render. One pivot, two products.

- **Board hub as cluster of role rooms** — /board-hub/{chair, treasurer, secretary, director, operations, distribution, agm, training, applications, drive-map, social-ideas, cashflow-budget, onboarding, stuck, orders} — each role gets its own room rather than a single admin dashboard. The role IS the room.
- **Tenant seam** — tenant.headerProductLabel, tenant.legalName, board contact routing in api-server/src/config/board.ts — anywhere the app would say the co-op name goes through the seam. The seam is what makes the Commons zone a pattern for community production, not a one-off for Dryden.
- **Kitchen rental kept quiet** — public marketing has zero kitchen-rental promotion; /partners/kitchen-rental exists as a 'borrow equipment for community programs' page that still POSTs the same inquiry route. The naming carries the policy: it's borrowing, not renting.
- **Appreciation Wall / 'help' stack** — members pin thank-you notes to other members. A first-class surface, not a footer widget — gratitude has its own room because the system says it matters.

Zone 4 · Clearing

Domain: Conventional → regenerative track for industries — multi-year, sector-scale; current sector is regen beef in NWO

Status: live (v0.1 anchor shipping)

Opening: It is not just the spreadsheet and the phone call. It is the Facebook comments, the Instagram comments, the Facebook messages, the marketplace comments, the email, the voicemail, the text message, the in-person conversation, the invoice. One person has to touch it all — because it is the only way the ball of yarn will not unravel.

The producers running these operations are not failing for lack of effort. They are failing for lack of capacity. If they had the capacity to systematize, they could find the efficiencies needed for real growth. That is the job this zone exists to do.

The word they use is not "regenerative." It is grass finished. Grazing. Fodder fed. The work names itself in what it produces and how it is done.

Standby: Reads The Standby as sector-level standby modeling — which industries have which fragilities to which calls. Regen beef in NWO, for example: a freight call hits the abattoir's outbound packed weights before it hits anything else; a power call hits cold storage; a key-person call hits Jude herself. Sector → call → first-touched node is the modeling unit.

Reflections:

- Where is the ball of yarn closest to unraveling — and what would it take to add one more pair of hands?
- What do you call what you do? Not what the movement calls it — what you call it.
- What would systematic look like for one part of your operation this season?
- Is the land in this sector producing more or less life than it was seven generations ago — and which direction are you pointed?
- What would this sector look like if every decision made in it for the last 175 years had been made with the seventh generation in mind — and how far is today from that?

Worked examples:

- **Per-customer share split** — replaced 'cut sheet management' as the v0.1 centerpiece. Pre-Jude strawman optimized a symptom; the real work was the math after the kill — 6-14 customers, one animal, by hand, twice a week. Renaming the centerpiece rewrote the schema, the success metrics, and the build sequence in one move.
- **Don't fix my book** — Jude's line. Dropped the booking calendar from v0.1 entirely. Naming her paper ledger as a working artifact (not a legacy obstacle) REMOVED a feature.
- **Failures land on the tool, not on her** — Black Barn's tone note. Now an architectural constraint on every error state — operator-protective copy, not generic 'something went wrong'.
- **Make it easier for Jude to say no** — Lisa Koshel's add. A v0.1 design principle, not a feature: scope-creep guards, lock-date enforcement, no-button-that-just-absorbs-pain.
- **OMAFRA traceability as byproduct** — the animal record was designed so the regulator's log falls out for free. Naming it 'byproduct' prevented a parallel ledger from being built.
- **Estimate → actual → variance loop** — Jude records real packaged weights; the same UI that showed '≈' to the farmer flips to 'Actual' when the data lands; the dashboard surfaces per-species variance; the constants in yield.ts stay tunable from that signal. Naming the whole cycle as a loop, not three features, kept it coherent.
- **Pre-zone parked thread** — 'Homestead-sitter / childcare app for farm families' — discovered during Black Barn discovery, deliberately not absorbed into Z4. Parked as a scratch thread; probably Z0 or Z5 when it finds a home.

Zone 5 · Edge

Domain: Wild / observation — private capture (takes) with structured channel-out and opt-in float to the Shallows

Status: live

Opening: A dam day is a day without rhyme or reason — where a spark was lit and a fire burst forth. It may be a creative hyperfocus, or a day that required a shift of energy that no constellation can contain. Dam days are fleeting. But there are gems worth harnessing in them — they may just be covered in muck.

The Shallows is where you clean them off. Not every take becomes something. But the practice of catching it before it disappears is the whole discipline.

Standby: Reads The Standby as the surface where debriefs that someone wants to share publicly float to the Shallows. The private-by-default posture holds: a debrief stays a Take in Edge unless its author chooses to float it. The Standby gives the chapter hint.

Reflections:

- What is sitting in the muck right now that might be worth cleaning off?
- How do you know when a day is a dam day versus a day that just got away from you?
- What would it mean to trust the dam day instead of fighting it?
- Which ideas in your margin are too big for your lifetime — and does that make them worth keeping or worth letting go?
- What would you want the seventh generation after you to know you were trying to do — and does anything you captured today point at that?

Worked examples:

- **The rebrand without a rewrite** — The Zone 5 app was deployed as watershed.replit.app before The Margin existed as a zone name. When the rename happened, it touched display strings, prose, and the Forge prompt — not chapter IDs, storage keys, or schema. The codetory test: change the name, did the structure survive? Yes — because the structure was the metaphor underneath the name. The URL stayed watershed.replit.app; the concept Watershed moved to Zone 1 where it always belonged.
- **Slowly at first, then all at once** — Same line lives on the home page (web), the book cover (screen reader), and the print PDF. One epigraph, three surfaces, identical bytes.

- **Typos as fingerprints** — The Forge system prompt mandates verbatim artifact preservation. The book that gets generated quotes the user's own typos back at them as evidence. The metaphor 'every drop is sacred' is implemented as // preserve typos, casing, weird spacing.
- **The Shallows handle** — A user posts anonymously; their pseudonym in that thread is stable; in another thread they're someone else. The 'depths below the shallows' framing is literally the session-hash one-way derivation.

Teachers

- **Jack Spirko** · The Survival Podcast — link · *for if times get tough or even if they don't*
- **Joel Salatin** · The Lunatic Farmer — link · *frequent meditations on food and farming that bring a wise and humble conscience to practice, policy, and participation*
- **Nicole Sauce** · Living Free in Tennessee — link · *build the life you choose on your terms*
- **Freedom Cells** — link · *peer-to-peer community organization, co-founded by Derrick Broze and John Bush*
- **Henry Cloud** · Boundaries / Your Desired Future — link · *you cannot change what you do not own; you cannot build what you have not named*

STANDBY CHECKLIST (ZONE 0 HOUSEHOLD)

The umbrella system + always-on state for temporary centralized disruptions — drought, fire, smoke, flood, ice, power, water, freight, payment systems, pandemic, evacuation, AGM-postponed, key-person-down. One name that holds both the slow side (always-on preparation) and the fast side (active event).

Rung: advisory

something is forming on the horizon; no posture change required, but the watch is informed

The Common Pantry

- **Glance at standby stock — what would we draw on first?** — Open the cupboard, the freezer, the medicine drawer. No re-stock yet — just see what's there.
- **Note what's running low (water, fuel, meds, batteries).**

The Watch

- **Read the latest advisory from the agency that issued it.** — One source, read fully. Don't doomscroll — pick the issuing agency and stay there.
- **Tell the household, in one sentence, what's forming.** — Kids included. The advisory is informed; the posture hasn't changed yet.

Rung: standby

preparation is sleeved in; standby stock is verified; envelopes ready to flex

The Common Pantry

- **Top up water on hand — 4 L per person per day for at least 3 days.** — Drinking, cooking, basic hygiene. Fill jugs and the bath if a shutoff is plausible.
- **Verify fuel for heat and the generator — and test-start the generator.** — Wood stacked, propane tank weight, jerry can full. A generator that won't start is not standby stock.
- **Refill meds you're low on — keep a 7-day buffer for everyone in the house.** — Prescription and over-the-counter. Note expiry on anything in the kit.
- **Check the first-aid kit, headlamps, batteries, hand-crank radio.**
- **Set aside small bills (cash) in case payment systems are down.**

The Watch

- **Confirm the kid-care plan — who picks up if school closes mid-day.** — Primary, backup, and the third name if both are at work. Tell the kids who.
- **Print the contact tree — who calls whom, on paper, not just in phones.** — Stick it on the fridge. Phones die; the fridge does not.
- **Agree on a meeting place if the household gets separated.** — One indoor, one outdoor. Tell every person, not just the adults.

- **Charge phones and the backup battery; queue a paper map of the route out.**
- **Pet & livestock plan — food, water, and an evacuation route for them too.**
- **Name the neighbour who'd struggle most — the elder, the household alone with kids.** — Decide who in your household checks on them when a call opens.

Rung: active

a call is open; the system is responding; envelopes and rosters have flipped

The Common Pantry

- **Open the call: pull standby stock out where the household can see it.** — Counter, table, hallway. What's hidden in a cupboard is not in the call.
- **Ration water at 4 L per person per day; log what's used.** — A line on a sheet of paper is enough. The log is for the debrief.
- **Run the generator on a schedule — don't leave it on or run the tank dry.**
- **Take meds at normal times. A call is not a reason to skip a dose.**

The Watch

- **Trigger the contact tree once — not five times.** — One message, the named callers make their named calls.
- **Confirm everyone is at the meeting place — or accounted for by name.**
- **Stay on one weather/agency channel; mute the rest.** — Pick the agency that issued the advisory. Information overload is a posture problem.
- **Check on the neighbour you named at standby.**

Rung: standdown

the call is closed; debrief opens; standby stock is replenished

The Common Pantry

- **Replenish standby stock — water, meds, fuel, batteries, first-aid.** — Replace what was used before the call closes in your head, or it won't get done.
- **Reset the fridge contact-tree printout if it got drawn on or torn.**

The Watch

- **Close the contact tree — one message: standdown.**
 - **Write the debrief: what worked, what didn't, what we'd reset.** — Five lines is plenty. The debrief is the artifact the household keeps.
 - **Send the debrief to the co-op so the cross-zone record holds.** — Optional, never required. The household keeps a copy either way.
-

NARRATION SCRIPTS

the-saltbox

Station 1 · The Saltbox — narration script

Source chapter: §1.2 The saltbox principle (`data/handbook.ts`, `id: "1-2"`) **Target length:** 75–100 seconds (about 220 words) **Voice direction:** Calm, considered, unhurried. Pause around the line breaks. Italics get gentle emphasis, not theatre.

A codetry app is named the way a saltbox house is built — every beam carries weight.

When we say *Saltbox Zone Zero*, we don't mean it as a label. The name is the design spec. It carries that the household is Zone Zero. It carries that this is the saltbox-house itself. And it carries that everything else in the system flows from this center.

Change the name, and you have changed the structure.

Codetry borrows from the cold-climate vernacular. A saltbox house wasn't designed for prettiness. Its asymmetric roof and thick north wall were the only way a house survived a boreal winter. The form *is* the function.

Codetry asks the same of software. Let the form-language do the structural work. Let the name carry the weight a column would otherwise carry.

So here is what to bring with you, into the next room of your day.

Walk through your home and pick the one room that does the most jobs. Write down — by hand, on paper — the three jobs it carries.

Then tape the paper to the doorframe.

That paper is your first piece of codetry. The room hasn't changed. But now its name is doing the work the architect's drawing used to do.

both-states

Station 2 · Both-States — narration script

Source chapter: §1.3 The both-states principle (`data/handbook.ts`, `id: "1-3"`) **Target length:** 100–125 seconds (about 280 words) **Voice direction:** Same calm narrator as Station 1. Slow down when you get to the candidate-rejection passage; the *Pantry* and *Watch* lines are the load-bearing example.

Some systems run in one register, and only need a name that fits that register. A *bucket* holds money in an envelope-budget app and never has to do anything else. The noun does one job, and does it cleanly.

Other systems run in *two tempos at once*. A slow side, and a fast side, that are the same room read at different speeds.

The temptation, every time, is to name each tempo separately, and let them grow into two systems. The both-states principle is the codetry move that resists that.

When a system has a slow tempo and a fast tempo that are the same plumbing read at different speeds — the umbrella name has to ride from one tempo to the other without bending. Or the system will fork into two systems, with two cadences, and two cultures.

Take *The Standby*. The Standby names both the always-on shelf — the pantry, the standby stock, the watch as a posture — and the active event — a call, the active rung on the ladder, the debrief once it stands down. One word, two tempos. The people, the stock, the vocabulary are all one. Only the cadence changes.

Two early candidates were rejected. *The Common Pantry* held the slow side beautifully — but couldn't hold an active fire call without straining. *The Watch* held the active posture — but couldn't hold the slow shelf of stock without bending into a permanent vigil.

Both survived as sub-shelves inside The Standby. Neither could be the umbrella name.

So here is the test. Pick the slow side first, and ask whether the noun also fits the fast side. Then pick the fast side, and ask whether the noun also fits the slow side. If the answer to either question is *not really* — the name is doing one job, and the system has already started forking.

both-sides

Station 3 · Both-Sides — narration script

Source chapter: §1.4 The both-sides principle (`data/handbook.ts`, `id: "1-4"`) **Target length:** 110–135 seconds (about 300 words) **Voice direction:** Same narrator. The vocabulary lists (*neighbour, channel, the books...* and *resident, bank account, financial statements...*) want a metered, list cadence — short pauses between items, no breathlessness.

The both-states principle holds when a system runs in two tempos.

A second class of system runs in one tempo, but in two contexts at once. Two audiences, holding two different vocabularies as legitimate. Neither willing to give up theirs to the other.

The temptation, every time, is to name each side separately, and let them grow into two pipes facing two rooms. The both-sides principle is the codetry move that resists that.

When a system has language that has to live in two contexts that hold different vocabularies as legitimate — the umbrella name has to fit both contexts in one word. Or the system will pick a dialect, and lose the other room.

Take *The Gate*. The Gate names both the *bright side* — the constellation's own dialect: *neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock, the watch* — and *the systems* — the outside world's dialect: *resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves, compliance officer* — inside one umbrella that does not pick a side. One word, two contexts.

Two candidates were rejected. *Translator* held the directional work — but flattened the membrane into pure transaction. A translator processes; a gate decides whether to. *Glossary* held the dictionary side — but couldn't hold the active posture of substituting words inside real documents, the ledger of past substitutions, or the *refused* rung for source-side language with no honest target-side equivalent.

Both survived as sub-shelves inside The Gate. Neither could be the umbrella name.

The both-states test picks a tempo. The both-sides test picks a context. Pick the bright side, and ask whether the umbrella name still respects the systems. Pick the systems side, and ask whether the umbrella name still respects the bright side.

Same word, different room. That is the test.

the-standby

Station 4 · The Standby — narration script

Source chapter: §2.10 The Standby — generated chapter from `data/foundingExamples.ts` (`primitiveId: "the-standby"`) **Target length:** 110–135 seconds (about 295 words) **Voice direction:** Slightly slower than the principle stations — this one names a primitive the reader will have to live with for a long time. The "two sides, one umbrella" line wants a held beat after it.

The Standby is the constellation's first non-zone primitive.

It holds two registers that an outside system would almost certainly split apart.

On one side is a slow, always-on practice. The pantry shelf is stocked. The contact tree is current. The generator gets test-started. The watch reads the morning advisory before anything is happening.

On the other side is a fast, episodic event. A fire call opens. The rosters flip. The standby stock comes out where everyone can see it. And the system runs in *active* until the call stands down.

Two sides. One umbrella.

If the slow side and the fast side were named separately — *The Pantry* for the shelf, *The Call* for the event — the constellation would end up with two systems. One would have an inventory cadence and no event handling. The other would have an event handler and no preparation discipline. The cultures would diverge. And the moment a call opened, the practitioner would discover that the people who keep the pantry are not the people who run the call. The handoff would have to be invented under fire.

The both-states test catches this before it happens. Pick the slow side, ask whether the umbrella name still fits the fast side. Pick the fast side, ask whether the umbrella name still fits the slow side. *Standby* passes both. *On standby*, and *standby stock*, are the same posture in different tempos.

The two-sidedness here is *temporal*. One system, two tempos. Slow side and fast side are the same plumbing running at different rates.

So when you walk back outside — what fails first on your homestead when the power goes out? Don't fix it yet. Just name it, in your own words, in pencil, where you can see it tomorrow.

Station 5 · The Gate — narration script

Source chapter: §2.11 The Gate — generated chapter from `data/foundingExamples.ts` (`primitiveId: "the-gate"`) **Target length:** 120–150 seconds (about 320 words) **Voice direction:** This is the last station; let it land. Slow the *bright side* and *the systems* vocabulary lists. After "Keep both. The two together are the gate." pause for two full beats before letting silence end the recording — the audio file should not be trimmed tight.

The Gate is the constellation's second non-zone primitive — language across institutional boundaries.

It holds two registers that an outside system wouldn't even recognise as siblings.

On one side is the *bright side* — the constellation's own dialect. The words a community uses with itself, in its own kitchens, meetings, and ledgers: *neighbour, channel, the books, standby stock, the watch*.

On the other side is *the systems* — the outside world's dialect. The language a regulator, a banker, a funder, a lawyer, or generic SaaS English will accept: *resident, bank account, financial statements, inventory reserves, compliance officer*.

Neither side is wrong inside its own context. Each side is unfit currency in the other's context.

If the two sides were named separately — *Translator* for the bright-to-systems direction, *Importer* for the systems-to-bright direction — the constellation would end up with two pipes and no posture.

The Gate is more than directional substitution. It decides whether a piece of language *should* cross at all, in either direction. It logs every substitution, so the bright-side noun stays on file alongside the systems-side equivalent. And it has a *refused* rung — for source-side language that has no honest target-side equivalent, and would lose its meaning under any substitution.

The two-sidedness here is *contextual*. One system, two contexts. Bright side and the systems are the same plumbing facing different rooms.

The Standby's two sides were *temporal*. The Gate's two sides are *contextual*. The Standby's principle is *both-states*. The Gate's principle is *both-sides*. Both are now registered as named principles in the manifest.

So here is what to bring back from this last station. Take one piece of mail from a regulator, a banker, or a government office. Underline every word in it your family wouldn't say at the table. Write your family's word in the margin, next to each one.

Keep both. The two together are the gate.
